



Manage special events

D1.HML.CL10.08

D1.HRM.CL9.07

Trainee Manual



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Trainee Manual



**William
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Institute**

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for foods, tourism
& hospitality

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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees' chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Manage special events

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Manage special events in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HML.CL10.08
D1.HRM.CL9.07

Nominal Hours:

80

Element 1: Develop event concept and proposal

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Identify event objectives and scope
- 1.2 Establish event concept, theme, format and protocols
- 1.3 Prepare event brief
- 1.4 Develop event proposal/bid details, where necessary

Element 2: Determine event venue/location

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Identify potential event venues and sites
- 2.2 Analyse alternative event venues and sites
- 2.3 Select event venue/site
- 2.4 Confirm arrangements for selected venue/site

Element 3: Plan and deliver event catering

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Identify and analyse event factors which may impact on catering
- 3.2 Prepare event catering proposal
- 3.3 Prepare event catering operational plan
- 3.4 Implement event catering operational plan

Element 4: Plan and deliver sponsorship plans

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Identify sponsorship opportunities, where appropriate
- 4.2 Create and promote sponsorship packages, where appropriate
- 4.3 Implement sponsorship items and activities
- 4.4 Follow up with sponsors

Element 5: Plan and deliver event management

Performance Criteria

- 5.1 Liaise with event stakeholders
- 5.2 Prepare event management plan
- 5.3 Manage event set up in-line with event management plan
- 5.4 Monitor conduct and implementation of event in-line with event management plan
- 5.5 Manage finalisation of event and event breakdown in-line with event management plan

Element 6: Plan and deliver event registration

Performance Criteria

- 6.1 Take event bookings and process event registrations
- 6.2 Monitor on-going event registrations and take remedial action where necessary to increase attendance/registrations
- 6.3 Finalise event registrations
- 6.4 Produce identified event materials for guests and delegates
- 6.5 Coordinate and process guest and delegate registration at the event

Element 7: Plan and deliver infrastructure for outdoor event

Performance Criteria

- 7.1 Identify necessary infrastructure requirements
- 7.2 Organise identified infrastructure needs
- 7.3 Monitor implementation of identified infrastructure requirements

Element 8: Conduct post-event evaluation

Performance Criteria

- 8.1 Meet with client to discuss the event and finalise outstanding issues
- 8.2 Meet with sponsors to analyse their thoughts
- 8.3 Meet with staff to debrief the event
- 8.4 Calculate the financial outcome of the event
- 8.5 Determine the extent to which the event attained the identified objectives that were set for it

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Develop event concept and proposal				
1.1	Identify event objectives and scope	1.1	1	1
1.2	Establish event concept, theme, format and protocols	1.2	2	2
1.3	Prepare event brief	1.3	3	3
1.4	Develop event proposal/bid details, where necessary	1.4	4	4
Element 2: Determine event venue/location				
2.1	Identify potential event venues and sites	2.1	5	5
2.2	Analyse alternative event venues and sites	2.2	6	6
2.3	Select event venue/site	2.3	7	7
2.4	Confirm arrangements for selected venue/site	2.4	8	8
Element 3: Plan and deliver event catering				
3.1	Identify and analyse event factors which may impact on catering	3.1	9	9
3.2	Prepare event catering proposal	3.2	10	10
3.3	Prepare event catering operational plan	3.3	11	11
3.4	Implement event catering operational plan	3.4	12	12

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 4: Plan and deliver sponsorship plans				
4.1	Identify sponsorship opportunities, where appropriate	4.1	13	13
4.2	Create and promote sponsorship packages, where appropriate	4.2	14	14
4.3	Implement sponsorship items and activities	4.3	15	15
4.4	Follow up with sponsors	4.4	16	16
Element 5: Plan and deliver event management				
5.1	Liaise with event stakeholders	5.1	17	17
5.2	Prepare event management plan	5.2	18	18
5.3	Manage event set up in-line with event management plan	5.3	19	19
5.4	Monitor conduct and implementation of event in-line with event management plan	5.4	20	20
5.5	Manage finalisation of event and event breakdown in-line with event management plan	5.5	21	21
Element 6: Plan and deliver event registration				
6.1	Take event bookings and process event registrations	6.1	22	22
6.2	Monitor on-going event registrations and take remedial action where necessary to increase attendance/registrations	6.2	23	23
6.3	Finalise event registrations	6.3	24	24
6.4	Produce identified event materials for guests and delegates	6.4	25	25
6.5	Coordinate and process guest and delegate registration at the event	6.5	26	26
Element 7: Plan and deliver infrastructure for outdoor event				
7.1	Identify necessary infrastructure requirements	7.1	27	27
7.2	Organise identified infrastructure needs	7.2	28	28
7.3	Monitor implementation of identified infrastructure requirements	7.3	29	29

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 8: Conduct post-event evaluation				
8.1	Meet with client to discuss the event and finalise outstanding issues	8.1	30	30
8.2	Meet with sponsors to analyse their thoughts	8.2	31	31
8.3	Meet with staff to debrief the event	8.3	32	32
8.4	Calculate the financial outcome of the event	8.4	33	33
8.5	Determine the extent to which the event attained the identified objectives that were set for it	8.5	34	34

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Access	The right of entry to a venue
Accoutrements	'Accoutrements' are the items used to fit out the tables
A la carte	term used for a menu that has individually priced dishes
Banquet	A formal event comprising food, beverage and entertainment
Briefing	An informational meeting
Buffet	A display of food and beverage items
Catering	The provision of food, beverage and other services associated with an event, function or meeting
Client	The person who is arranging the event, either for themselves or on behalf of an organisation
Continental breakfast	A style of breakfast made up of fruit, cereal, pastries, juices and tea and coffee. No cooked food is normally included
Cover	A place setting for one guest
Crockery	Plates, bowls, cups and saucers
Cutlery	Knives, forks, spoons and teaspoons
Deficiencies	Problems that exist in an operation, technique or equipment
Event / Function	A structured purpose for people meeting together
Event Management Plan	A plan that takes into consideration all possible scenarios and activities that need to either be planned or addressed
Glassware	Different types of glass vessels
Infrastructure	Physical requirements needed to conduct an event

Term	Explanation
Liaise	To meet and communicate
Merchandise	Items that may be sold or given to event delegates
Quotation	A detailed presentation of proposed event activities and costs
Registration	The process of collecting and recording delegate information
Registrations correspondence	The various forms and documents that are sent to/from event management to delegates in the lead up to an event
Sponsor	An individual or company who makes a contribution to an event for an expected return
Suppliers	Different organisations that contribute to the running of an event or function

Element 1:

Develop event concept and proposal

1.1 Identify event objectives and scope

Introduction

Events are a unique style of service provided by hospitality organisations. Whilst some aspects of the service reflect those provided in any food and beverage setting, such as the provision of food and beverage, there are many aspects to it that differ greatly. As most events are unique and present many challenges, it is an exciting operation that requires creative, flexible and hard working individuals.

This manual will explore the world of events and discuss all the activities associated in planning, preparing and delivering a professional event.

Concept of events

Traditionally, events were known as the provision of food and beverage or a meeting at a location which is not prepared at one's home. This normally meant at areas such as hotels, resorts, restaurants.

In today's world, events are not only restricted to these venues but can be expanded to include any location imaginable including:

- Homes for private functions
- Meetings, banquets, conventions, and weddings
- Nature areas including open water, zoos, parks, wineries
- Transportation vehicles – including planes, yachts, cars, buses
- Festivals
- Sporting events
- Birthday parties
- Anniversaries.



In today's world where time is of the essence, anyone can take advantage of organisations that provide events to organise any occasion, whether for business or pleasure. By using professional event organisers a lot of the organisation, hassle, responsibility and stress associated with holding an event are taken away.

Whilst some events do not involve catering, most will consist of some level of food and beverage provision. These items may be prepared completely at the event or may choose to bring prepared items and put the finishing touches on once it arrives.

Again, the range of food and beverage itself provided can vary from a simple boxed meal consisting of a sandwich, fruit, cake and drink, through to lavish 10 course banquets, served at the table.

In most hotels there is a dedicated area for functions, which can cater to a wide variety of activities comprising each function.

The facilities normally comprise a number of empty rooms that can be used for a variety of purposes. In addition, they are designed with flexibility in mind to ensure that they meet the needs of each function. It is common for a function area to be made up of one large vacant area that can be divided into smaller individual rooms of different sizes.



Given that many function areas are extremely busy, it is also common for a wide range of hotel facilities to be used that are associated with functions.

Benefits of events

There are many reasons why events are becoming a popular style of business.

For the customer:

- It saves time and stress
- It allows for professional staff to have the responsibility for running an event
- It provides access to rooms, space, locations and equipment that is not found in a normal office or home environment
- The outcome is a product or service which cannot be produced by a home or office environment.



For a hospitality organisation:

- It is an additional revenue source
- It allows the organisation to promote itself away from the physical location of the hotel
- It promotes creativity, skills and knowledge in staff.

Types of events or functions

Most people may think that a function is just a catered event where people sit down to a banquet dinner. It could not be further from the truth.

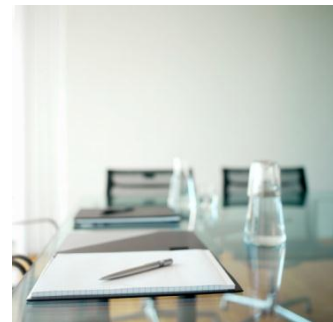
There are endless styles of functions that can be arranged, tailored to the unique specifications and requirements of the customer.

Therefore the activities to be conducted will vary depending on the event of function that is taking place.

Styles of functions

The hospitality industry can deliver a range of different function styles for customers including:

- Breakfasts
- Lunches
- Dinners
- Seminars, workshops and conferences
- Cocktail parties
- General parties – birthdays, celebrations of various sorts
- Wedding receptions
- Anniversaries
- 21st birthday parties
- Product launches and distributor functions
- School formals, annual dinners and dinner dances
- Annual general meetings
- Training seminars
- Graduations and award nights
- Press receptions
- Fashion shows
- Special events
- Tradeshows
- Stage productions, including musical events.



As you can see, the styles of functions are endless. Whilst many hospitality organisations may offer all of these to potential customers, they may also specialise in order to attract a select or niche market and be seen as the industry leaders for a particular style of function.

MICE

Many venues focus on the MICE sector of the industry.

MICE stands for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and Events.

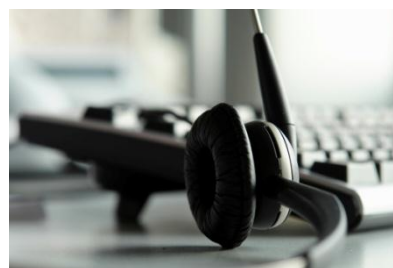
- Meetings include general business meetings
- Incentives refers to functions that businesses organise to reward or motivate staff
- Conferences are usually business or industry based occasions where people get together to discuss issues and share knowledge
- Events can include bands, concerts and a variety of entertainment.



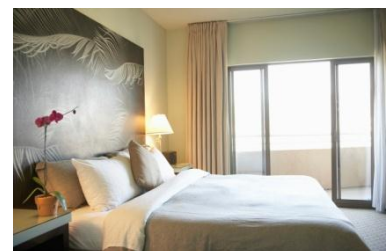
Range of event facilities

The various hotel facilities that may be used to directly or indirectly support functions include:

- Meeting/conference room – this is the main facility that is used for a function. Many functions during the day hold business related meetings. The focus of these rooms is to ensure small to large meetings can be conducted with the appropriate technological capacity
- Stand up conference areas - this can include areas outside the main conference room that is used for welcoming customers, break out areas, cocktail receptions etc. These areas may not be as large as the main room themselves, however may offer great views and are a great area to use, when main conference room needs to be replenished or cleaned
- Banquet room – these rooms, often similar to meeting or conference rooms, are used for banquets. As will be discussed in the next section, a banquet is a function based around the provision of food and beverage. Therefore not only does the room need to be large to accommodate banquet groups but it needs direct access to a kitchen and bar dispensing facility
- Exhibition bays and space – many hotels cater to the exhibition market where customers can showcase their offerings. These rooms need to be big and are able to accommodate separate bays and high displays
- Business centres – are used to aid organisers and participants of events with all their business needs through a host of services including:
 - High-speed Internet access
 - Word processing
 - Photocopying
 - Faxing services
 - Computer access and rental
 - Faxing services
 - Office supplies
 - Packaging and shipping
 - Secretarial services
 - Courier service
 - Translations
 - Arrangement of transport
- Auditoriums – used for large audience presentations and events. These areas must be able to accommodate large seating capacities and adequate height and depth for main stages etc



- Press rooms – these are used by the press in order to prepare and submit information relating to a function taking place in the hotel. They will normally include the provision of:
 - Tables and Chairs
 - Internet access
 - Business equipment
 - Basic food and beverage
- Storage bays – these are used to store a wide range of items used for a function, whether for the use of staff or customers and include:
 - Storage cupboards – for packages, boxes, equipment, stationery, documents decorations and displays to be used in a function. Often these items are sent in advance of the function itself by the organiser
 - Cloak rooms – for jackets and coats of participants
 - Baggage areas – for luggage of participants. In some cases participants of functions may not have access to accommodation rooms and need a place to store luggage whilst the function commences. In addition presents for weddings may need to be stored for later collection
- Parking facilities – naturally depending on the size of the function, suitable parking needs to be arranged. Spaces may need to be reserved for all participants or for a selected few VIPs
- Change rooms – may need to be provided for sporting events or where participants may need to refresh after a conference before departing the hotel
- Display areas – these may be outside the main function room enabling a company to place a banner or a display. Often it is immediately outside the main function room, the lift or in the lobby of the hotel
- Designated and discreet sections of restaurants and/or bars – normally used as dedicated lunch or dining areas for functions. In cases where main function rooms are operating at maximum capacity, these may be used as function rooms themselves. They will be partitioned off to ensure privacy. Quite often they are used for staff meetings and training sessions
- Food and beverage service – many functions have some element of food and beverage which require preparation kitchens, fridges etc
- Accommodation – accommodation rooms may be used for a number of reasons including:
 - Accommodate participants overnight
 - To be used as breakout rooms to host smaller meetings
 - To be used as a rest and change area for wedding parties and for VIPs at conferences. It is not uncommon for a hotel to allocate a number of rooms to a large function enabling VIPs to refresh before departing for long flights etc
- Sound and lighting – Not only does sound and equipment take up a large amount of space, any parts must also be stored in a safe and secure location



- Communication technologies and equipment – In most events or functions, there is a need for some need for technical equipment or services including:
 - Audio can include taping, telephone hook-ups, speakers to external points
 - Visual (video/television/direct conference)
 - Data projectors
 - Large screens including printable white boards
 - Multi-media provision including linkages and compatible hook-up points
 - Computers and internet connectivity
- Sound and music facilities, including microphones, speakers etc
- Gardens – these are often used for outdoor events such as cocktail parties and weddings.



Receiving an enquiry

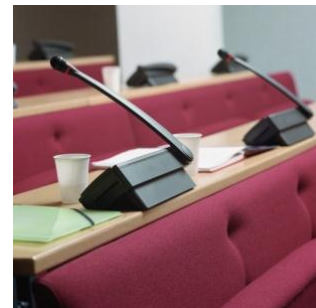
In many cases, the client will contact a hotel events department directly, either by phone or by email in relation to an event enquiry.

In many cases the client will be contacting a number of possible venues not only to see what is available but to compare offerings and prices to ensure they get a provider who can best cater to their needs.

When receiving an enquiry an event co-ordinator may record information to help them prepare a detailed quotation for review by the potential client.

Some of this information can include:

- Contact person – correct name, name of business
- Contact details – phone number, email address etc
- Type of event
- Location
- Date and time of event
- Budget
- Possible number of attendees or guests
- Overview of event requirements
- Special instructions or requests.



As events can be quite complex, in an initial discussion it is often the goal to get an overview of the client's expectations and to prepare a proposal based on these.

Normally the event co-ordinator will also extend an invitation for the client to visit the hotel to discuss the event in more detail and to show them in person what the hotel or establishment can provide.

Meeting with clients

To date, we have looked at a number of possible events that may be required by the client, however before any event or function can be organised there is a need to determine client needs for it.

The most effective way to do this is to meet face-to-face with the client and talk to them about their needs, wants and preferences.

After receiving an enquiry and once initial information has been sent to clients regarding an event or function it is best practice to invite the client to your venue to

- Talk to them about their expectations and needs
- Allow them to view the property and its facilities
- Meet some of the key staff, where appropriate.

The meeting should be scheduled at a time to suit the client and conducted in a private location, such as the board room or your office.

It is appropriate to provide catering, light refreshments and even a meal.

In the following sections, the information gathered in relation to an event will be detailed.



1.2 Establish event concept, theme, format and protocols

Introduction

As identified in the previous section it is important to identify client requirements in order to determine whether or not the venue can, or wants to, provide what is required.

The following is a list of the topics that need to be addressed as part of this process. Your venue may have a checklist prepared to guide you through the questions to ask and the information to be gathered at this initial meeting - where you have such a checklist you must use it.

If you do not have such a checklist it is vital you take extensive notes to function as the basis for the work you will need to do in order to provide costings, suggestions, options and ideas to the client.

Timing

As mentioned, this is probably the first thing to be discussed.

You need to identify the date the client wants their function and the time of day their function will occupy.

Most clients will have a specific date in mind and a start and finish time. In the majority of cases this is not negotiable. If you are already booked for this date the client will often have to look elsewhere. In some limited cases the client will have room to move the function.

You need to identify:

- Date of the event or function – remember some functions such as conferences and incentives will take more than one day
- The amount of preparation time needed to set up rooms and otherwise get the function area ready for the event. This may include use of in-house staff and external suppliers to set up stages, lighting and displays
- Checking availability in Functions Booking book
- Assessing the potential for moving existing bookings to a different location/room and/or date.



Most venues have a function booking book, be it in paper-based or electronic format. You should have this with you at the meeting to assist in identifying availability and options.

Note that further details regarding timing requirements will need to be addressed at a later stage when the function is confirmed.

Type of event

You need to identify the type of function the client wants to hold.

This is important as some venues have a policy of not hosting certain events such as rowdy parties or sporting groups.

Knowing out the type of function may also intersect with availability issues. For example, you may be able to host a small function for 20 people in a small function room at the same time a larger function is taking place in the main function room.

Size and type of room

One of the most important aspects of a function is the requirements for where the function is to take place and how much room is needed.

Questions that may be asked include:

- What room requirements do they need?
- Do they have a preference for your ballroom, dining room, foyer, outside area, small conference room or theatrette?
- Is there a need for break-out rooms?



Numbers attending

This is another critical requirement as all venues have limits on the numbers of people they can accommodate.

Once again, this factor also intersects with potential room availability.

Some venues will also seek to identify the ratio of males to females attending, as well as number of children. In a conference situation there may also who will be accompanying delegates but not attending the conference.



Catering

At this stage discussions regarding catering need only to address general requirements.

Catering refers to the provision of food and beverages for the function.

You should attempt to determine answers to the following questions:

- If the enquiry is about a function:
 - Is catering required 'on arrival'? If so, what is required?
 - Does the client want a sit-down meal or stand-up finger food?
 - If it is a sit-down meal, how many courses?
 - If it is finger food, what sort of food is required?
 - Are there any special requests, or needs to accommodate any special health or cultural requirements?

- If the enquiry is about an event:
 - Is catering required 'on arrival'? If so, what is required?
 - Is there a requirement to provide catering at break times – morning tea, afternoon tea, supper? If so, what is required? Danish pastries, cake, biscuits, fruit?
 - Is there any requirement to provide refreshments throughout the day for the event? This may include mints, bottled water, jugs of water, fruit juices etc
 - Is catering required for breakfast, lunch or dinner?
 - Does the client want a sit-down meal or stand-up finger food for lunch?
 - If it is a sit-down meal, how many courses?
 - If it is finger food, what sort of food is required?
 - Are there any special requests, or needs to accommodate any special health or cultural requirements?



Technical equipment

The technical requirements for a function will vary greatly depending on the type and style of function being booked.

Not all establishments will have technical equipment on-hand and may need to lease or hire such equipment from an outside service.

The cost of such will be charged to the customer.

The different types of technical equipment were previously discussed.

Some clients, especially companies, will want to use their own audio-visual people and equipment for the screening of DVDs, PowerPoint presentations slides, the presentation of speeches, recording of events, or management of teleconferences.

It is important to get a clear understanding of what is required in this regard as your costings will need to include the cost of any equipment that has to be hired or bought-in for the function.



Access

It is important to raise access to the property as part of the initial discussion to identify what the client requirements are likely to be prior to the event.

Many clients require access to the venue or function area to deliver materials, goods, and displays and to enable their personnel to assist with setting up displays, setting sound and lighting levels, testing equipment, placing flowers on tables etc.

In some cases their needs can be quite extensive and in other cases there is no need for access other than at the time of the function.

This topic relates strongly to bump-in and bump-out.

When you discuss access it is useful to also cover a description of what the client wants to bring in to the venue. For example, the client may want to have a car as part of a display but your facility may not enable access to something of that size.

Bump-in and bump-out

The terms bump-in and bump-out are most commonly used when bands are involved but can also apply to other events.

It refers to the time and dates that the client has to move their items into the venue (bump-in) and for removing them from the venue after the event has finished (bump-out).

It is important client requirements in this regard are factored in when determining availability of the venue.

Generally, the larger the function, the more time required for bump-in, bump-out. One to two days is not uncommon.

You also need to realise the bump-in, bump out times can also add expense to the costing as there will need to be someone from the venue available to answer questions, provide directions and oversee activities during these periods.



Themes and decorations

It is quite common for functions to involve a theme and the use of decorations to match the theme or to add to the visual appeal of the event.

From time-to-time you may be asked to suggest a theme for a function, and to suggest decorations.

It is best to ask the client if they have any thoughts on the matter before making these suggestions as they are fraught with danger inasmuch as your recommendations can often not align with client preferences.

Where possible refer the client to photographs or DVDs of previous functions.

Questions that may be asked include:

- Are there to be any theme or decorations required?
- Is the client supplying them and putting them up?
- Does the client want the venue to supply them?
- What sort do they want and how extensive are they?



Security

You should also ask the client about their requirements for security.

While the venue may provide a basic security service for small functions, larger functions can create a need for extra security staff, which will have to be charged for.

Security staff may, depending on the function, be required to:

- Provide screening of people entering the function
- Provide general crowd control
- Secure the car parks
- Patrol the areas 'out-of-hours' – this is most common where displays, marquees etc, are set up in external areas.

Media

It is always worthwhile raising the issue of media attention at any function and identifying how the client wants the media treated.

Clients often forget about media attendance.

In many cases the client can require them to receive specified catering, access etc.

Use of external suppliers

There are a wide variety of external suppliers that can be used to help provide or assist in the running and co-ordination of an event.

Style and format

Functions may range from informal through to formal to reflect the nature of the function.

Informal functions

Informal functions are characterised by:

- No set time for guest arrival
- No dress code
- Flexible times for food and beverage service
- Impromptu speeches
- No service protocol
- No seating plan.



Formal functions

Formal functions are characterised by:

- Dress code
- Set time for guests to arrive
- Registration and name tag requirements
- Allocated time for speeches and presentations etc
- Specific meal times
- Semi-silver service or full silver service
- Program for the occasion
- Specific service protocols
- Specific seating plan
- Guest speakers or Master of Ceremonies presentations
- Specific times for entertainment to commence and finish.



Room layout

Room layout will depend on client needs and the style best suited to meet those needs.

Stand-up function

This style of function is generally used for cocktail parties, general parties or lunches that are part of a conference.

The only seating might be around the edges of the room with several tables placed randomly in various places to provide the guests with a place to put down their drinks and any unwanted glassware and used plates.

When deciding if a stand-up function is suitable, it is worth bearing in mind the proposed duration of the function. Does the client think that the guests can stand for the length of time expected?

Stand-up lunches for conferences where delegates have been seated all morning are a good idea to allow them to stand up for a while.

Stand-up lunches are usually a less expensive than sit-down meals and they encourage people to mingle and network.

The very nature of a stand-up function is attractive to some clients and to some function types as it does not encourage people to settle in and stay for extended periods.

Sit down function

This style of function is generally used for weddings or formal dinners, banquets and presentations.

Most dinners for conferences are also sit-down.

The tables and seating used for such a function are placed in accordance with specific table number and stated seating requirements.

Some functions may require tables of six, whereas other functions may require tables of ten or more.



Boardroom meeting

Smaller functions or meetings can be catered for in small rooms or the board room.

There are a number of styles to use when setting up a boardroom meeting.

Each style has its own benefits, which should be matched to the needs of the client.

- Theatre style – this is where chairs are placed in rows facing a stage or head table. This layout is used to address large audiences whom do not need tables in which to record information. It is also used where the audience is required to listen as opposed to communicating themselves. It is important to have aisles in which both participants and speakers can easily move around in. It is popular with seminars and presentations
- Boardroom style – this is the use of a small to large table where all participants are able to see and converse with each other and have their own place in which to spread out documents and record information. This layout is popular for many meetings as it allows for interaction
- Hollow square - depending on the size of the audience, a boardroom format may be required, to allow for interaction and discussion but there are simply too many people. In essence this is where tables are set up in a square, hexagon or round format with room for microphones, photographers or plant displays etc in the middle
- Classroom style – this is where tables and chairs are set up in straight lines or in a v-shape formation, similar to a classroom setting at school. The tables face the front of the room so that all participants can easily see the instructor. This layout is popular when large amounts of audience members are in attendance, each requiring space to layout documents. It is also useful in presenting computer training sessions
- Banquet style – this is where smaller round, square or rectangular tables are used for smaller discussions and group work
- U Shape – also known as a 'horseshoe' this format allows audience members to see each other and interact whilst accommodating larger numbers. It also allows for a presenter to walk within the 'U-shape' itself to personally interact with each participant. It is a very popular layout method
- E-shape – this is a variation to a U 'shape' as it allows for greater numbers of audience members, as table is placed in the middle of the U 'shape'.



Using different set up options

Depending on the function they may use different lay outs, either:

- Simultaneously – where a function may address large audiences, therefore requiring a seminar format, but then allows participants to work in smaller groups, therefore using a boardroom or banquet style
- At different times of the day – for example a room may be set up for a conference using a 'U-shape- format during the day but need a banquet layout at night for a formal dinner.

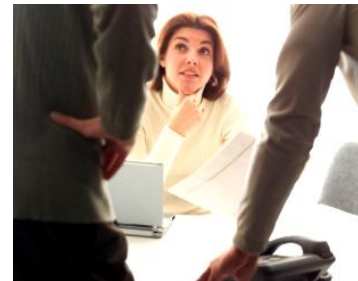


Identification of key stakeholders

There may be many stakeholders who are involved in the organisation and implementation of an event.

These may include:

- Event principal
- Local community
- Organising committees
- Local authorities including police and fire
- Internal event staff
- External contractors
- Entertainers
- Talent
- Staff from host businesses.



Event liaison and management structure

Every event must have clear channels of communication and lines of authority and responsibility. In the event of large events, involving a number of suppliers, host businesses, departments or staff, this is essential to ensure that all key decision makers are not only aware of what is happening but have given appropriate consent or authorisation to do so.

It is vital to confirm:

- Event liaison – who are the contact people communications be directed to and who needs to be copied or involved in communication
- Management structure – who are key managers in relation to different aspects of an event
- Lines of authority - who are the ultimate decision makers or have overriding authority and responsibility.



Develop options and ideas in consultation with colleagues and suppliers to assist client with event planning

Some clients have extensive experience with planning an event and many do not. Some clients will expect you to assist them in developing and planning their event and others will not.

How do you identify if the client needs planning assistance?

You will gather a good idea of whether or not the client needs this type of assistance during the initial meeting with them.

You will form your judgement by virtue of:

- The questions they ask
- What they know about the venue and functions in general
- Any previous experience with functions they share with you
- Whether or not they are repeat clients.



If you are unsure about whether or not they require help it is acceptable to ask them if they do.

Remaining client focussed

When you are developing ideas and options to assist the client in the development and planning of their function it is vital to remain client focussed.

It is essential the client believes your advice, suggestions, recommendations etc are being made to best meet their stated needs and preferences. It is very counter-productive for the client to believe they are being offered options and ideas which are solely of benefit to the venue by virtue of adding cost to the final bill.

Events and functions demand the client trusts and has confidence in the venue. As soon as the client starts thinking your focus is on 'money' (maximising revenue, optimising profit) and not on their needs, this trust and confidence quickly starts to evaporate.

Who may be involved in this process?

The type and extent of the function will determine who you should involve.

Obviously not every venue will have all of the following people, but the following list is indicative of who you might talk to:

- Property owner or manager
- Head Chef
- Food and Beverage manager
- Bar manager
- Dining room manager
- Head housekeeper
- Entertainment/event manager
- Functions manager
- Head of Security.



1.3 Prepare event brief

Introduction

Once the event organiser has had an initial meeting with the client, they will now be able to prepare an event brief, in which to base their proposal and quotation of prices.

An event brief is the template which contains all necessary information relating to a catered event or function.

Therefore this will be the primary document used to not only prepare a proposal but it also clearly identifies a range of event considerations.

This event brief is then used as the template for a 'Function sheet' (sometimes also known as an 'event order' or 'function order') that is an internal communication form that sets out the details of a function.



Content of an event brief

Naturally an event brief will only be as detailed as the depth of discussions carried out between the event organiser and the client, but some details that will be included may be:

- Agreed event details – including concept, theme, format and protocols
- Identification of stakeholders – and their individual roles
- Allocation of responsibilities and setting of milestones and task completion dates
- Type of function – wedding, launch of product, ball
- Name, address, and contact number of client
- Day, date and time of the function
- Rooms and locations where the function will be held
- Costings – where determined
- Billing instructions – who gets the bill, their address
- Menu – break-down course-by-course of the agreed dishes including specification of 'on arrival' food, morning and afternoon teas
- Beverage arrangements – description and quantities of beverages to be provided
- Sequence of service – covering timing of service, and details of when speeches and presentations will occur
- Entertainment – details of bands and the order of ceremony
- Room set up – number of tables, floor plan, decorations, table set-ups (cutlery, crockery and table accoutrements)
- Type of service – plated, tray, buffet, silver service, finger food
- Special requirements – commonly relating to technology requirements such as microphone, DVD facilities, data projector, sound and lighting.



1.4 Develop event proposal/bid details, where necessary

Introduction

All potential clients will need to be supplied with a proposal and quotation for their function before they commit to booking it and paying a deposit.

By preparing an event brief, as detailed in the previous section, an event proposal can be constructed for the consideration of the client.

The critical nature of quotations

Providing a quotation to a client is a serious business.

If the cost is too high, the client may elect not to proceed with the function.

If the quote is too low, the venue may not make enough profit or could even lose money.

Provide overview of how you can meet/exceed client expectations

Given that the client will usually collect proposals and quotations from a number of competing hotels it is essential that you are able to detail how you can meet or hopefully exceed their expectations.

These 'unique selling points' must be clear in their definition and how they are to be achieved or provided.

Factors to take into account when developing a costing

The following are important points to bear in mind when developing a costing:

Follow house policies

Every venue will have its own protocols for determining the final cost for a function and it is essential you adhere to these. Where there is a chance to be involved with senior staff when they meet a client and cost a function, you should take advantage of that opportunity.

Make sure everything is charged for

It is essential that all charges which can be legitimately charged for are included in the quotation.

The information gathered from the initial meeting with the client together with subsequent contacts with the client will provide the basis for this.

Only include services and products the client has requested

While you are expected to suggest and pursue additional sales opportunities with all clients, the quotation should only cover the items that have been confirmed with the client.

If house policy requires additional potential services and products are included as part of the quotation they should be contained on a separate page and quite clearly indicated as options and not as part of the final quote.

Double-check your figures

It should be standard procedure to check and double-check all figures contained in the quote.

This need to check and double-check applies to:

- In-house charges – for accommodation rooms, provision of in-house services (spa treatments, room hire, use of nominated facilities)
- Goods and services to be provided by external providers – always check with suppliers to get up-to-date and accurate quotes from them regarding goods and services they are to provide
- Confirming house policy regarding charging for third party suppliers – where the venue is using external providers to supply nominated goods and services you must know what the venue policy is regarding how these charges are to be passed on to the client. Some venues may charge these out 'at cost' and some may add a certain percentage as a fee to cover the time involved in arranging things
- Arithmetic calculations – you must check all your additions, extensions etc, are correct
- Including any discounts that may apply – these may apply to certain Very Important People (VIP) clients, or by virtue of their membership of some club or organisation.

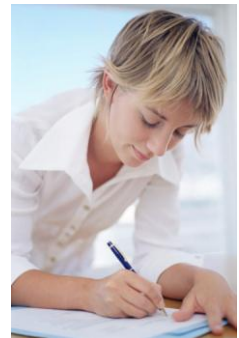
Identify and explain every charge

It is standard procedure to ensure each and every charge the client is being asked to pay is individually identified and priced.

The intention is to provide the client with a detailed, clear and unambiguous quotation with no hint of deception or hidden costs.

In practice this means there can be a need to specify:

- The number of accommodation rooms included in the quotation – and the type of room and in-room facilities
- Where a three course meal is offered – the choices available for each course
- Where wine is being provided as part of the catering – the number of bottles, the type and brand, style, vintage
- Where refreshments are being provided on arrival or during breaks – exactly what will be provided
- If extra security is being charged for – the number of security staff and the service they will be providing.



Observe promises made

Where you have promised the client certain facilities and services, it is essential these are included in the quotation to confirm to the client they will be provided.

Where you have promised the client their quotation will be provided by a given date, this promise must also be met. In the mind of the client, if you can't get the quotation done as promised it does not give them confidence in your ability to execute the function.

Verify with management

Always get management to double-check any quotation before it is presented to the client. Never present a quotation to a client unless you have specific authority to do so.

The experience and operational knowledge that management have can often raise an issue, cost or operating issue that you are unaware of, that has significant impact on the quotation.



Preparing for delivery of the proposal and quotation

Prepare materials

It is important to prepare a range of materials that may be used to illustrate the planned actions.

These include:

- Quotation – including detailed list of activities and costings
- Event brief – as discussed in the previous section
- Bid materials, promotional materials and visual presentations that will be used in the meeting with the client



Presenting the proposal and quotation

Try to present the quotation in person

Where possible try to meet with the client when you present the quotation.

This enables you to explain the various charges.

If the client simply receives a postal or e-mailed quotation their focus can often be on the cost and they may fail to appreciate the value for money the proposal represents.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 1.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain how to identify client needs in relation to an event
 - 1.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to select on type of event and research and identify the different inclusions that make up the event, including various products and services
 - 1.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify what needs to be included in an event brief
 - 1.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify how to prepare and present an event proposal.
-

Summary

Develop event concept and proposal

Identify event objectives and scope

- Concept of events
- Benefits of events
- Types of events or functions
- Range of event facilities
- Receiving an enquiry
- Meeting with clients.

Establish event concept, theme, format and protocols

- Timing
- Type of event
- Size and type of room
- Numbers attending
- Catering
- Technical equipment
- Access
- Themes and decorations
- Security
- Media
- Use of external suppliers
- Style and format
- Room layout
- Using different set up options
- Identification of key stakeholders
- Event liaison and management structure
- Develop options and ideas in consultation with colleagues and suppliers to assist client with event planning.

Prepare event brief

- Content of an event brief.

Develop event proposal/bid details, where necessary

- The critical nature of quotations
- Provide overview of how you can meet/exceed client expectations
- Factors to take into account when developing a costing
- Observe promises made
- Verify with management
- Preparing for delivery of the proposal and quotation
- Presenting the proposal and quotation.

Element 2: Determine event venue/location

2.1 Identify potential event venues and sites

Introduction

One of the key considerations when preparing for an event is to ensure the right venue or location is chosen. This is normally the first consideration event organisers will have. They will want to ensure that the venue selected is suitable to what they need to achieve during the event.

Venue / location considerations

In many cases there are a number of considerations, some of which include:

- Location in relation to office, public transport or potential audience – it is normal to select a location that is close to where people are coming from. Normally the closer the better as it keeps travel time and inconvenience to a minimum. This is important where events include the service of alcohol
- Indoor / outdoor – whilst most conferences and meetings are conducted indoors, there are many events that prefer an outdoor location. This is especially true for team building activities and weddings
- Venue quality or brand – given that many events involve large expenses, many businesses will choose a venue that has a strong brand name, reputation and a 'superior' image
- Space – where events require large areas of space or need to accommodate large numbers of participants, such as an exhibition or wedding, large open rooms will be required
- Reputation – naturally most event organisers will select a location or organisation with a proven reputation for high service levels
- Aesthetic appeal – many weddings are selected due to the visual beauty of room or immediate surroundings
- Accommodation – some events draw participants from different locations and hence need accommodation rooms
- Venue facilities and services – most event organisers have a desire for an establishment which is modern and fresh. In addition many high tech meetings will require a venue with specific audio visual capability
- Cost – this is a key requirement as everyone seeks value for money and must also meet budget constraints.



Potential event locations

There are endless possible event locations which include:

- Hotels
- Resorts
- Restaurants
- Private homes
- Schools, universities and other educational providers
- Meetings rooms
- Banquet rooms
- Convention halls
- Exhibition centres
- Wedding reception centres
- Nature areas including open water, zoos, parks, wineries
- Transportation vehicles – including planes, yachts, cars, buses
- Festivals
- Sporting venues
- Government buildings and civic centres
- Museums.



Process of selecting suitable locations

Research into suitable venues and sites

This may include a comparison of internal and external venues. A key is to understand the purpose and key activities of the event. Some events may be cheaper to be conducted in-house as meeting rooms do not need to be hired, where as others may be cheaper if conducted in an external environment which is able to provide a wide selection of food and beverage, without needing to rent equipment and supplies etc.

Finalisation of client needs

By having a clear understanding of what the client requires from a venue or location, it makes it easier to choose a location to meet these needs.

Negotiation and liaison with site/venue owners or controllers

It is always a good idea to negotiate with different venues which you may be considering to hold an event.

Later in this manual the process of negotiation will be expanded upon. Whilst the section on negotiation focuses on how you can negotiate with a client, the elements that can be negotiated will also apply if you are the client or acting on behalf of a client.

2.2 Analyse alternative event venues and sites

Introduction

Once a list of possible locations or venues have been identified, it is time to analyse them to decide which one will be the most suited to meeting the needs of an upcoming event.

If you are responsible for selecting the event venue or location, it is important that you have done your research and are comfortable with your choice.

Collect information

One of the first things an event organiser can do to gain an understanding of what potential venues and locations are available is to conduct research.

There are a number of ways to do this including:

- Conduct internet research – this is the most effective way as not only can you get information at your finger tips, you can also gather large amounts of detailed information about each possible venue and may be able to take an on-line tour
- Phone different hotels or hospitality venues and speak with banqueting and conference departments. Ask questions about how they can cater to your needs and ask them to send out a Function Kit for you to review
- Speak with colleagues to identify whom they may have used in the past
- Read event specific journals that not only identify different providers but also may include reviews, special promotions or features about specific properties.

Review Function Kit

Many establishments have a 'Function Kit' to assist in providing advice to clients, and to demonstrate the venue's expertise and ability in relation to events and functions.

These kits are given to the client to take away with them so they have printed information in relation to items such as:

- Venue size, capacity and alternative seating arrangements
- Venue facilities, services and equipment, including a range of items that can be hired for specific functions
- Sample menus for various dining styles, and at a range of price points
- Sample drink lists featuring alcoholic and non-alcoholic drinks by the bottle and by the glass
- Suggested staffing levels for functions of various numbers, and of various styles and types.



Most kits incorporate colour photographs of room and table set ups, as well as 'during the function' shots depicting what the 'final product' will look like.

Some venues have also produced DVDs to help promote their function trade. These DVDs are loaned or given to prospective clients to watch in their own time.

Tour of the venue

It is standard practice to undertake a tour of venue to not only ensure you are able to get a visual understanding of what can be provided, but also that you can have any questions answered.

The tour should include a visit to all areas of the property that will be involved in the event. For example, if the event requires accommodation, then the rooms of the property should be included in the tour.

In some cases you may need to schedule a second meeting to enable your client to also experience this tour.



Meeting key staff

The tour of the venue may also include meeting key staff.

Staff may include Head Chef, Food and Beverage manager, Functions manager, owner and Head of Security as appropriate to the identified needs of the client for their function.

2.3 Select event venue/site

Introduction

Once you have had the chance to visit potential venues, spoken to key event coordinators and collected information it is time to compare each against each other and select the right venue.

Given that there are many specifications that must be catered for when selecting a venue, at times it may be hard to work out which venue will be the most preferable.

Development of specifications against which to assess options

One of the most effective ways to determine the best location is to identify a list of key requirements that must be met to ensure the successful running of an event and apply a weighting system to each of these requirements.

This helps to compare different locations or venues easily based on a numerical comparison.

Compulsory requirements

In some cases, some requirements are essential to whether the venue can be considered for selection or not. For example, if the event needs space to cater for seating for 150 people and the venue can only hold 50 people then this venue cannot be considered.

Key requirements

Once the compulsory requirements have been identified it is time to list all the key requirements that you consider important to your event. Naturally each person will have different requirements to suit their specific event and the weighting assigned to each requirement will be different based on individual preferences.

On the next page is an example of a suggested weighting system.

Whilst this method looks at the venue selection processes in a clinical and methodical manner, in many cases the event organiser or client will select a venue based on emotional attachment or 'gut feeling'. This is especially true when selecting wedding venues.

Event Requirements Weighting Sheet

Requirements	Weighting Scale	Hotel A	Hotel B	Hotel C	Hotel D
Compulsory Requirements					
Location - city	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Meeting rooms to hold 40 persons	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Accommodation for 40 persons	✓	✓	✓		✓
Key Requirements					
Cost	15	10	12	10	11
Aesthetic appeal	15	12	11	15	10
Venue quality or brand	10	7	8	7	8
Reputation	10	7	8	10	5
Experience	10	8	5	7	7
Venue facilities	10	5	8	9	4
Menu Selection	10	4	3	7	10
Meeting Packages	5	3	5	5	5
Equipment	5	5	4	4	5
Venue services	5	5	4	3	5
Assistance provided	5	5	5	5	5
TOTAL	100	71	73	82	75

As can be seen in this example, Hotel C has the highest rating, however is missing one of the compulsory requirements. Therefore the best venue for this event will be Hotel D.

Confirm booking

Once a venue is selected it must be confirmed with the chosen establishment. This process will be discussed in more detail in Section 2.4 of this manual.

2.4 Confirm arrangements for selected venue/site

Introduction

All functions and events require some form of negotiation with the client due to the individual nature of the occasions and the unique needs and preferences of the client.

When these negotiations have been concluded it is standard practice to prepare written information for the client detailing what the arrangements are.

This provides the client with an opportunity to verify the arrangements and to add or vary any issues they want to change.

This final confirmation also serves to provide a basis for an original quotation or to prepare a revised quotation based on the changed circumstances that have been agreed on.

The process of negotiating

Negotiating with clients can relate to:

Price

Price is nearly always an issue when negotiating functions. The client wants the best price and the venue needs to obtain its identified profit margin.

Most venues have set prices for products and services and there is traditionally little room to manoeuvre in terms of negotiating price.

You may be authorised to negotiate price where this is specifically identified in your 'scope of authority'. For example you may have permission to reduce prices by a nominated percentage (say, 5%) in order to secure a function.

Where you have no such scope of authority your options are limited to referring the negotiations to management or explaining to the client that your price is your 'best price'. In many cases price can often be seen as a 'take it or leave it' situation.

Where price is an issue the primary way of reducing it is to reduce what is to be offered.

This may include:

- Reducing courses at a meal – from three to two
- Substituting a less expensive wine for the wines already quoted on
- Substituting less expensive menu items into the meal options
- Not including liquor in the function – meaning guests have to pay for their own
- Limiting the time the function runs – which can reduce staffing costs
- Removing a previously identified activity from the function – such as the band or having a smaller band, entertainment, side tours and other inclusions.



Timing

This relates to price in that some functions may be able to be delivered at a price that suits the client if the hours or days for the function are reduced.

Timing negotiations can also include discussion and agreement about:

- Days the function is to be held – your venue may be able to offer a better deal at a time when business is traditionally slow
- Timing of guest arrival – staff costs can be reduced by shortening the amount of time between guest arrival and the start of the function
- Decisions regarding the timing of activities within the function itself – such as when meals are to be served, when different courses are to be served, when speeches are to take place, when morning and afternoon teas are to be served
- Access to the function area for client personnel
- Times/dates by which the event must be finished.

Goods and services to be provided

It may be possible to assist the client by curtailing expenses in terms of:

- Providing their own cake – even though the venue will still charge a fee per person for cutting, plating etc
- Providing cheaper dessert items
- Removing the 'pre-event' drinks
- Decreasing the amount, or changing the type of, decorations to be supplied
- Eliminating flowers
- Not including accommodation.



The Event Contract

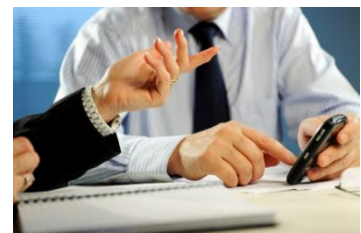
Once the function details have been verbally confirmed with the customer, standard practice requires a written agreement to be drawn up and signed by all parties involved.

This agreement is generally a pro forma document requiring you to simply complete various pieces of 'missing' information.

The function contract is generally sealed by the payment of a deposit to secure the booking.

When negotiations have concluded you must be in possession of the following information which may need to be included in your function contract:

- Full contact details of the client
- Type of function – such as wedding, product launch, or business seminar, including service style (buffet, seated, finger-food), seating arrangements for meals, seminars, group sessions etc) This indicates how the tables, chairs, stages, head tables and other items of equipment will be laid out
- Dates and times of the function



- Date for notification of final numbers
- Location of the function, name of rooms and facilities to be used
- Approximate numbers attending
- Décor, displays, table decorations etc
- Food to be served – including when, type, amount
- Beverages to be served – as above
- Entertainment, activities and inclusions
- Ancillary sales – such as accommodation by type, number and dates, tours, in-house services, provision of a Master of Ceremonies (MC) or host, photographers
- Services and facilities the venue has agreed to provide at no charge – such as table for presents, change room for the Bride and Groom, use of pool and gymnasium facilities
- Technology required to support the function – data projectors, stage, sound and lighting requirements, DVD players etc
- Access required by the client prior to the function
- Products and services the client will be supplying
- Involvement of third party suppliers
- Total cost of function – broken down into all the component areas, not just the traditional food and beverage elements. The more items you can point to in this section, the better value-for-money the function will appear to the client
- Deposit amount – the amount you are asking for as a deposit and how that figure was calculated, and when it is payable
- Preferred method and date for final payment – where an account for final payment is to be forwarded, this section will also include confirmation of who is to get the account and the address where the account is to be sent. Payment by cheque may be acceptable in some instances otherwise cash or more commonly credit card is preferred. Where the venue knows the client and is assured of their credit rating they may be prepared to send an account - payment is normally required within a relatively short timeframe (7 – 14 days) as opposed to 30 days plus
- Refund policy – explaining the conditions under which the venue is prepared to offer a refund of a deposit, how much the deposit will be
- Payment for extra persons – as previously mentioned a figure should be stated indicating how much the venue will charge if there are additional people attending the function.



Booking conditions

All venues will have specific booking conditions. These will usually appear on the website and form part of the standard function contract.

The conditions will be very specific in what they require of the client but often these are 'diluted' somewhat to accommodate individual client need and to ensure the venue secures the function rather than lose it simply because they refused to be flexible in meeting client needs or because they were pig headed about insisting every aspect of every booking condition be fulfilled.

Booking conditions may include reference to:

- How long the client has to sign the function contract (7 days is common) – including mention the venue may sell the dates and times of the function to another party until the contract is signed and a deposit paid
- Need for the client to provide information by a set date that has not yet been provided but which is essential to the planning and preparation for the event
- Need for the client to advise the venue within a set time (48 hours) of any inaccuracies contained in the contract, running sheet, etc
- Ability of the client to make changes (up or down) to expected numbers to a given percentage (say 10%) up to 7 days before the function.

Where a decrease in numbers is notified according to this timeframe the conditions may indicate no penalty applies providing agreed 'minimum numbers' are attained.

Where an increase in numbers is notified a maximum number of extra people may be indicated and there may be mention of the need to move to different rooms which may necessitate a higher room charge fee

- Payment – this can stipulate how payment is made, dates for payment and how payment can be made.

The conditions may state that where the client requires a credit account with the venue this must be formally applied for, and that all accounts are required to be paid on 'net 30 days' terms.

This section also explains that where the venue produces an incorrect account (that is, one that is less than what it should be or one that omits a charge that should have been made) the venue retains the right to issue a supplementary account to recover these costs

- Cancellation policy – this applies where the total function has to be cancelled and sets out the percentage refund the client would be entitled where a deposit has been made and the timing issues that apply (for example, X% refund if cancellation occurs before XX/XX/XX but a lesser percentage if the cancellation is received after that date).

Some venues may base their refund/cancellation statements on 'profit' – such as the venue will retain X%(say, 30%) of the quoted cost for food and beverage regarded as being the lost gross profit for the function.



Some venues may be prepared to refund the majority of the monies paid (say 90%) where they can re-sell the dates/rooms that have been cancelled

- Right of the venue to make changes – this gives the venue the right ‘under extenuating circumstances’ to alter any agreed part of the agreement provided they supply suitable alternative arrangements
- ‘Force majeure’ – most contracts will contain a condition stating that in the event of ‘force majeure’ instances which includes things such as riots, war, terrorism, natural disasters, fire the venue will not be held liable
- Right of the venue to refuse certain activities or individuals – while Equal Opportunity legislation must be observed the venue will nearly always retain the right to prohibit certain people or activities on their premises.



Naturally this area is a sensitive one but the venue will often seek to protect its reputation, not to mention protect its physical assets and staff, other customers, by banning nominated activities. This means the venue will have, for example, the right to refuse to have a certain band play at the venue if it believes that band to be ‘inappropriate’.

There is usually also some statement reminding the client that the venue has the right and legal obligation to remove anyone from the premises whose presence on the premises renders the venue liable to an offence under law

- Conditions that apply to decorating and using the venue – this will indicate the actions that the client can and cannot take when they are involved in preparing for the function. Common inclusions here are that the client cannot stock anything to walls, cannot nail anything in place, must ensure all items used are safe
- Loss and damage – stipulating the client must accept responsibility for any loss or damage they cause to the venue
- Check-in and check-out times for accommodation rooms that are being included as part of the function – this will also extend to bump-in, bump-out times.

Requesting the deposit

It is standard industry practice to request a deposit when the final details of a function have been confirmed.

Every venue has its own policy on the amount of deposit required to secure a function and this must be strictly adhered to. Due to the nature of the work, preparation and need to order stock such as food and beverages for a function, the deposit required is commonly substantial.

No function is confirmed until a deposit has been paid.

You may have blocked the required areas for an anticipated function, but it remains 'tentative' until a deposit has been secured and a contract signed.

In practical terms, this means a tentative function may be bumped where another client is prepared to pay a deposit and sign a contract for the same days.

Confirmation – and certainly the contract – may be in writing but, again, it is best to communicate this confirmation at a face-to-face meeting where ambiguities can be cleared up, explanations given and final changes made.

The face-to-face meeting allows you to pick up on any non-verbal cues that may indicate hesitance, reluctance or disagreement on the part of the client and address them as appropriate.

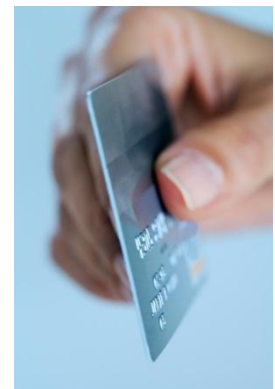
A personal meeting also sends the message you are taking this function seriously, and that it matters to you and the venue.

Whilst getting the details finalised are obviously important, it is equally important that you remain flexible about certain aspects of the function.

Naturally the date and time are fixed, and to an extent the numbers must likewise be guaranteed - a minimum number is usually required to be paid for, and numbers above a set figure are required to be paid for at \$X per head.

Dates for notifying final numbers are also immovable when they have been agreed to.

However, many other aspects of a function cannot be set in concrete, and by their nature must be 'set in jelly'.



Steps associated with handling deposits

Each organisation will be different in terms of the policies and procedures to be followed when handling deposit requests. That said, common steps to follow include:

- Requesting deposit payment – this can be based on a standard establishment requirement such as percentage of estimated or quoted final cost
- Setting date for payment of deposit – this is important as it helps to determine the seriousness of the potential client and in addition allows a conference department to release a function room with adequate time to rebook it
- Advising of payment options – many hospitality organisations will have established payment options including:
 - Charge back to company – this normally requires a credit check to be conducted and also some guaranteeing method of payment to be recorded
 - EFT – this is common form of payment enabling money to be transferred electronically from the client's bank account into that of the hotel.
 - Cash – not a common method but certainly an acceptable option
 - Debit and credit cards – these may be processed, either as a pre-payment or a pre-authorisation. This can be conducted face to face when the client is at the establishment or done via email using appropriate procedures
- Issuing receipt for deposit – this normally accompanies the confirmation
- Recording payment of deposit on internal documentation – normally the functions department will obtain a record of the payment, either through the financial department or via front office, if the payment was made face to face.

It is essential that regardless of where and how the payment was received, that it is recorded on file, normally through the establishment of a house account dedicated to the function.

In addition, it is essential that the functions department is aware of when it is made, so that they can issue a receipt in a timely manner and to ensure they aren't following up a payment which already has been made



- Advising customer of amount outstanding – if there is any amount outstanding from the agreed deposit amount or for payments required for external suppliers, this must be followed up according to organisational policy.

Updated financial information

When the client pays a deposit for a function an account is usually opened for them at this stage.

- It is vital the first entry on this account shows their deposit and places their account in credit
- Make sure you check the details of any account that is prepared, verifying correct figures, names, addresses
- It may be company policy to mail the client a copy of this, or a receipt or both for monies received. A copy of all paperwork relating to payments received must also be placed in the function file so that anyone looking at the file knows immediately what the financial status of the file is
- As further payments are made by the client these too must be entered onto the account and up-dated in the function file. For example 'progress payments' may have been negotiated for large functions, where there is a relatively long lead-time and large expenses have been accumulated
- It is important the function file contains these details relating to account status as often the venue representative and the client will meet at times when the accounts department is closed and this information cannot be obtained, if needed
- Similarly, expenses are posted as appropriate reflecting purchases that have been made in relation to the function. These figures are essential for post-function administration and analysis.



Preparing confirmations

A standard pro forma confirmation is sent to the client when they have signed the function contract and paid a deposit.

This confirmation acknowledges the contract has been signed and that money has been paid and received.

In addition a copy of Function Sheet is also sent which gives brief details about the basics of the function including type, dates, times, numbers, brief menu. This is explained in more detail in the next section.

Confirmations serve to give the client confidence the function has been secured and will go ahead.

Confirmations may also be sent by the venue to suppliers and third party providers once the function has been confirmed, advising what the venue requires them to provide for the function and letting them know it is going ahead.

Confirmation to the client should be in hard copy form whilst confirmation to suppliers can be email, fax or phone.

It is also important to ensure that the function is written as confirmed in the Functions Booking book.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 2.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify a range of potential venue sites and locations that can be used for an event
 - 2.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain what needs to be analysed when trying to determine the most suitable venue site or location
 - 2.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain how you would select a site or venue
 - 2.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify what needs to take place to confirm a venue or site for an event.
-

Summary

Determine event venue/location

Identify potential event venues and sites

- Venue / location considerations
- Potential event locations
- Process of selecting suitable locations.

Analyse alternative event venues and sites

- Collect information
- Review Function Kit
- Tour of the venue
- Meeting key staff.

Select event venue/site

- Development of specifications against which to assess options
- Confirm booking.

Confirm arrangements for selected venue/site

- The process of negotiating
- The Event Contract
- Booking conditions
- Requesting a deposit
- Steps associated with handling deposits
- Updated financial information
- Preparing confirmations.

Element 3: Plan and deliver event catering

3.1 Identify and analyse event factors which may impact on catering

Introduction

Catering refers to the provision of food and beverages for an event. Most events will have some element of food or beverage to them, either as the key component, as in the case of celebratory dinners and weddings, or may be a secondary part such as a working lunch during a conference.

Regardless of the role food and beverage plays in an event, it still must be arranged in a professional manner with all factors taken into consideration.



Types of event factors that impact on catering

The types and styles of food and beverage menus will vary greatly depending on:

- Available budget
- Dates and time of function
- Numbers of participants
- Speed of service required due to timing demands on activities within an event
- Types of food required
- Service styles required
- Cuisines preferred
- Location of event
- Seasonal influences
- Nature of event
- Production and transport issues
- General logistics
- Staffing
- Pre- and post-function activities.



Menu considerations

Most organisations will have a varied selection of different menu options taking into consideration:

- Styles of functions – whether food and beverage is a main aspect of the function (such as a banquet) or to supplement a function (such as a coffee break during a meeting)
- Styles of service required –including plated service, silver service, semi-plated service, stand-up finger food, buffet, a la carte, table d'hôte or set menu options
- Timing of functions – depending on the time available for the consumption of food and beverage, some options may be more appropriate than others
- Providing a variety of price points – this is important so that the client can choose a specific price point and quality of food and beverage offering to meet their needs and budgets
- Having inclusive and non-inclusive menus – depending on the participants some clients may wish to have a one price option which covers everything or is happy to pay for each item consumed. These options will be discussed in more details later in this section.



Types of food and beverage menus

The types and styles of food and beverage menus will vary greatly depending on the size and style of the venue, available budget, client preferences, nature of the function and various timing factors such as time of day, day of the week, time of the year, pre and post unction activities.

It is important to price all menus shown to guests with flexibility. That is, with a range of pricing options designed to meet the needs of a diversity of potential clients.

Options in relation to pricing include substitution of dishes, elimination or addition of courses, incorporation of beverages with meals, and service style options (silver service compared with table service).



The following are some typical examples of the types of menus used for function service and demonstrate the options that are available within what may seem fairly basic meal times.

Breakfast menu

- Continental
- Continental plus selected cooked food items
- Continental plus full cooked food items
- Food platters – fruit and bakery items, intended as finger food
- Beverage items – coffee, tea, juices
- Buffet breakfast for large numbers
- Full breakfast – cereal, juices, cooked main items, toast, tea and coffee: served to seated guests.

Morning/afternoon teas

- Selection of pastries and bakery items
- Selection of open or closed sandwiches
- Selection of biscuits and cake
- Selection of petit fours
- Beverage items – coffee, tea, juice, water, aerated waters.



Lunch menu

- Buffet of selected hot and cold items – may include an entrée, main course and dessert, or any combination
- Set menu (to a specific number of courses) – can be served to seated guests or presented for buffet style service
- Platters of sandwiches, filled rolls – sandwiches and rolls may be open or closed
- Platters of cakes, biscuits, pastries and petit fours
- Platters of fruit, fruit and cheese, cheese and greens
- Beverages – selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages which may include full bar, selected and minimal liquor, or non-alcoholic beverages only comprising aerated waters, waters, fruit juices, mocktails.



Dinner

Dinners are traditionally 'heavier' meals than lunches. This is because guests are not going to be doing anything after dinner, whereas with lunch there may be a need for guests to pay attention and not nod off to sleep!

One common difference is that platter service is not usual at dinners. However there is a section of the market emerging that seems to prefer finger food dinners. This may be driven by economic imperatives.

- Set menu (to a specific number of courses) – can be served to seated guests or presented for buffet style service. Dinners are more commonly a seated affair where lunches tend to be buffet style
- Buffet of selected hot and cold items – may include an entrée, main course and dessert, or any combination. More time is traditionally available for dinners whereas with lunches there tends to be a tighter time frame as people need to return to meetings, groups or activities by a given time
- Beverages – there may be a selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages. There may be a set number of specific wines set on each table – above that, guests may be required to pay for what they want, or there may be a full bar facility.



Seminar/conference

- Usually a selection of light refreshments - small sandwiches and rolls etc compared to substantial menu items - the idea being not to send the people off to sleep. There is a definite need to include healthy options such as fruit
- Commonly these meals are buffet style or finger food style to keep costs down, and to facilitate the concept of people networking at the function
- Morning and afternoon teas are common – with pastries, cakes and biscuits rotating throughout the time of the conference
- Beverages – alcohol is less common, but not unknown; non-alcoholic beverages include tea and coffee, and water
- Tea, coffee, water and pastries may be served to guests on arrival in the morning while people are arriving, registering and mingling.



Wedding

- Commonly a set menu specifying the number of courses to be served, and the style to be used
- Can also feature a buffet of hot and cold food items
- Beverages may be a nominated selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages, full bar, or guests pay as they go.



Cocktail parties

- Platters of hors d'oeuvre and canapés can be presented in a buffer style, or served by waiting staff
- Beverages are usually a nominated selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages up to a set dollar figure, or for a given time period.

Promotions and product launches

- Generally features a selection of light refreshments – small sandwiches, rolls, canapés, and other finger food
- There may be a special room to cater for media attendees – reporters, photographers, sound recordists
- Beverages may be dictated by the nature of the promotion or product being launched, but it is common for a nominated selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages for the entire duration of the function.

Client providing own items

It is not uncommon for the customer to bring some of their own items to suit the requirements of the occasion. For birthdays and weddings it is normal for the customer to bring their own:

- Cakes
- Speciality wines
- Decorations.

Styles of service

Plated service

Plated service is the most common service style where the kitchen plates all the food and the waiting staff carry the plated food to the table.

This is a common style of service for most banquets.

The benefits of plated service are:

- Consistency of meals
- Fast service - as meals are plated in the kitchen and then delivered quickly to the customer
- Portion control – chefs have control over portion sizes.



Silver service

Silver service is where food items are prepared and carved or separated into individual portions and placed on platters by kitchen staff. Then waiting staff use spoon and fork to serve food from service platters, and serve sauces to guests on an individual basis from a sauce boat.

This style of service is not common in many functions due to its labour and time intensive nature, but is commonly used when serving bread rolls to the customers.

The benefits of silver service are:

- Adds a dimension of 'entertainment and sophistication
- Customers can choose what they like without leaving the table.

Semi silver service

Semi-silver service is where the meals are plated and the sauces are 'silver served' or where the meat component of the dish is plated and served, and the vegetables are silver served.

The benefits of semi silver service are:

- Increases options for customer
- A more time efficient use of silver service.



Gueridon service

This is where food is prepared or cooked at the table and served using full silver service techniques. This service style is not common for large banquets and in fact is only suited to intimate situations, whether catering to high end clients or for special occasions such as romantic meals.

The benefits of gueridon service are:

- Is a form of entertainment
- Is interactive
- Allows customers to see the cooking process
- Meals can be prepared to customer's exact specifications.

Buffet service

This is where food is prepared in kitchens in large quantities and then placed on a buffet or display table. In most buffet situations guests serve themselves and select the items and quantities they desire.

In some situations a staffed buffet may be offered. In this scenario, diners bring their own plate along the buffet line and are given a portion from a server at each station. This method is prevalent at catered meetings where diners are not paying specifically for their meal in an effort to reduce wastage and to have some form of portion control.

The focus of staff in this situation is to:

- Replenish food items
- Keep buffet areas clean
- Provide crockery and cutlery
- Clear the tables.

The benefits of buffet service are:

- Customers have greater choice
- They can have small amounts of different items as opposed to having one type of food
- Service is very time efficient
- Labour demands are reduced
- Food can be prepared in advance.



Cocktail service

This style of service is very popular, either as a prelude to a dinner or as a standalone function in its own right. In essence this style of service involves waiters providing a range of finger foods and beverage to customers in a stand up function.

The benefits of cocktail service are:

- It has great flexibility in terms of both cost and item options
- It is a cost effective method for clients to provide food and beverage to their participants
- It can be performed within a limited time frame
- It requires only a small space
- Participants can mingle with each other easily.

Types of packages

As can be seen above there are many different types of menus options that are available to customers.

To keep it simple, functions present three common package options

Inclusive packages

- This is where an all-up price quoted to the host for the function and the price includes nominated food and beverages. The host pays this agreed amount regardless of whether the full amount of guests attends or not, and regardless of how much of the agreed food and beverages are consumed. Any extras are paid for 'on consumption'
- It includes a set, negotiated range of drinks but does not stipulate quantities. Guests may drink as much as they like from (for example) bulk beer, house wines, soft drink and nominated pour brands of spirits. For anything apart from this, individuals pay for their own. This commonly refers to premium or more expensive brands.



Open bar

An open bar is where the guests at the function can order drinks without paying for them. The client settles the account at the end.

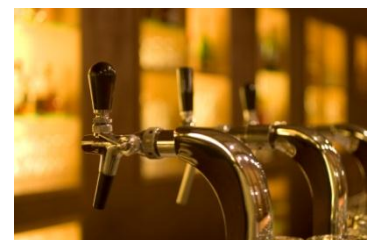
Open bars may be 'full bar' meaning there is no restriction at all as to what guests can order. They can order wine, spirits, beer, mixed drinks, any type, any brand. If the bar has the beverage, the guest can have it.

Open bars can also be 'restricted' meaning the drinks served to guests may be restricted to only draught beer, house wines and soft drink. If the guests want something other than these drinks they have to pay for it themselves.

Many hosts set a limit on the amount of money they are prepared to spend on an 'open bar'.

For example, the client may state they want a full open bar up to a limit of \$2,000.

Where this is the case it is standard practice to inform the client on the day of the function regarding the progress of this amount. In the case of the \$2,000 limit you might inform the client when \$1,000 has been reached, when \$1,500 has been reached, when \$1,750 has been reached.



Doing this allows the client to monitor consumption and provides them with an opportunity to authorise extra money to be allocated to the original \$2,000.

On-consumption basis

- Only what is consumed is charged for.
- Client usually sets a limit above which guests pay for their own, however they sometimes extend the limit at the function. Below this limit it may be a case of:
 - Anything goes – guests can order bottles of wine, cocktails, premium spirits
 - Guests select only from a limited range of bulk beer, house wines, soft drink and nominated pour brands of spirits
 - A 'dry till' is run – that is, amounts are rung up on a cash register as drinks are served but no money changes hands.



Cash basis

This is a growing option as this style of service reduces the expense incurred by the host.

Cash bars are common. Guests pay for all their own drinks either obtaining them at the bar or via waiter service.

Tailoring menus to client needs

Regardless of the menu option selected by the client, it is important that a functions operation is flexible in ensuring what can be provided meets their specifications.

This is important especially in relation to any dietary or cultural requirements in which they may have.

3.2 Prepare event catering proposal

Introduction

Quite often a quotation will also be prepared and used as a Running Sheet for the benefit of event organisers, staff from different departments, suppliers and the client themselves.

In many cases, a potential client will give an event organiser some basic information relating to an event and then rely on the organiser to provide detailed options that are available.

Example of event procedure / timeline

In elements 2 and 3 of this manual a number of steps related to arranging a function have been detailed.

Following is a summary of steps that event organisers are suggested in relation to preparing a proposal.

Take Initial Enquiry

- Ensure you receive all the relevant information to make your quote as individual as possible
- Ask leading questions such as “Tell me more about...?” Leading questions enable the customer to define his/her objectives and gives us a better feel of the type of function they are looking for
- If possible ask guests to email all details.



Use Checklists

In an event that involves a large variety of services including food and beverage, a checklist may be determined to help identify and clarify key requirements. Two of these events as weddings and conferences.

Following are examples of wedding and conference checklists that may be discussed and used by both an event organiser and the client themselves in their planning and organisation.

Wedding Checklist

Wedding Checklist	
Date of Wedding	_____
Name of Wedding couple	_____
Location	_____
Number of guests	_____ (excluding bridal table)
Number on Bridal table	_____
TIMES:	
Ceremony	_____ Where _____
Reception	_____
Guests seated	_____
Entrée	_____
Main Course	_____
Dessert	_____
End Bev Package	_____
End Wedding	_____
MENU:	
Hors d' ouvres	_____
Entrée	_____

Main Course	_____

Dessert	_____

Tea, Coffee & petit fours	
Dietary Requirements	

BEVERAGE REQUIREMENTS:

Bev Package _____

Other _____

MUSIC:

Disc Jockey _____

Own _____

FLOWERS:

Colours _____

CANDELABRAS:

_____ Amount _____

CHAIR COVERS/RIBBON:

Colours _____

CAKE:

Type _____

Delivered _____

CAKE BAG:

Own _____ Delivered _____

Purchase _____ Amount _____

PLACE CARDS:

Own _____ Delivered _____

Purchase _____ Amount _____

REGISTRY BOOK:

Yes _____ Delivered _____

No _____

MASTER OF CEREMONIES:

Who _____

Phone _____

FLOOR PLAN:

Delivered _____

Ensure guest supplies names & numbers per table

Sketch of room & bridal table names & places

MENU TASTING:

Who (2 max) _____

When _____

Booked _____

BRIDAL DRINKS:

Foyer _____

Separate room _____ Location _____

BRIDAL SUITE

Booked _____

Privacy _____

R/S Breakfast time _____

Menu _____

Hot Meals _____

Juices _____ T/C _____

OFFICE DETAILS

Candelabras _____

Flowers _____

Ivy _____

Skirting _____

Music _____

Glassware _____

Silk _____

Suite _____

Dance Floor _____

Conference Checklist

Initial Questions

- What are your main objectives for the conference? (What needs to be achieved by the end of the conference?)
- Location (capital city, country retreat etc)
- Preferred dates - alternative dates (consider: holidays, sporting events etc)
- Number of delegates (Are spouses and/or family included?)

Conference Facilities

- Room size
- Room configuration (theatre, u-shape, boardroom, classroom etc)
- Syndicate area requirements
- Audio visual equipment requirements
- Additional equipment (displays, registration and head table for speakers)
- Duration and schedule of conference.

Catering

- Daily requirements including:
 - Breakfast or arrival coffee and tea
 - Working lunches
 - Dinner and/or supper
 - Morning and afternoon breaks
 - Post conference drinks and canapés
- Special dietary requirements such as
 - Vegetarian
 - Religious
 - Low fat
 - Low salt
- Specialty menus (themes, welcome cocktails, awards night)
- Entertainment

Accommodation

- Number of rooms required
- Type of accommodation required (single, twin, double or suites)
- Duration of stay (including delegates arriving early and those remaining after conference)
- Check in/check out times
- Charging details and method of payment.

Miscellaneous

Organising a conference involves a myriad of small details to make it truly successful.

- Car parking facilities
- Photographer for groups shots
- Team building and recreations activities
- Post conference activities
- Additional tourism information for interstate and overseas delegates
- Welcome letters for in-house guests
- Special gifts to be given to guest speakers, VIP's, delegates etc.

Prepare and send proposal

Inclusions in a catering proposal

In summary an event catering proposal should include:

- Details of all catering proposed – including menus, drinks, timing, service times
- Costs
- Options available within designated budget parameters
- Overview of production, transportation and service of food and beverages
- Staff numbers
- Reference to previous events that have been catered for on the same/similar scale.

In many cases a proposal will include a summary of information on the first page and then a detailed list of options that are available including costs.

On the following pages is an example of a proposal that provides information that can be used for most events within a hotel.



EVENT PROPOSAL

DATE:	FROM:
TO:	TEL:
TEL:	FAX:
FAX:	RE: Event Proposal
	PAGES: (incl. cover)

Hi,

Following is a proposal for your event as requested. Please call for further assistance.

EVENT(S):

DATE(S):

TIMES:

GUESTS: (to be confirmed)

LOCATION:

ROOM HIRE:

ROOM STYLE:

CATERING: Please refer to menus attached and advise us of your selection.

EQUIPMENT: Please refer to list attached and advise equipment requirements.

PARKING: Complimentary underground security parking is provided, subject to availability.

ACCOMM: We are pleased to offer any of your delegates who may require accommodation our conference rate of \$160.00 + tax, per single occupancy room.

PAYMENT: Please advise us of your preferred method of payment; should you wish to be invoiced, please call and we will send you a credit application; otherwise, credit card details are requested for full payment.

CONFIRMING: Please email confirmation, with details regarding catering, equipment and timing for catering if possible.

Have a great day

ROOM SPECIFICATIONS

Each of our banquet rooms has been designed and tastefully decorated to suit the requirements of every function.

'A' Room is appropriate for meetings, training seminars, intimate wedding receptions and other smaller luncheons and dinners. This room can be separated to cater for smaller functions or combined to accommodate up to 120 theatre style.

'B and C' Rooms(combined) is ideal for larger conferences, video conferencing and cocktail parties. This room can accommodate up to 120 people for a formal dinner or 250 guests for a cocktail party or theatre style convention.

The Executive Boardroom caters especially for the business executive. It includes a custom designed boardroom table, built in television monitor and VHS recorder. With breath-taking views, the Executive Boardroom is also perfect for small dinners, product displays or that special cocktail party.

Private meeting rooms and executive suites with lake, ocean or park views are also available.

FUNCTION ROOM	AREA (m ²)	COCKTAIL	THEATRE	BANQUET	CLASSROOM	U-SHAPE
A	171	250	230	120	100	50
B&C	190	150	120	70	60	36
B	112	80	70	50	30	25
C	78	40	50	30	20	20
Executive Boardroom	42	40	30	24	Boardroom 24	-
Parkview Suite	34	30	20	12	Boardroom 12	-

All conference rooms come with an overhead projector and screen, flipchart and whiteboard as well as many items on request such as Blu-Tac, scissors, marker pens and other last minute essentials.

Room Hire Charges

'A'	\$700.00
'B'	\$400.00
'C'	\$350.00
'B&C'	\$550.00
Executive Boardroom	\$400.00
Parkview Boardroom	\$350.00

ACCOMMODATION

Hotel A has 170 deluxe rooms with extensive harbour and parkland views. One and two bedroom suites with kitchen facilities are also available.

Our special conference delegate rate:

Rates

Deluxe Single Room	\$160.00 per night
Deluxe Twin Share	\$170.00 per night
Residential Package	\$254.00 per night

Room Facilities

Individually controlled air conditioning and heating	CNN News
Bath and shower	International direct dial telephones
Hair drier	Tea and coffee making facilities
Mini bar and refrigerator	Desk or bureau
Iron and ironing board	Remote control colour television
24 hour room service	Laundry/valet service
In-house movies	In-room account and message review

Business Facilities and Complimentary Services

24 hour reception	Secretarial services
Express check out	Photocopying, printing and faxing
Daily newspapers	Complimentary passes to the local gym
Frequent Flyer points	Courtesy shuttle bus service to local business area

Car Parking

Complimentary undercover car parking is available for all residential conference delegates.

EQUIPMENT

Hotel A prides itself in providing the latest technology and high quality equipment to enable you to conduct your conferences with professionalism and flare.

Equipment Available

Equipment	Cost of hire per day
Whiteboard with pen set and duster (Additional \$25.00)	Complimentary
Flipchart with pen set and paper (Additional \$25.00)	Complimentary
Overhead projector and screen (Additional \$40.00)	Complimentary
Portable CD player	Complimentary
Sound system including lectern, microphone, amplifier and speakers	Complimentary
Electronic whiteboard - 2 screen	\$130.00
Slide projector and screen	\$60.00
Video and monitor	\$60.00
Lapel microphone	\$50.00

Additional audio visual aids can be arranged with our Banquet Department prior to the commencement of your conference.

Complimentary Conference Aids

- Iced water and mints on conference tables
- A4 note pads and pens
- Conference Concierge - dedicated to providing specialised attention to all your conference needs.

Video Conferencing

Hotel A offers ISDN Video Conferencing. This state of the art technology provides a faster, more cost effective way of communicating with people across the country and the world. It can be used for conferences, board meetings, training seminars, remote expert consultation, presentations and product launches. For further information, please contact our Banquet Department.

CONFERENCE PACKAGES

Allow us to take the stress out of your conference planning. Everything you need for a full day conference is included, plus those little extras which highlight your days of conferencing!

- One set price
- Concentrate on the conference not the catering
- No hidden costs
- Allows you to be flexible and us to be innovative!

Day Conference Package

\$49.00 per person (minimum 20 people)

Includes:

- Room hire
- Brewed coffee, tea and mini muffins on arrival
- Morning coffee, tea and home baked cookies
- Afternoon coffee, tea and chocolate brownies
- Working lunch
- Overhead projector, whiteboard and flipchart.

DAY CONFERENCE MENUS

Working Style Lunch

\$21.50 per person or inclusive in the Day Conference package

MENU ONE

A selection of Mediterranean filled pide rolls
Roast pumpkin, baby spinach & pine nut salad
Fresh fruit and cheese platter
Coffee, tea and orange juice

MENU TWO

Selection of Laviash Rolls
Potato Salad
Fruit Platter
Coffee, tea and orange juice

MENU THREE

Selection of Italian pizzettas
Caesar salad
Fruit Platter
Orange juice, Tea and Coffee

MENU FOUR

Selection of gourmet sandwiches
Greek Salad
Fruit and Cheese platter
Orange juice, Tea and Coffee

MENU FIVE

Mediterranean buffet served in Restaurant.

A full selection of dishes that have made the countries of the Mediterranean famous, including grilled chorizo, marinated calamari, artichokes, tzatziki, cous cous and more.

All menus come with coffee, tea and orange juice.
Please note 1/3 of each of these menus is vegetarian.

Ask our Banquet Department about our Residential Package.

BREAKFAST MENUS

Breakfast is the most important meal of the day. Get your conference off to a flying start with a healthy and nutritious breakfast.

Continental

Chilled fruit juices
Fresh fruit platter
Assorted pastries, croissants and muffins
Selection of jams and preserves
Brewed coffee and tea

\$14.50 per person

Health Plate

Chilled fruit and vegetable juices
Selection of yoghurts and fresh fruits
Muesli Bar - make your own muesli
Scrambled eggs with mushrooms
Grilled tomatoes on the side
Wholemeal toast and muffins
Brewed coffee, decaffeinated coffee and tea selection

\$16.00 per person

Country Buffet

Chilled fruit juices
Assorted pastries
Fresh fruits and compotes
Cereal and muesli bar
Scrambled eggs
Bacon slices and sausages from the griddle
Mushrooms, tomatoes and hash browns
Toast selection
Jams and preserves
Brewed coffee and tea

\$19.00 per person

Big Breakfast Buffet

Champagne and orange juice
Chilled fruit juices
Assorted pastries and croissants
Fresh fruits and compotes
Assorted cereal and muesli bar
Flapjacks with maple syrup and whipped butter
Scrambled eggs with smoked salmon, sour cream and chives
Thick slices of leg ham, smoked bacon and sausages
Mushrooms, tomatoes and hash browns
Muffins and toast selection
Selection of jams and preserves
Brewed coffee and tea

\$24.50 per person

COFFEE BREAKS

Make your morning or afternoon break something special with the following temptations!

Coffee and tea with shortbreads and cookies	\$4.00
Milkshakes and smoothies with cinnamon doughnuts	\$5.50
Devonshire tea with scones, jam and cream	\$5.00
Coffee and tea with banana cake and carrot slice	\$6.50
Coffee and tea with individual chocolate and mocha éclairs	\$6.50
Coca Cola with assorted chocolate bars	\$6.00
Coffee, tea and homemade mini muffins	\$4.50
All day continuous coffee and tea	\$8.00
Themed Coca Cola Conference Break	\$6.50

BREAK WITH A DIFFERENCE

We take pride in providing something a little out of the ordinary to surprise and impress your delegates.

For a break with a twist, try these suggestions:

Revitaliser

An abundance of fresh whole fruit

Freshly chilled juices

A healthy mix of dried fruits and nuts

Full and low fat yoghurts on ice

\$6.50 per person

Energiser

To put that extra zing into your conference break

A selection of health and energy bars

Freshly made fruit smoothies

\$6.50 per person

Chocoliser

A little indulgence to keep the team going

Copious amounts of chocolate treats

Smooth chocolate malt milkshakes

\$6.50 per person

Ask us about even more ideas to brighten up those inevitable but sneaky moments of information overload.

BANQUET MENUS

Whether you require a luncheon, a supper for six or a formal dinner for sixty, our Executive Chef and his team will make your function an occasion to remember.

Naturally, we are only too happy to cater for guests with special dietary needs. Please inform our Banquet Department when you make your booking for any special requests.

We can also design a menu to suit your taste and budget.

Menu One

Caesar salad
Charred breast of chicken with baked polenta
and grilled vegetables with a balsamic vinegar jus
Apple and cinnamon pudding with King Island double cream
Coffee and tea

\$30.00 per person

Menu Two

Baked tomato tart with parmesan and vine-ripened tomato
Herb crusted rack of lamb served with Dauphinoise potato
and a minted red wine demi glace
Sticky toffee pudding with butterscotch sauce
Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$30.00 per person

Menu Three

Sugar cured salmon with a mustard dill sauce and lavoche
Oven roasted loin of veal with a Pommery mustard crust
served on wild mushrooms and potato
Pear and almond tart with crème Anglaise
Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$35.00 per person

Menu Four

Oriental chicken salad with a soya mirin vinaigrette on Asian greens
Individual fillet mignon served on roesti potato
with a green peppercorn sauce and caramelised onion
Chocolate mud cake with vanilla bean ice cream
Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$37.00 per person

BUFFET MENUS

Selection One

Your choice of one of the following:

- Boned chicken wings with stir fried vegetables
- Sautéed beef with capsicum and onions
- Braised veal with garden fresh vegetables in a creamy sauce
- Sautéed chicken with mushrooms and bacon in a red wine sauce
- The choicest of Australian seafood in a spicy casserole.

Plus An array of cold meats and small goods

- Salad bar and a selection of dressings
- Seasonal fruit platter and dessert selection
- Assorted local and imported cheeses with crackers
- Bread selection
- Coffee and tea.

\$30.00 per person

Selection Two

Your choice of two of the following:

- Boned chicken wings with stir fried vegetables
- Sautéed beef with capsicum and onions
- Braised veal with garden fresh vegetables in a creamy sauce
- Sautéed chicken with mushrooms and bacon in a red wine sauce
- The choicest of seafood in a spicy casserole.

Plus Chef's carvery: Your choice of one of the following:

- Roast loin of pork with peach and cashew stuffing
- Leg of veal with pistachio stuffing

Plus An array of cold meats, terrines and smallgoods with pickles and chutneys

- Soup kettle with crusty bread
- Creamed potatoes and buttered vegetables
- Salad bar and a selection of dressings
- Seasonal fruit platter and dessert selection
- Assorted local and imported cheeses with crackers
- Bread selection
- Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$36.00 per person

BEVERAGE PACKAGES

Whether it's a quiet drink after a hectic day in conference or a cocktail party for 200, Hotel A has a variety of beverage options to suit all your requirements.

Liquor Package One

Local beers, house red and white wine, local sparkling wine, orange juice and soft drinks.

First hour or part of	\$8.00 per person
Two hours	\$13.50 per person
Every hour thereafter	\$4.50 per person

Liquor Package Two

House spirits, local beers, house red and white wine, local sparkling wine, orange juice and soft drinks

First hour or part of	\$11.00 per person
Two hours	\$17.50 per person
Every hour thereafter	\$5.50 per person

Beverages by the Glass

House Chardonnay	\$3.50
House Shiraz	\$3.50
Local 375 ml bottled beer	\$3.50
Imported beer	from \$4.50
Spirits - Standard	\$3.50
Spirits - Premium	\$4.50
Liqueurs - Premium	\$4.50
Liqueurs - Deluxe	\$5.50
Orange Juice - Jug	\$6.00
Orange Juice - Glass	\$2.50
Soft Drinks - Jug	\$6.00
Soft Drinks - Glass	\$2.00
Mineral Water - Jug	\$6.00
Mineral Water - Glass	\$2.50

Open Cash Bar - Guests purchase drinks at their own expense.

COCKTAIL PARTIES

Mix business with pleasure at an informal cocktail reception. It's the perfect way to end a long working day or entertain, and we have something to suit everyone's taste and budget.

Conference Completion Package \$17.00 per person

Beer, wine and soft drinks with the Chef's selection of Mediterranean nibbles served in Cocktail Bar. One hour duration.

Menu One

Two hours of beer, wine and soft drinks plus

- Mezze platters of olives, babaganoush, tzatziki, hommos, taramasalata, roasted capsicum, chorizo and grilled flat breads.

\$25.00 per person

Menu Two

Two hours of beer, wine and soft drinks plus:

- Smoked salmon and dill roulade on pumpernickel
- Chinese pork and roasted peanut tartlets
- Crostini with olive tapenade and aioli
- Gourmet mini pizzas with various toppings such as roasted artichoke, prosciutto, rocket, goats' cheese, capsicum and eggplant
- Lamb, cumin and pine nut meat balls with minted yoghurt
- Kangaroo chipolatas with bush tomato chutney.

\$27.50 per person

Menu Three

Two hours of beer, wine and soft drinks plus:

- Seared rare tuna on rice crackers with wasabi mayonnaise
- Peking duck crepes with hoi sin sauce
- Goats' cheese, roasted capsicum and rocket bruschettas
- Crisp flat bread with babaganoush and hommos
- Mini fillet steak sandwiches with onion marmalade
- Marinated chicken skewers with spicy peanut sauce
- Tandoori lamb fillet on crisp pappadums
- Shiitake mushroom and onion tartlets.

\$30.00 per person

COCKTAIL PARTIES

Your choice of:

Any **six** hors d'oeuvres plus bowls of crisps, nuts, olives, corn chips, platters of vegetable crudités with spicy guacamole, bacon and sour cream dips.

\$13.00 per person

Any **eight** hors d'oeuvres plus bowls of crisps, nuts, olives, corn chips, platters of vegetable crudités with spicy guacamole, bacon and sour cream dips.

\$17.00 per person

Any **ten** hors d'oeuvres plus bowls of crisps, nuts, olives, corn chips, platters of vegetable crudités with spicy guacamole, bacon and sour cream dips.

\$20.00 per person

Simply choose from the following hot and cold hors d'oeuvres:

Cold

- Mini potato and onion tortilla with tomato chutney
- Miniature vegetable frittata
- Sushi - your choice California rolls/salmon/tuna with sticky rice
- Green papaya and lime barquettes
- Assorted finger sandwiches with various fillings
- Mini bagels with smoked trout and horseradish cream
- Rock oysters with Spanish onion and balsamic marinade
- Chilled king prawns with lemon grass and soya dipping sauce
- Thai style chicken tartlets
- Fresh steamed asparagus wrapped in lamb prosciutto
- Slow roasted Roma tomato and bocconcini on crostini with basil pesto
- Fire seared capsicum and rare beef on pita
- Mini croissants filled with smoked turkey and cranberry
- Baked tomato and parmesan tart

Hot

- Trimmed char grilled lamb cutlets with tomato relish
- Tempura vegetables with soya mirin dipping sauce
- Lobster spring rolls with rice vinegar and sweet chilli sauce
- Spinach and ricotta triangles with sweet chilli dipping
- Coconut coated king prawns with a curried mango dip
- Baked crab and avocado tartlet with salmon caviar
- Spicy chicken and shallot spring rolls with plum sauce
- Steamed prawn shao mai with sesame and soya
- Baby potato filled with crisp bacon, chives and sour cream
- Roasted corn fritters with an avocado and tomato salsa
- Poached oysters in the half shell with ginger, sesame and soya
- Spicy calamari rings with aioli

COCKTAIL PARTIES

Select individually any of our hot or cold hors d'oeuvres at only \$3.00 per person, and receive complimentary bowls of crisps, nuts and olives

Simply choose from the following hot and cold hors d'oeuvres:

Cold

- Mini potato and onion tortilla with tomato chutney
- Miniature vegetable frittata
- Sushi - your choice California rolls/salmon/tuna with sticky rice
- Green papaya and lime barquettes
- Assorted finger sandwiches with various fillings
- Mini bagels with smoked trout and horseradish cream
- Rock oysters with Spanish onion and balsamic marinade
- Chilled king prawns with lemon grass and soya dipping sauce
- Thai style chicken tartlets
- Fresh steamed asparagus wrapped in lamb prosciutto
- Slow roasted Roma tomato and bocconcini on crostini with basil pesto
- Fire seared capsicum and rare beef on pita
- Mini croissants filled with smoked turkey and cranberry
- Baked tomato and parmesan tart

Hot

- Trimmed char grilled lamb cutlets with tomato relish
- Tempura vegetables with soya mirin dipping sauce
- Lobster spring rolls with rice vinegar and sweet chilli sauce
- Spinach and ricotta triangles with sweet chilli dipping
- Coconut coated king prawns with a curried mango dip
- Baked crab and avocado tartlet with salmon caviar
- Spicy chicken and shallot spring rolls with plum sauce
- Steamed prawn shao mai with sesame and soya
- Baby potato filled with crisp bacon, chives and sour cream
- Roasted corn fritters with an avocado and tomato salsa
- Poached oysters in the half shell with ginger, sesame and soya
- Spicy calamari rings with aioli

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Confirmations of Bookings

Confirmation of a booking must be made in writing within fourteen (14) days of the original booking. If such confirmation is not received, the management reserves the right to cancel the booking. A minimum deposit of 20% of the estimated cost is required at the time of confirmation.

Guaranteed Numbers

A guaranteed number of guests is required two (2) full working days prior to the function. This will be regarded as the minimum number for catering and charging.

Terms of Payment

Credit facilities must be established with the hotel prior to function commencement. When the lead time to a function is less than seven (7) working days, a credit card number must be supplied as security. Total payment is due within seven (7) days after the function.

Cancellation

Hotel A reserves the right to retain deposited monies as a cancellation fee. If a function is cancelled as late as 48 hours (i.e. two working days) prior to its due start, the organisers will be charged the total quoted price of the function.

Insurance

The guest assumes the responsibility for any and all damage or loss of merchandise left in the hotel prior to, during or after the function. Guests should arrange their own insurance.

Damage

The guest assumes responsibility for any and all damage caused by them or by any of their guests, invitees or other persons attending the function, whether in rooms reserved or in part of the hotel.

Adherence to Law

It is understood that the guest will conduct the function in an orderly manner and in compliance with the rules of the Hotel Management and with all applicable laws. The hotel reserves its right under law to refuse service of alcohol if in their opinion this service would contravene the hotel's obligations under the liquor licensing laws of this state.

Substitution

If the rooms reserved cannot be made available for causes beyond the control of the hotel, the hotel reserves the right to substitute similar or comparable accommodation for the function.

Follow up proposal

Within 24 hours of sending out a proposal a follow up call is required. This is used to determine the following:

- If they received the proposal
- If you can be of further assistance
- If they would like to confirm the booking
- That method of payment is clearly understood.



It is a good idea to make a follow up call week later as a secondary follow up call. Explain that dates are filling and there is another enquiry for the requested date. This usually gets a decision out of them.

If they are not going ahead ask why and enter them into the “Lost Business data base”.

3.3 Prepare event catering operational plan

Introduction

Once the catering proposal has been prepared, submitted and agreed by the client it is now time to prepare an operational plan which details the requirements and activities associated with food and beverage to be prepared and served at an event.

Contents of a catering operational plan

Event catering operational plan will follow acceptance/final confirmation of the event proposal and will present:

- Final menus and beverages
- Final arrangements regarding timing, locations and all agreed service issues
- Final prices
- Details of implementation protocols to ensure service and product delivery in accordance with the proposal.



Catering Running Sheet

It may also be necessary to present the client with a running sheet for their function which can be discussed and used to confirm details or identify situations where you have misunderstood or misinterpreted the client's needs.

Timing details and appropriate coordination of activities are a very important aspect of running a function or an event. Determining the appropriate times for the different stages of the function will ensure food and beverage service, technical arrangements and other service provisions can be timed and coordinated to coincide with the client's timing requirements.

Proper coordination for events ensures that multiple activities in a variety of locations can occur at the same time.

These timing details should be recorded on a 'running sheet'.

For example:

Guest arrival	6:30PM
Pre-dinner drinks	6:45PM
Seated for dinner	7:15PM
Entree	7:20PM
Speech and presentation	7:45PM
Main course	8:15PM
Entertainment	9:00PM
Dessert/coffee	9:30PM
Departure	10:30PM

Example of wedding running sheet

EVENT(S):	Wedding Reception
DATE(S):	
TIMES:	
5.00pm – 5.30pm	Guests Arrival
5.30pm – 6.15pm	PRE-DINNER DRINKS & HORS D'OEUVRES Mini Bagels with smoked trout & horseradish cream Assorted local and imported cheese & crackers Complimentary bowl of crisps, nuts & olives
Beverage package	Soft drinks, orange juice & water Alcohol (TBA)
6.15pm – 6.30pm	Guests move in to Jacaranda Room
6.30pm	Announce Bridal Party
7.00pm	DINNER Boned chicken wings with stir fried vegetables Sautéed beef with capsicum & onions Leg of Veal with pistachio stuffing An array of cold meats, terrines, and small goods with pickles and chutneys Soup kettle with crusty bread Creamed potatoes with buttered vegetables Salad bar and a selection of dressings Seasonal fruit platter and dessert selection Bread selection Coffee, Tea & petit fours
8.00pm	SPEECHES (Champagne to be served)
10.30pm	WEDDING CONCLUSION
GUESTS:	82 (Including bridal table of 7 persons)
LOCATION:	Wedding Room
ROOM HIRE:	Complimentary
ROOM STYLE:	Bridal Table 7 persons Banquet Tables 3 @ 10 persons 5 @ 9 persons Dance floor; cake table and knife; lectern and microphone.

COSTS:

FOOD PACKAGE	Hors D'oeuvres	\$ 3.00pp
	Buffet Dinner	\$36.00pp
	Kid's Price	\$15.00pp

BEV PACKAGE	<u>Soft Drinks</u>	
	Squash, Coke, Lemonade, Diet Coke	
	Orange juice and water (5 Hour duration)	\$15.00pp
	Champagne for speeches	\$22.00 per bottle
	Alcohol (TBA)	

ACCOMMODATION: Bridal Suite has been booked complimentary for bridal couple.

We are pleased to offer any of your family and friends who may require accommodation our special rate of \$160.00 + tax, per single occupancy room.

MUSIC: CD's to be brought in by couple and played on our system.

MASTER OF CEREMONIES: Bride's brother

EXTRAS: Flowers Organising own
Place cards Organising own
Love hearts To be brought in (hung right hand side of room)

Floor plan & seating To be forwarded

PARKING: Complimentary underground security parking is provided for all of your guests, subject to availability.

PAYMENT: A \$600.00 deposit has been received with thanks, with the remainder payable 48 hours prior to the Reception.

Benefits of running sheets

Naturally the larger the function and the more activities and inclusions there are, the bigger and more complex this sheet will be. Computerised event management software may be used to facilitate this, enabling easier control over multiple functions and at multiple locations.

A running sheet will also be distributed to other departments and used by them in their contribution to the function.

Examples of how this may be used can include:

- Staff setting up the rooms need to know when they must have everything ready
- Technical staff need to know the time when equipment will be needed, and for how long
- Kitchen staff need to know when food – each course, including pre-dinner snacks as well as all morning and afternoon teas – is required for service
- Beverage staff need to know which beverages are to be served, and when
- Service staff need to be informed of service times, so they know when to prepare, serve, clear, clean, re-set, etc.



3.4 Implement event catering operational plan

Introduction

One of the key requirements when planning for a function is to ensure that you are adequately staffed for the event.

This is normally undertaken through the use of a roster.

A roster is a plan that organises staff, indicating which staff are to work where and at what times.

The purpose of rosters can be seen as ensuring that the right people, in the right number, are employed at the right places at the right time.

This is always a unique challenge in functions, as each function is often different than others, with different levels and skill sets required based on a number of impacts, as identified below.



Reasons for having rosters

There are five reasons why organisations have rosters.

Four of these relate to the effective and efficient running of the business, while the fifth relates to individual employees.

Organising staff

Rostering is a means of organising staff.

It enables the supervisor to know who is working on a particular shift and who is not.

It enables the workload to be distributed fairly among staff and over time.

Balancing experienced staff

Rostering enables skilled workers to be on duty with people who are not so experienced. In this way, rosters ensure the customer is adequately served by staff in both numbers and skills.

This will be explained in more detail later in this section.

This is an effective and efficient use of staff.

Rostering also tells the organisation where various staff are deployed or why they are not at work. In many organisations, there is a direct link via computer software between the roster, the timesheet and payroll services.

Communicating

Rostering is a means of communicating with employees, to inform them of when they are required for work and when their leave days are available to be taken.

Good rosters reflect to the employee the busy periods and the goals of the organisation in terms of service.

In some cases, the roster may indicate to the employee what location and work they will be doing at a given time.

Cost controlling

Rostering is a definite way of controlling labour costs.

It ensures enough people are working for each function.

Rostering allows work to be distributed in a cost efficient manner while ensuring service to consumers is not diminished.

Aiding employees

Rosters enable individual employees to better plan and manage their personal and work time.

It enables them to plan for their holidays and 'time off' in advance.



Impacts on staffing

The amount and type of staff required to service a function will greatly depend on the:

- Type of function
- Service requirements
- Numbers attending
- Level of service required
- Host of associated miscellaneous details.

Sometimes the number of staff required is determined by the client. The budget they have available will dictate staffing levels.

Sometimes the venue will 'contribute' staff where this is deemed appropriate. This may occur when:

- The client is a regular, high-spending client and the venue wishes to make a tangible donation to the function
- The venue wishes to clear, clean and strip a room so it may be quickly re-set and re-used for another function. It may be the case a room is used for a lunch meeting and is also booked for a dinner function the same day. This would require extra staff to organise things and make sure both functions can be accommodated.

Calculating staff numbers

When determining how many staff are needed or can be afforded to a functions is based on a number of factors.

Roles to be performed

Each function is unique and therefore a great deal of thought needs to go into what each staff member will be required to do during the actual event. The following provides an overview of staffing needs for different function types:

Breakfast Function – Self-service – Continental Menu

- Staff to set up and service the buffet
- Staff to greet and seat customers
- Waiting staff to clear away unwanted crockery, cutlery and glassware
- Staff to clean up function and set for lunch.

Cocktail Party – Informal Function – Stand up

- Staff to set up function area
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Waiting staff to carry platters of food
- Staff to clean up the area after function.

Formal dinner party

- Staff to set up function area
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Waiting staff to provide semi-silver service to guests
- Staff to clean up the area after function
- Security staff.

General party

- Staff to assist with decorations
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Staff to coordinate and play music (DJ)
- Staff to carry platters of food
- Security staff.

Productivity standards

Every job has standards of performance that are required to be met by the employee undertaking that job.

Each organisation will have different 'expected levels of output' required for each staff member depending on the type of activities that they are required to perform.

Performance standards are targets and as such, where possible, should be expressed objectively. Examples of productivity standards may include:

- Food waiters may be expected to serve X number of people
- One bar tender is used to serve X number of customers.

Naturally, depending on the style of service, the expected output will vary but some form of standard will exist. For example staff undertaking silver service will be able to service fewer customers, than for a buffet function.



Budget

The person drawing up rosters of functions needs to consider relevant staff budgets that have been allocated to their department/section.

Issues to note are:

- Forecast labour costs for the period covered by the roster – how much money is available for staffing
- Ensuring all hours are covered and the wages/labour costs for the roster are within the allowable labour budget for each function.



Many establishments will forecast sales/revenue for the function in question, and that will determine the dollar figure available for labour, because they operate on a 'percentage of sales' labour budget.

In effect, the greater the revenue generated for a function, the more staff you can use. Correspondingly, less revenue means that fewer staff are available.

This scenario means management allocates the amount that can be spent, and it is up to you how you spend it.

The cost of employing someone does not just mean their wages, but also includes many other costs. Examples of these include workers' compensation insurance, superannuation, payroll tax and leave entitlements.

All supervisors have a responsibility to keep labour costs down while maintaining customer service level. This may be one of the ways your employer judges your workplace performance.

Allocating the right mix of staff

When rostering staff it is essential to use the available skills bases or skill sets and competencies of available staff to match the type of function. This is aimed at obtaining the most effective and appropriate mix of staff to meet different operational requirements and constraints. Given the nature of different functions and the fact that staff are not normally employed on a regular basis in a functions environment, it is essential that there is a 'right mix' of staff.



Consideration of the mix of staff for a specific function is done so the staff who are rostered on, complement each other and therefore provide balanced and total service to customers.

Factors influencing the mix of staff

This balance and mix may include attention to:

- The mix of experienced staff and new staff – the new staff may include trainees, those who are newly employed but who may have experience only in other establishments, people on work experience, staff who have just been promoted, and employees who are making a transition, perhaps as part of a multi-skilling focus, into the area but who may have experience within the venue in another department

- The mix of permanent and casually employed staff – most casual staff do not have the same knowledge or an organisation, know where items are located, how procedures are to be performed and different people who work in the functions and kitchen area, as permanent staff. In addition, they normally will not have the same sense of responsibility as permanent staff. Therefore it is important that there are qualified permanent staff who can help direct, lead and assist casually employed staff
- The mix of males to females – many establishments prefer a gender balance in their staff to cater for the various needs of their clientele. In addition, there may be certain roles that are traditionally occupied by one gender, equal opportunity legislation notwithstanding
- The mix of skilled employees to semi-skilled employees – this also highlights that staff with lots of experience are not necessarily those with skills. Skills and years of service are not always the same, although many staff tend to believe this is in fact the case. You may require a majority of staff in your functions area to have only basic plate carrying, service and clearing skills, while you will always want to have two on duty who have high levels of silver service and gueridon skills
- The mix of language skills – for some functions it could be critical to ensure an adequate mix of people with various language abilities.

Accessing staff

In many cases, functions do not have a ready pool of staff available at its disposal to cater for an event and may need to access staff through:

- Other departments
- Other hotels within the chain
- Specialist contractors
- Casual employment
- Employment agencies.

Venues often keep a list of people they can call on to work at functions. These are predominantly casual staff who have worked on functions at the venue before and who have proved their worth and competency. It is a fact that staff who do not perform at functions, are never re-hired.

In addition, some permanent venue staff will be allocated to work the function. These staff may well be more competent or multi-skilled staff who can work quicker, who know the run of the venue better, or who have more function experience and so on. Note that allocating normal dining room staff to a function may leave the dining room under-staffed for that time so additional staff have to be hired to back-fill that department.



Confirming staff

Because events/functions are one-off in nature staff used on them will often need to be confirmed.

This means contacting them to determine their availability and their willingness to work. Organising staff must be done in advance. It must never be left to the last minute.

Once rosters have been determined, by whatever means the enterprise uses, they must be communicated to staff within appropriate and designated timelines.

Information to communicate

Remember, you must be quite specific with all function staff about when they start, when they finish and exactly what their tasks are to be. Functions are sometimes seen by staff as opportunities to rack up a bit of extra cash.

All staff must be made aware of their working hours, and of the fact that no overtime will be paid unless approved by the appropriate person.

Methods of communicating confirmation

- Typically a copy of the roster will be posted on the noticeboard within the workplace – this is not always effective when a large amount of casual staff are used, many whom may not be on the premises on a regular basis
- Distributing hard copies to individual staff
- Phoning or texting staff members – this is the quickest method to both send requests and receive confirmation of shifts
- E-mailing electronic copies to staff – either at their work-based e-mail address or to their private home e-mail
- Distribution may be supplemented by mentioning the roster for the next week/fortnight at a weekly staff meeting.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 3.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify factors that may impact on catering
 - 3.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify what is included in a catering proposal
 - 3.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify what is included in a catering operational plan
 - 3.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain the steps associated with staffing a catered event.
-

Summary

Plan and deliver event catering

Identify and analyse event factors which may impact on catering

- Types of event factors that impact on catering
- Menu considerations
- Types of food and beverage menus
- Styles of service
- Types of packages
- Tailoring menus to client needs
- Types of menus
- Beverage options
- Room layout.

Prepare event catering proposal

- Example of event procedure/timeline
- Take Initial Enquiry
- Use Checklists
- Prepare and send proposal
- Follow up proposal.

Prepare event catering operational plan

- Contents of a catering operational plan
- Catering Running Sheet
- Benefits of running sheets.

Implement event catering operational plan

- Reasons for having rosters
- Impacts on staffing
- Calculating staff numbers
- Allocating the right mix of staff
- Accessing staff
- Confirming staff.

Element 4:

Plan and deliver sponsorship plans

4.1 Identify sponsorship opportunities, where appropriate

Introduction

Sponsorship is a common part of running an event. There are benefits for both the event organiser and the sponsoring business and it has been proven on many occasions that event sponsorship is a perfect match and essential partnership when hosting events, of any type, in any location and of any size.

Benefits for sponsors

Naturally, if a person or company is going to 'invest' in an event, they will seek some type of benefit in return. These benefits can include, but are not limited to:

- Right to display and promote their name at the event itself and on any materials related to the event
- Increase brand awareness
- Affiliate with other organisations, charities or celebrities who may be in attendance
- Enhance the brand or visibility of an event by having a 'reputable' company behind it
- Engage with the community and employees
- Enhance product and service sampling amongst its desired audience
- Improve contact and visual presence with the media.



Considerations when planning sponsorship

There are a number of considerations that should be taken into account when planning and implementing sponsorship activities:

- Try to secure a new sponsor each year whilst maintaining repeat sponsors
- Sponsorships must be identified as part of the initial planning phase
- Brainstorm program elements early to enhance creativity
- Try to involve potential sponsors when deciding sponsorship benefits or inclusions
- Allow maximum time to secure sponsors
- Identify the value of each category; reinforce the benefits of a previously held program and its sponsorship levels
- Create a fact sheet for each property/individual sponsorship category



- Offer higher level sponsors the right of first refusal. Majority of sponsors are either participating or onsite
- Renew all sponsorships at least six months prior to the event
- Secure new/replacement sponsors at least three months prior to the event
- Hold weekly or regular meetings to communicate sponsor status and renewals.

Identify potential sponsors

Whilst the range of sponsors is endless, sponsorship is normally offered to organisations that are like minded or will find some benefit in being involved in an event.

Potential sponsors can include:

- Individuals
- Government agencies – local government agencies, departments of trade etc commonly engage in events where organisations, products, services from their particular region are represented
- Companies – from a wide variety of industries trying to appeal to the target audience
- Industry organisations – this may be other hotel groups, food, beverage or equipment suppliers
- Community groups – including project focused groups, schools, volunteer organisations.

A great starting point is to compile a list of suitable sponsors. This can include:

- Current vendors
- Past sponsors
- Business partners
- Affiliated businesses.

The key is to identify possible benefits participation in an event may have and then identify companies that may be suited to the benefits being provided.



Types of sponsorship

In summary sponsorship normally is designed to account for 20-30% of event costs, with the remaining costs either being borne by the organising company or through delegate packages or entry costs.

There are a number of common types of sponsorship including:

- Cash sponsorship – where sponsors provide a financial contribution
- Product sponsorship – where sponsors donate actual products and services for a limited or no charge. This can also include products and samples in gift bags
- Venue sponsorship – where sponsors will provide a venue for the use of an event
- Person sponsorship – where key persons, celebrities or staff donate time to an event.

What sponsors will receive for their sponsorship contribution will be discussed in more detail in the next section.

4.2 Create and promote sponsorship packages, where appropriate

Introduction

It is common for different events to offer different levels of sponsorships to interested parties. Naturally not all participating companies will have similar sponsorship objectives, or will want to provide the same level of financial commitment or need the same level of exposure as others.

In order to improve the chance of obtaining different sponsors from different industry segments, it is a proven idea to offer different sponsorship packages. Each level will have a different financial cost and matching benefits.

Basic sponsorship categories

Examples of different inclusions in sponsorship packages may include:

Basic level sponsorship

- Logo inclusion on event marketing materials
- Right to use event logos
- Logo inclusion on the event website
- Recognition at all event meetings and ceremonies
- Dedicated team area for event participation



Medium level sponsorship

- Logo visibility on event-t-shirts
- Banner place at event site
- Right to exclusive sponsorship of a related program activity
- Speaking opportunities for company representative at ceremonies.

Top level sponsorship

- Category exclusivity at their respective level
- Right to exclusive sponsorship of a related program activity
- Speaking opportunities for company representative at ceremonies.



Types of different packages

Whilst the above categories may be basic in their structure, they are good starting points in which to create your own range of packages with unique, creative and appealing inclusions that will appeal to potential sponsors.

The different types of sponsorship packages are only limited by imagination. That said, the packages must reflect the type of event being held (e.g. sporting, fashion or music) and what benefits are available to sponsors.

Example – Food and Wine Festival

Corporate sponsors play a significant role in the planning and execution of any community festival. For large food and wine festivals there could be over 50 different sponsors across 15 different sponsorship categories which support the festival.

Possible sponsorship categories at a Food and Wine Festival can include the following:

- Presenting the event (\$750,000)
- Hosting the Village (\$125,000)
- Official Credit Card (\$90,000)
- Taste Stage (\$90,000)
- Concert: 1 per night (customised)
- Gourmet Dining Pavilion (\$50,000)
- Dining Pavilion (\$40,000)
- Participating (\$30,000)
- On-Site: 10 days (\$25,000)
- On-Site: 1 day (\$5,000)
- Media: in-kind value (\$120,000).



The organisers of a Food and Wine festival will determine different sponsorship levels and direct benefits help support the objectives of possible sponsors. Depending on the sponsorship level, visibility included in a Food and Wine Festival may include any of the following:

- Signage/banner opportunities (stage, railing, towers, street pole, etc.)
- Corporate logo on main stage
- Category exclusivity
- Promotional tent
- Advertisement in program materials
- Status level on event brochure
- Corporate logo on event advertisements
- Corporate logo at ticket windows
- Mentions in radio advertising
- Priority seating tickets
- Use of corporate hospitality tents
- Main stage presentations
- Main stage mentions
- Corporate press releases with event press kits
- Parking and delivery permits
- Opportunity to distribute pre-approved sample items.



4.3 Implement sponsorship items and activities

Introduction

As mentioned, one of the best ways to appeal to potential sponsors is to not only have attractive packages with tangible benefits but also to offer different levels of sponsorship, at different price points, each with differing levels of entitlements.

Now that packages have been identified, marketed and sold to sponsors, it is now time to implement them.

Depending on the type of sponsorship package, there are wide selections of items or activities that need to be prepared.

Summary of items and activities to prepare

Sponsorship items and activities that need to be prepared may include:

- Overall event sponsorship and/or segmented sponsorship
- Satchels and physical items
- Meals, drinks, travel, accommodation, speakers, social events
- One-off promotional activities and on-going organisational activities.



Example – A major sporting event

In the previous section, we looked at the example of the inclusions for different levels of sponsorship for a food and wine festival. To demonstrate the different items and activities that are associated with different types of events, this section will explore what needs to be planned and implemented for a large sporting event for the different sponsors that are participating at an event.

Hospitality and Entertainment Activities

Some hospitality or entertainment items and activities that may need to be arranged for sponsors include the arranging of:

- Game Tickets
- Sponsor Luxury Boxes
- Accommodation
- Media Party Tickets
- Night Party passes
- VIP Sponsor Event passes
- Golf Outing Invitations
- Luncheon Invitations
- The luncheon itself
- Media Reception Invitations



- Pre-Game Hospitality
- Player Personal Appearances
- Bus Transportation for Game Day
- Limousine Transportation for Game Day
- Priority Parking Passes.

Marketing and Promotional Activities

- Exclusive Sponsorship
- Couponing/Sampling at events
- Register-to-Win Contests
- Recognition in event publications
- Sponsor recognition at all private and public events
- Logo Identification and hot link on event Web Site
- Exclusive Sponsorship of Volunteer Program, includes Logo Recognition on Volunteer Uniforms
- Local Radio and Television Sponsor Tags
- Corporate Logo Identification in Local Print Media Inventory
- Emerging Business Program Sponsorship
- Exclusive Sponsorship of Media Party
- Use Logo to brand association with the event.



As it can be seen there are many items and activities that need to be prepared that are sponsorship focused, in addition to the actual event activities.

It is important that the same amount of care and attention are provided to these activities as sponsors will certainly consider themselves to be of the same value as customers as event customers or delegates themselves.

4.4 Follow up with sponsors

Introduction

At all stages of the event planning and implementation process it is important to follow up with sponsors to ensure that they are satisfied that what is being offered reflects what was promised for their contribution.

In order to keep sponsors happy at this event and to increase the chances of obtaining further sponsorship in subsequent events, sponsors must feel they have the opportunity to contribute and are getting value for money.

As mentioned in the previous section, a weekly communication meeting may be the most desirable way to ensure constant interaction with sponsors, however as the event is drawing closer; it is common to meet on a more regular basis.



Reasons to communicate with sponsors

There are many reasons to communicate with sponsors at all stages of the event including:

- Ensure the correct sponsor logos, image and message are being used as intended
- To discuss and confirm arrangements of sponsor activities and items, as identified in the previous section
- To forward any tickets, documents and passes etc
- To gather feedback or suggestions for improvement. This is especially important when sponsor products or services are being displayed or used in an event
- To arrange sponsor staff or representatives that are involved in event activities
- To arrange speakers or media events.

Regardless of the reason, sponsors must feel that they are being valued and are an integral part of an event.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 4.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify different types of sponsors that can be involved in an event of your choice
 - 4.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to create three different types of sponsorship categories and their respective inclusions for the event you have selected
 - 4.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify the different items or activities that will need to be prepared for the above mentioned event
 - 4.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify different ways you can involve sponsors in the communication process in the planning and implementation of an event.
-

Summary

Plan and deliver sponsorship plans

Identify sponsorship opportunities, where appropriate

- Benefits for sponsors
- Considerations when planning sponsorship
- Identify potential sponsors
- Types of sponsorship.

Create and promote sponsorship packages, where appropriate

- Basic sponsorship categories
- Types of different packages
- Example – Food and Wine Festival.

Implement sponsorship items and activities

- Summary of items and activities to prepare
- Example – A major sporting event.

Follow up with sponsors

- Reasons to communicate with sponsors.

Element 5:

Plan and deliver event management

5.1 Liaise with event stakeholders

Introduction

Communication throughout the planning, preparation and delivery of an event is vital to ensure that all stakeholders are not only aware of what they need to do, but also how it interrelates or impacts other stakeholder.

All successful functions are a result of effective teamwork.

This highlights the need to involve others in the planning phase so that the implementation works as required.

It is vital you appreciate the need to proactively include others in the planning stage especially those who will be participating in the preparation and execution of the function.

Never be afraid of asking for input from people in relation to planning these occasions.



Types of assistance

There are many types of assistance that may be required, either to be given or received, by different stakeholders in a function, including:

- Seeking advice or suggestions
- Confirming information
- Updating them about preparations and purchases
- Undertaking logistical activities and arrangements
- Assisting them to meet function requirements.

Who might be involved?

The following is indicative of who you may liaise with when planning a function:

- Food requirements discussed with Executive Chef
- Beverage requirements discussed with Beverage Manager
- Technical requirements discussed with Maintenance Department or outside suppliers
- Linen requirements discussed with housekeeping – outside suppliers may also be involved
- Room decorations and floral arrangements discussed with housekeeping or outside suppliers
- Facility set-up requirements discussed with Catering and Food and Beverage or functions coordinator

- Security information and requirements discussed with the Security Department
- Arrival and departure information discussed with Front Office Department.

What input can these people make?

Essentially you are asking these people to make input based on:

- Their previous experience
- Their specialist areas of expertise
- Their individual knowledge of the venue, what it can do, what it has to offer and what it has done successfully or unsuccessfully in the past.

Why involve them?

The benefit of involving these people should mean:

- You are more aware of other factors that could impact on the function – as result of information from these people about other happenings in the venue
- The venue avoids repeating previous mistakes they have made in other functions
- The venue is able to play to its strengths in terms of service delivery, staff expertise, facilities etc.

Examples of issues that can be more successfully addressed during planning if the right people are involved include:

- Special needs on the menu to accommodate vegetarians, cultural or special dietary needs
- Advice on a certain aspect of the function relating to the use of technology, specialist equipment etc
- Availability of specific facilities, rooms, staff, locations, equipment etc
- Input regarding table setting requirements – specific linen colours, accoutrements, table sizes, table plans, service issues, especially as they relate to timing
- Advice on a particular beverage being available for the function – to match beverages with food, to meet cost limitations and to ensure sufficient availability
- Assistance on the possibility of extending liquor trading hours and obtaining authorisation to trade in different areas.

Obtaining advice from others

Seeking advice from colleagues or management is usually done formally at a scheduled meeting where time is allocated for everyone to discuss the function and make input.

Sometimes, however, there can be a need to obtain help from people without notice.

For example, where you have the client with you in the office, and have to ring a colleague to find an answer to their question. In these cases it is advisable to say something like “Chef, I have Mr Walsh with me in the office. He wants some information on our \$40 per head set menu – have you got a minute to speak to us?”

Notifying the person on the other end of the phone that the client is with you can help avoid many potentially embarrassing situations. The same advice holds true of you are phoning a supplier to make an enquiry.

5.2 Prepare event management plan

Introduction

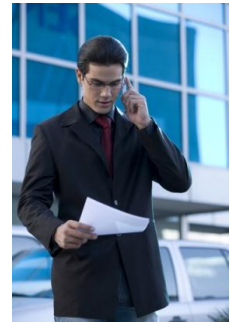
Once all details of an event have been finalised and confirmed it is vital that event management prepare a detailed event management plan.

This plan takes into consideration all possible scenarios and activities that need to either be planned or addressed.

Inclusions in an event management plan

Event management plan should address planning and preparation issues focusing on event implementation such as:

- Staffing requirements
- Security
- Management of external contractors
- Running sheets
- Briefing papers
- Staging elements or requirements – including set ups, rigging, room preparation, seating, tables, audio visual equipment, catering, security, sound and lighting displays and signage
- Catering arrangements – as specified in the event catering plan
- Liaison with stakeholders, dignitaries, delegates and guests, media, sponsors
- Guest/delegate management on arrival, during the event and on departure
- Risk management
- Emergency management
- Performance standards and guidelines
- Traffic management – including vehicular control and foot traffic within the venue/site
- Specification of control, command and communication structures – including lines of authority
- Scopes of responsibility, identification of key contact details for event managers
- Use of technology
- Timing and co-ordination of services, facilities
- Contingency plans – including contingency plans for adverse weather, and other identified high medium level potential risks.



It is important to note, some of these points have been discussed in other parts of this manual so will not be repeated in this section.

Arrange or communicate with external providers

Because all functions are unique they demand attention be paid to identifying and organising necessary resource requirements for every function or event.

While the venue will have certain physical facilities available as standard, individual functions traditionally may require the use of specialised skills or equipment which may not be available within the organisation.

At these times, external services will be utilised.

Given the nature of the function department, function managers will have strong working relationships with a number of external suppliers to help meet the requests of clients.

Types of external providers

Many functions will require you to use the services of third party, external businesses to source items and services needed to ensure the successful running of a function.

These external suppliers can vary enormously depending on the type and scale of the function and may include:

- Florists
- Photographers
- Party Hire companies – for trestle tables, extra crockery, cutlery, glassware, chair covers, seating, decorations
- Entertainers – bands, disc jockeys, solo performers etc
- Suppliers of rental technical equipment for audio and visual needs
- Printers – for personalised stationery, menus, signage and decoration needs
- Security agencies – for extra security staff
- Employment agencies – for additional waiting, bar, service and cooking staff
- Business support services – such as interpreters, translators, secretarial support
- Transportation – including chauffeurs, limousines, private cars or buses for tours
- Clowns and other entertainers



Arranging external services

When developing relationships with external providers, there are a number of steps that may be taken including:

Sourcing option

Like with any business, different companies will offer different products and services as a means of identifying their point of difference. Even in similar businesses, such as equipment, linen or theme hire companies, the actual products they provide will differ.

It is a good idea to source at least three companies in a similar field to ensure that you have an understanding of a wide selection of what is available.

Liaising with providers to identify and price necessary items and services

Given that a hotel's relationship with external suppliers will not be a one-off event, it is important to gain an understanding of what an external provider can provide including:

- Range of offering – selection of products and services
- Pricing structure for each item – including discounts or complimentary additional items
- Service guarantees – what quality and quantity guarantees can they provide
- Availability - how available are items. It is no use choosing a provider, no matter how cheap, if their items are never available
- Pre-event services – delivery and setting up arrangements
- Event services- what will the company do during the event to ensure its products or services operate as expected
- Post-event services – take down and removal of items, cleaning etc
- Billing and payment arrangements.



In the eyes of the customer, what is provided at an event, regardless of whether internally or externally supplied, will impact on the reputation of the hotel, therefore it is essential that external providers are carefully selected.

Facilitating access by external providers to venue to enable on-site assessment of requirements, facilities and demands

Most external providers will need access to a venue before the commencement time of an event to set up. Likewise after the completion of a function, they will also need time to take down remove and clean the area.

It is essential that providers understand:

- What time they have access
- Delivery and parking zones
- Storage areas
- Commencement and finishing times of the function
- Amount of time allocated after the event for access.

Connecting service providers with customer, where appropriate

In many cases functions staff will suggest that external providers correspond directly with the client because:

- Functions staff do not have the technical knowledge or understanding of what the external provider can offer
- External providers can explain what they can offer and provide suggestions
- Can remove a level of activity or responsibility from the functions department.



Preparing function sheets

It is standard practice to prepare a function sheet as a means of communicating with staff about an upcoming function.

A function sheet, sometimes also known as an 'event order' or 'function order', is an internal communication form developed to suit each venue's needs that sets out the details of a function such as:

- Type of function – wedding, launch of product, ball
- Name, address, and contact number of client
- Day, date and time of the function
- Rooms and locations where the function will be held
- Billing instructions – who gets the bill, their address
- Menu – break-down course-by-course of the agreed dishes including specification of 'on arrival' food, morning and afternoon teas
- Beverage arrangements – description and quantities of beverages to be provided
- Sequence of service – covering timing of service, and details of when speeches and presentations will occur
- Entertainment – details of bands and the order of ceremony
- Room set up – number of tables, floor plan, decorations, table set-ups including cutlery, crockery and table accoutrements
- Type of service – plated, tray, buffet, silver service, finger food
- Special requirements – commonly relating to technology requirements such as microphone, DVD facilities, data projector, sound and lighting.



Maintaining and updating Function Sheet

Whilst the Function Sheet may be accurate at the time of the function booking and confirmation, there will be changes which need to be updated and communicated to relevant internal departments and external suppliers.

Updating Function Sheet

When any changes to a function are identified the Function Sheet must be updated by:

- Amending Function File on the basis of requests from customer – including finalisation of menus and beverages, confirmation of times, and adding new requests for products and services
- Adding details to the file regarding function-related activities – including booking of entertainers, confirmation of external services to be provided, and timing of service.

Identification of changes

As more and more changes are made, it may become difficult to identify which copy of a Function Sheet is the most updated and accurate.

It is essential that each updated version of the Function Sheet is marked in some way as to identify the version.

This identification can come in the form of a version number depicted by:

- Numerical identification – 1,2,3
- Date identification – identifying date of version.

Discussing changes

It is also important that any updated versions are given to the appropriate people in a timely manner and that they understand the changes that have been made and how they impact the department of staff member.

Email

This can come in the form of an email with the following instructions letting the sender know the status of the email including:

- Notification - when the email has been opened
- Read Receipt – send by the recipient when they have read and understood the changes.

In person

Updated Function Sheets may be distributed and explained in meetings, allowing all relevant people time to discuss the changes and how best to implement them. Given that the logistics of a function impacts a number of departments, it is essential they all understand and agree on the changes to be made.

Alternatively the function staff member may personally deliver the updated version in hand to ensure that it is not only been given to the correct person, but allows them to discuss updates and changes with different colleagues and staff. This format is used when changes are made at the last minute, which is very common in functions.



Identify and consider possible event impacts and take appropriate action to address these impacts

Shortage of staff

It is always possible more guests arrive for a function than planned for or staff members rostered to work may call in sick.

An emergency list of staff, with phone numbers, who can be called in at very short notice must be compiled and managers should know where they poach current staff from until the crisis passes.

By 'borrowing' someone from room service, someone from another function, two from the dining room and one from the bar it may be possible to struggle through until help arrives, or until things ease off.

Management should not be shy in pitching in to help as necessary.

Loss of power or IT connections

Power failure and failure of technology is a constant source of worry during functions.

The failure of speakers, data projectors to function as required can turn an otherwise successful occasion into a disaster.

To effectively address this potential, pre-planning is imperative.

Some venues have a stand-by generator to accommodate power failure and this is an obvious first step to consider.

For addressing IT problems you should consider having a suitably qualified technician in attendance, or staff with relevant experience and appropriate ability.

Equipment malfunctions

Equipment is always subject to failure without notice and options to address this include having back-up items available which may be able to be borrowed from other areas within the venue, hiring replacement units and having them on stand-by just in case or having a maintenance person on duty to fix them.

Excess noise affecting other areas of the business

Realistically, most functions produce some form of noise and it is a safe bet that it will upset someone, interrupt someone, or disturb someone's sleep. All you can do is apologise and perhaps offer some discount or complimentary service.

Appropriate planning can help minimise this potential.

Reception staff may be able to minimise possible complaints from in-house functions by not selling rooms above or immediately adjacent to the function area.

Using security staff to 'escort' patrons to their cars may also help keep the noise on leaving under control.

Locating the function in a space not frequented by other patrons may be an option. Some venues will restrict access to certain areas which are normally open to the public while a function is on, thereby preventing members of the public being impacted by the function.

Shortage of food and beverage products and any associated items

Adequate planning and calculations should avoid this situation but the unpredictable can always occur resulting in shortages.

Keys to avoid problems are:

- Count items in stock to know how much you have – never assume you know what is available - make arrangements to buy, hire or borrow whatever is needed
- Be aware that while a function is in progress other parts of the venue have to be able to operate as normal – the function can rarely be allowed to monopolise all venue resources so make sure other bars, dining areas etc, are still able to deliver the service levels needed for other patrons
- Use in-venue history to help determine what demand will be on all resources necessary – figures and evaluations from previous functions can be extremely useful in determining what is needed or what problems might occur
- Have a Plan B for instances where food and menu items run out – it is essential the kitchen is able to supply a meal of some sort where the agreed menu items run out.



Unacceptable behaviour

Functions and events often give rise to unacceptable behaviour.

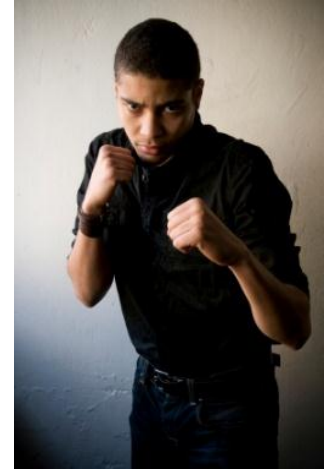
This behaviour may be unacceptable to other attendees at the function or unacceptable to other venue patrons who are not part of the function.

Prevention is better than cure in these situations and constant monitoring of behaviour by security staff, operational staff and management coupled with early intervention is critical.

Standard procedure in some venues as a first response to unacceptable behaviour is to notify function coordinators who may include committee members, team leaders, captains, and treasurers where behaviour is a problem and ask them to intervene.

Where this fails to resolve the situation, normal procedures for dealing with trouble makers should be followed.

The standard orientation is to hope for the best, and plan for the worst.



Disruption to normal service caused by closure of room/areas

Depending on the size or location of the event, other areas outside the dedicated function rooms may be used exclusively for a function. This means that it is not open for the use of other in-house guests.

This may include by not limited to:

- Gardens – for use of cocktail parties and weddings
- Restaurants – for private parties and birthdays.

It is essential that if an area is closed, that arrangements can be made elsewhere to accommodate in-house guests. For example if a restaurant is closed, the same menu may be available for room service or in the bar.

Restricted access to the venue

At times, VIP's such as heads of state may be attending functions. In these cases, security levels may be higher than usual, with access restricted to certain areas.

Notices may be sent to in-house guests notifying them of the added security measures put into place.

Reduced availability of parking for regular customers

The larger an event, the more car spaces will be taken up by participants at these events. Whilst it is important to allocate spaces for event patrons, a certain percentage of parking must be reserved for in-house guests and other patrons.

Where parking may be a problem, arrangements may need to be made with local car park facilities, whether to arrange special prices or to reserve spaces, so that some form of alternatives can be provided to function patrons or in-house guests.



Adequate notification

Regardless of the activity that may impact on other customers and in-house guest, generally with the provision of some advanced notice, they may be more accepting of the impacts as it will not be a surprise and they will have time to make suitable arrangements.

Methods of suitable notification may include:

- Signs in the foyer
- Signs in elevators and bathrooms
- Letters sent to guest rooms
- Verbal explanation – at reception or by staff in other departments.



Prepare, update and distribute event documentation to clients, relevant colleagues and suppliers

Information for internal staff

Communication is extremely important in relation to all functions.

Much communication is verbal but all functions demand written information to give certainty and details about what is required.

Any documentation that is contained in the function file may be shared with internal staff especially departmental managers such as head chefs, head housekeeper, food and beverage manager.

A vital document used to disseminate information is the function sheet. This should be distributed to all internal staff involved in the execution of the function.

Methods of distribution include:

- Posting on departmental notice boards
- Giving multiple copies to departmental heads for them to distribute to staff
- Function co-ordinator distributes personally to all those involved
- Email.

Using a function sheet helps to ensure that everyone gets the same information – this reduces potential misunderstandings, keeps everyone heading in the same direction, and indicates the planning that has gone into the function.

Suppliers

Documentation provided to suppliers will be limited to purchase orders for goods and services being supplied and a version of the running sheet to give them relevant dates, times and locations.

It is to be expected this written information will be supplemented by and clarified with verbal information as well.

The client

The information that is supplied to the client should include:

- Running sheet
- Function sheet

- Quotations from third party providers – where the venue is arranging products and services on behalf of the client
- Samples of all materials agreed to as part of the agreement – this may include invitations, food menus, wine lists, drink lists, service vouchers etc.

Remember the client may receive several versions of some of the above as details of the function change during the planning phase.

A copy of everything provided to the client must be placed in the function file ensuring it carries a date to assist with version control.

5.3 Manage event set up in-line with event management plan

Introduction

It is critical to have the function set up and ready to go by the agreed starting time. Any function that is not ready when required is destined to failure. You seem never able to retrieve a situation where you begin behind time.

A key objective when monitoring set up for a function is that all necessary mise-en-place is completed.

Mise-en-place

What does mise-en-place mean?

Mise-en-place is a French term that means 'to put in place'.

The term traditionally was used in kitchens to describe the activities required prior to commencing food preparation of a dish, such as assembling the ingredients and equipment needed, pre-heating the oven etc. It is now a common term used in all food and beverage outlets including dining rooms, restaurants and functions.



Therefore, 'set up and mise-en-place' refers to all the activities required to prepare the room for service. It means setting the tables and putting everything that is needed where it should be and in the quantities required to support the function.

Set up policies and procedures

What enterprise procedures and requirements may apply?

These can address:

Adhering to establishment SOPs that may relate to:

- Following prescribed safety procedures – including the use of all safety equipment and clothing that is provided
- Adhering to safe food handling practices – as set out in the Food Safety Plan/Program for the premises
- Staying within allocated scopes of responsibility

- Discharging all tasks to the best of your ability
- Ensuring that all allocated tasks have been completed – as described by your Position Description or Jobs checklist
- Notifying management when a problem, hazard or other situation likely to impact on service delivery is identified
- Working only the allocated hours as stated on the roster – unless specific and written approval for overtime is obtained.

Using checklists

When preparing activities for functions, there no doubt will be many small tasks that need to be performed. As will be explained later in this section, some activities to be completed will relate specifically to a particular function, whilst others will be common to all functions.

Regardless of the variety or list of activities to be performed, there must be a method of ensuring that all important activities are not only completed, but can easily be monitored to ensure they have been completed.

One effective method to ensure activities can be monitored is through the use of checklists.

Importance of Checklists

An industry-wide method of monitoring completion and monitoring of activities is to use a series of checklists.

Not only does a checklist help remind staff of what needs to take place, it helps ensure activities are not forgotten. In addition checklists can easily be used by management and staff to see that activities have been completed, by whom and at what time. It therefore makes them an easy to use referencing and monitoring tool.

Many examples of checklists are available but the key to using them is that they must reflect the needs of the premises, whilst still being flexible enough to apply to individual functions.

The use of checklists by staff

Checklists can be posted throughout the work area and used by staff as prompts of what needs to be done.

These checklists must reflect the precise information which has been generated. There must be congruence between these 'official documents' and what staff have been told are the requirements.

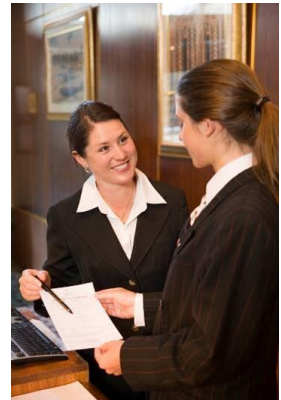
These checklists are very helpful in the functions department, as each function will be different and also due to the fact that many staff may be employed on a casual basis and may not be familiar with the exacting standards or procedures that need to be followed.



The use of checklists by supervisors

Supervisors can use checklists to monitor staff activities because they introduce the following into the overall process:

- No aspect of the job is left out of the monitoring process when a comprehensive checklist is used
- Consistency across all staff whose performance is being monitored – all staff are evaluated against the same criteria
- Subjectivity in monitoring – the areas to be checked are dictated by the checklist and not by the whim of the supervisor
- Matters that are regularly occurring as non-compliance issues can be identified and fed back to staff so top-up training can occur in-house.



Developing checklists

Checklists may be developed to monitor procedures being implemented by staff and to monitor the condition of areas as part of scheduled inspections.

Developing a dual-purpose checklist helps save time. You can monitor staff performance at the same time you monitor the condition of the area.

When developing checklists it is important to:

- Ensure all aspects of the process or area are covered – check legislated requirements, in-house practices, house standards and relevant documentation. Personal observation combined with proper industry and site knowledge are key factors
- Talk to those who are performing and supervising the work – to ensure nothing important is missed, to ensure the correct workplace sequence is adhered to and to factor in specific workplace techniques, problems and issues
- Trial a draft checklists – to see if it is satisfactory, appropriate and comprehensive before full implementation of the checklist occurs.

Example of checklist

On the following page is an example of a checklist that can be used in the functions department to help staff prepare for a function.

Functions Job Checklist Checklist usage: Before each session Responsibility: Floor staff Compliance level: All tasks must be completed	
Cleaning and checking the function room	☐
Cleaning and checking the customer facilities – toilets, reception areas, outdoor areas	☐
Setting comfort levels – music, air conditioning, lighting	☐
Preparing function floor plan/table plan	☐
Obtaining the cash register floats – and change	☐
Preparing servicewear, cutlery, crockery and glassware	☐
Setting tables – to match floor plan/table plan and the menu style being used: • Laying table clothes, • Setting cutlery and side plates • Necessary accoutrements to dress the table.	☐
Room set up – to conform to standard requirements and function requirements	☐
Preparatory activities – such as folding serviettes, preparing butters, preparing flowers, polishing cutlery	☐
Preparing service equipment – such as ice buckets and stands, espresso machines, waiter's stations, gueridon trolleys, tea making facilities, bain maries	☐
Liaison between staff	☐

Planning the set-up

Many venues will have plans of previous function set-ups to guide set-ups.

In all instances the room set-up must be in accordance with client wishes as set out in the contract.

Furniture arrangements and layout of the room will depend on the number of guests at the function, and things such as whether or not a dance floor is required, whether some form of display is needed and the other activities included.

A seating plan may need to be provided where sit-down meals are being provided and there can be a need to obtain head table details including number required and names of people sitting on it.



When setting up the relevant locations the function sheet should be referred to determine the need for specific furniture such as display tables, registration tables, tables for merchandise and delegate materials, catering and IT requirements.

A checklist may be prepared prior to set-up and used during the set-up to make sure all requirements are provided as agreed - where there are multiple rooms, there should be one checklist per room.

Decorations, flower displays, and table settings must likewise be in accord with client wishes and with the requirements of the menu decided on.

Setting-up the room according to instructions

Pre-planning is extremely important to ensure staff costs do not over-run budget during the set-up stage. Staff requirements for functions are often staggered with staff coming on at different times so that staff levels increase closer to function time and taper off after the main event.

Pre-planning must determine what tasks need to be carried out, how long those tasks will take and allocation of staff accordingly. The checklists referred to above will assist in this regard.

During room set-up it is common for client personnel or family to also be there, perhaps setting up a display or assembling some specific item which they have provided. A contact person should be identified for liaison purposes with these people so as to stop them interrupting venue staff, and to increase the chance of positive guest-venue relations.

Additional tasks include:

- Facilitating access to function area by customer to undertake their own decoration
- Facilitating access to function area by external providers to set-up their equipment
- Taking action to address problems arising – including bringing in extra staff, re-allocation of duties, and obtaining items identified as necessary at short notice.



Floor-related mise-en-place tasks

Whilst each function may be different, with specific mise-en-place tasks associated with each, as mentioned on the previous page, there will be general activities that need to be followed when setting up for a function that includes food and beverage service.

While the roles of individual staff will vary as designated by the supervisor to reflect the requirements of the function, there nonetheless always remains a non-negotiable requirement to undertake certain tasks.

The following mise-en-place activities must be addressed by food service staff:

- Preparing, polishing and setting glasses on each table at each setting – including the equipment to ensure that glassware is available and has been prepared to support the service of special beverages as required for the function
- Preparing crockery and cutlery – for placement on tables. Most premises require crockery to be checked to ensure it is clean and free of chips or cracks and that cutlery is to be polished prior to being set
- Checking that items required to support the service of menu items as listed are ready and available. This can include:
 - Platters, lids and covers
 - Service utensils – such as spoons and forks for silver service, tongs, cake lifts and stands, sauce boats and underliners
 - Oven-to-table ware – this is commonly the responsibility of kitchen staff but waiting staff may be responsible for ensuring the stands or mats that these hot items are placed on are ready and available
- Folding napkins – including the preparation of waiter's cloths/napkins ready for use on clothed service plates
- Preparing condiments – including re-filling, cleaning and placement on tables and in waiter's stations
- Preparing butters – including spares to cater for situations where extra butter is required
- Relying all equipment – such as espresso machines, tea and coffee-making equipment, Bain Mariers, waiter's stations
- Checking or preparing display materials – some properties will feature a display table to fit in with a theme
- Preparing and checking operational readiness of cash registers where a cash service is operating – this can include collecting and counting the float, obtaining change, checking the audit tape is sufficient for the up-coming session, and ensuring date/time is correct. This may be the role of bar staff in some venues where accounts are processed through the bar register
- Checking that table settings reflect dining needs, function requirements and house requirements – this may include checking and making necessary adjustments to items such as:
 - Linen presentation – checking the serviette fold used is as required, that napkin folds are uniform, clean and attractive, that overlays have been used as intended



- Paper overlays and serviettes – depending on the style or standard of the room, there may be a requirement that paper items are used as opposed to linen ones
- Placemats – checking cleanliness
- Glassware – to reflect house policy or function requirements
- Service wear and flatware – making sure that necessary quantities of normal service wear are ready for use, and that special items are available to suit identified guest needs
- Floral arrangements – checking bud vases for acceptable appearance and to make sure they are in position
- Condiments – checking they are present, clean and filled
- Table numbers – where they are used, checking to make sure all tables have numbers that reflect the floor plan/table plan.



Setting the tables

Tables must be set to:

- Reflect the menu that is being used for the function
- Reflect the floor/table plan that has been prepared
- Comply with house and function requirements – relating to table dressings, colours of table cloths, overlays, napkins. It also includes function preferences for things such as placement of wine glasses on the table for each cover/setting
- Ensure uniformity throughout the room – table set ups should be the same across the room.



Tables and chairs should be checked prior to service to ensure:

- Guest comfort – tables and chairs that are unstable reduce the level of guest satisfaction, enjoyment and comfort with their service experience
- Guest safety – checks should ensure the furniture is 'fit for purpose' and does not present a hazard to those using it: checks should ensure nothing is broken
- Appropriate access – so that guests can freely gain access to their seats and move safely throughout the room. Special care and action may need to be taken where wheelchair access is required and where gueridon trolleys are going to be used. In addition there must be adequate room for functions service staff to move in an efficient manner.

Bar related mise-en-place tasks

Mise en place tasks for the bar may include:

- Storing beverages that have been delivered to the bar – where stock is waiting to be put away. This is usually the first job to do in order to get drinks that require refrigeration into the fridges as soon as possible. All stock should be rotated using the First In, First Out method meaning that existing stock should be moved forward and the new stock stored behind it
- Preparing bar garnishes – these should include the basic lemon and orange slices and lime quarters as well as more sophisticated garnishes for any cocktails that are being offered as part of the function
- Preparing ice – including obtaining ice, crushing ice and readying ice buckets and stands
- Preparing and checking operational readiness of cash registers – if a cash bar system is operating
- Checking to see that all beverages listed on running sheets are available – and noting those that are not for mention at the staff briefing or ordering replacement stock as require
- Checking the post-mix – to make sure it is fully operational for all flavours and the water button, and is being delivered at the right temperature and strength
- Turning on espresso coffee machine
- Setting out drip trays – with de-naturing agent
- Setting out under-trays and racks for dirty glassware
- Checking equipment and bar utensils are clean and in working order – this check should include all operational bar equipment
- Placing racks of clean glassware out into their service positions – this may be in a glass chiller which will need to be turned on
- Checking glassware to ensure no cracks, chips, lipstick marks, etc
- Placing spirit pourers on the appropriate bottles – ensuring sufficient supply of liquor
- Stacking and ensuring cleanliness of service trays
- Filling up ice buckets
- Opening pre-selected wines
- Preparing and filling water jugs or other items that are to be pre-placed on function tables
- Prepare pre-ordered drinks
- Bar staff may also be required to set out appropriate glassware on the tables and to prepare service trays and drinks for, say, pre-function drinks in the lobby or champagne.



Organising stock

On most occasions stock will have to be purchased to meet specific needs of a proposed function.

This stock reflects the agreed client requirements and may include:

- Specific types/brands of wine or other beverages
- Specific food items from a specialist supplier
- Specific linen items – for example a certain colour of table cloths and napkins
- Specific furniture items.



Stock should always be brought into store at least two days before the date of the function. This allows for alternative arrangements to be made where non-supply occurs.

The procedure to purchase special stock not normally used by the venue may vary from establishment to establishment and can require special authorisation prior to purchase.

Set up tables for event

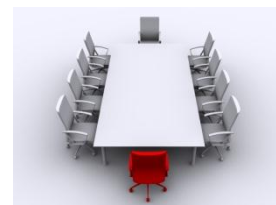
To date in this section, we have focused on setting up an event or function which is solely focused on the provision of food and beverages. This is not always the main purpose of the event.

A common type of event is a conference or meeting, where tables need to be set with a more business related focus in mind.

Arrange venue layout

Layout aspects to be arranged include:

- Tables and Chairs – for speakers and participants
- Surrounding furniture - including catering tables, chairs, coat racks, luggage storage
- Stage – including lectern
- Signage – to be displayed in the room itself, in front of the meeting room and the entrance of the building, including suitable directions
- Aesthetics – Flowers, plants, music lighting and temperature.



Arrange Equipment

The type of equipment required in a meeting may include:

- Computers, printers and scanners
- Photocopiers
- Telephones including teleconference equipment
- Video conference equipment
- Data Projector and screen
- Audio Speakers
- Internet connection or 'Wi-Fi'
- Microphone (cordless or fixed), stand and speakers



- Whiteboards and electronic whiteboards
- Flip carts, butchers paper and pens
- Lectern including light
- DVD Player and TV screen
- Lighting
- Camera and video player.

Arrange stationery

It is important that all participants have all the necessary tools at their disposal to record information. Most participants will expect these to be provided.

Effective meeting planners will arrange:

- Pens and pads
- Name badges
- Place settings
- Water glass and pitchers
- Mints / candy dishes.

Prepare registration area

This area may include:

- Registration table
- Signage
- Chairs
- Accompanying table for materials for information packs to be presented
- Pens and paper
- Area for coats and jackets.



Prepare presenters table

- A 'Stationery kit' which comprises a ruler, pencils, pens, scissors, highlighters, glue, pins, 'blu-tac', calculator, laser pointer, whiteboard markers, eraser, stapler, staple remover and hole punch
- Water and glass
- Copy of timing schedule – where applicable
- Copy of notes or materials.

Prepare and organise relevant event briefings in a timely fashion

Communication and planning is the key to success in any operation. This is especially true in functions where two events are never the same and therefore staff must be aware of the requirements for each and every new function.

The best way to communicate to staff the requirements of an event is in the form of a pre-function briefing when staff are all together.

Department heads and external providers may have held various meetings in the lead up to an event; however staff who will actually be performing the bulk of the activities were normally not present at these, and therefore are unaware of what the upcoming function entails.

Persons involved in briefing

Before the function is conducted it is traditional to conduct a briefing.

This briefing may involve:

- Heads of Departments – Food and Beverage, Kitchen, Front Office, Housekeeping
- Waiting staff
- Beverage staff
- Security staff
- Storeroom staff
- Technical staff
- Third party suppliers who are responsible for products and services to be supplied or who have key roles such as sound and lighting, special effects and activities
- The client or their representatives - in some cases it can also be useful to invite the client to the briefing to enable them to speak first-hand to all those involved.



Contents of a briefing

Before functions commence, the event coordinator should brief the relevant departments and all operational staff about the full and final details so as to ensure the smooth running of the function.

This briefing should be made to all staff involved. In reality this rarely occurs due to the casual nature of many of the staff who are used.

The briefing should cover any relevant information and important points about the function and include distribution of the latest running sheet to staff.

The briefing should address:

- Identifying customer and attendees to staff
- Overview of the function covering:
 - Who will be there – including identification of any celebrities, 'stars', media and other VIPs
 - Overall provision of food, beverages, facilities, services etc, as agreed with the client and attendees
 - Type of function
 - Identification of all rooms
 - Explanation of all activities
 - Final numbers
- Describing anticipated/planned function – including distribution of Running Sheets and discussing the importance of timing requirements
- Last minute changes to the running sheet
- Special requests made by the client – and how they are going to be handled
- Particular issues the venue expects with certain aspects of the function – such as where problems, equipment shortages, tight timelines and other issues have been identified
- Identifying options that exist for service recovery where service timing points are exceeded
- Presentation of service standards and mention of any security issues
- Clarification of 'chain of command' for all staff including specific scopes of authority, as they may apply
- Arrangements for security, media access, meals, photo/filming opportunities, passes etc
- Specific 'Do's and don'ts for the function – these should always be mentioned even where staff are familiar with venue protocols in this regard. Basics include:
 - No staring or pointing at celebrities
 - No asking for autographs/photographs
- Allocating roles and responsibilities
- Allocation of specific duties to specific staff – which should address set-up, implementation and take down stages of the function
- Allocating stations to waiting staff and explaining seating plan
- Any last minute changes of any aspect of the function – this frequently involves finishing time and arrangements relating to liquor provision
- Checking uniforms and personal presentation of staff
- Completing time sheets
- Discussing when staff breaks will be taken during the event.



5.4 Monitor conduct and implementation of event in-line with event management plan

Introduction

Not only is it important that activities are monitored in the lead up to a function, it is absolutely essential that they are monitored as the function is taking place.

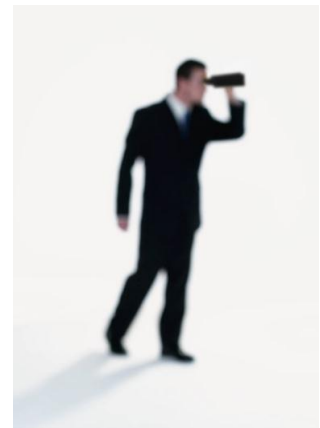
With many functions comprising a number of activities, which often impact on other activities, across a number of job roles and departments, it is important that the manager has a true grasp of what is happening and has the ability to make changes immediately to ensure the smooth conduct of all activities.

This section focuses on monitoring and reviewing of staff activities during a function.

Managers must ensure that work activities designated to staff or make up their job role, must be completed in an acceptable manner within the desired timeframes.

Simply because standards have been developed, reduced to writing, explained to staff and ratified by management, doesn't mean they will always be implemented.

What is required is some monitoring of customer service in the workplace to ensure standards are met in accordance with organisation policies and procedures.



Monitoring methods

Throughout the function you have to monitor activities and implement the running sheet as agreed with the client, taking into account any factors that may arise which can give cause for changes.

The most important thing in monitoring function activities is the will to monitor them. You have to want to monitor them.

The most common problem is service standards are developed and communicated but not monitored. If service delivery standards are not monitored the result can be service standards quickly drop and this impacts adversely on the function, not just on one activity, but on all activities influenced or affected by it.

The common monitoring methods are:

- Workplace observation – watching what goes on as it happens, reading customer body language and measuring waiting times
- Talking to staff – to get their impressions, to identify obstacles that will impact on the ability to perform function activities
- Feedback from the function co-ordinator or customers of the function - constant liaison with the client or their delegated representative is a given in large functions where there are multiple sites and multiple activities.

Monitoring the function

While the function manager will have overall responsibility for the function, there should be one individual at all times who has delegated responsibility for each area, whether a room or location, where any part of the function is being held.

As the function progresses this person should monitor the running sheet to ensure timelines are maintained and also pay attention to the following:

- Checking running times
- Adjusting service delivery to align with Running Sheet
- Arranging changes to the agreed Running Sheet to accommodate the need to do so
- Ensuring quality service delivery
- Ensuring all customer requirements are met
- Responding to queries and requests from clients and guests
- Liaising with customer during function to check level of satisfaction
- Enquiring if customer has additional requirements during service
- Providing additional items as required – this may include tables, chairs, ashtrays, glassware
- Clearing rubbish and used items
- Monitoring security, patron behaviour and on-going safety
- Observing what is occurring and factoring these observations into action to be taken to keep the function running on-time and keep the client satisfied
- Taking action to address service problems – this will be discussed below.



Taking action to address service problems

It is a fact of life there will be problems of some sort at any function.

Even where appropriate planning and preparation has taken place it is still likely there will be problems.

Problems may be caused by equipment failure, shortage of materials, patrons. Many problems relate to timing issues.

Whatever the cause of the problem the best way to achieve an optimal outcome is to:

- Actively monitor all aspects of the function – listen to what is being said, watch what is happening and compare 'actual' occurrences to the running sheet. The sooner you find out there is a problem, the better
- Communicate with relevant people about what is happening – this includes:
 - Informing client of problems and advising them of options or actions that will be taken in response

- Telling kitchen and other departments of changes that are necessary to previously made arrangements, times, quantities etc
- Obtaining assistance from others to help deal with, resolve or prevent a worsening of the existing problem situation
- Take immediate action – no problem will ever resolve itself. It will only compound and get worse so it is essential you take action or organise others to take action to address the identified problem.



As soon as you notice a problem or a timing issue you have to immediately begin to do something to resolve or address the situation.

A key is to be prepared yourself to jump in and do whatever is needed.

Working quickly is essential.

Using programmed decisions

Most venues who conduct regular functions will have thought through the potential for problems and issues and developed a series of 'programmed responses' to deal with many issues that can crop up when a function is being conducted.

Programmed decisions identify nominated situations and prescribe the action to be taken in response to them.

The programmed decisions should identify:

- Actions to be taken
- Responsibilities for action
- Sequence in which prescribed actions should be taken.

Programmed decisions should be considered for all predictable problems. These may be seen to include:

- Power failure
- Emergency situations including fire, gas leak, bomb threat etc. The Emergency Management Plan, which will include evacuation procedures, must be considered to ensure it remains relevant and effective when there are large numbers of people at the venue in function circumstances
- Client dissatisfied with delivery of agreed services
- Venue realisation that there is a deficit in the quality of products being provided
- Sub-standard performance by third party provider
- Technical malfunctions of IT and other equipment
- Last minute changes to agreed requirements including activities, timing, food and beverages as requested by client
- Security problems and unacceptable patron behaviour.



5.5 Manage finalisation of event and event breakdown in-line with event management plan

Introduction

As most hotels are very busy with functions and events, it is vital that any clean up is conducted in a suitable time frame which allows for the next event or function to be set up with reasonable time to spare.

Identifying time of next event or function

Any supervisor of an event must ensure what time access must be granted for preparation of the next event or function. Not only is this time required by hotel staff to set up but also for clients to set up:

- Displays - including banners, stands, product samples and in some cases vehicles
- Equipment - including computer terminals, TV screens and other audio visual equipment
- Decorations - especially for weddings
- Materials - to deliver boxes and parcels to the room and to unpack, arrange and lay out items.

A visual check must be performed at the end of an event, after all activities have been completed, to ensure the area is clean with all items placed in their appropriate locations.

This is important to ensure that no items are left behind, which could possibly be stolen and that the venue itself is locked and secure.

Ensure area is clean

There are a number of aspects that need to be checked to ensure that the event venue is clear and clean including, but not limited to:

- Tables and chairs – are clean and stored
- Equipment – is clean, operational and stored
- Food and Beverage – is stored in appropriate fridges, freezers and cupboards and locked
- Service areas – including kitchen and bars are clean, restocked and locked
- Decorations – are stored or returned
- Linen – that it is collected and placed in appropriate location
- General area – that it is clean and tidy
- Windows and doors – that they are locked
- Lighting – that all lights and air conditioners are turned off
- Lost and found items – are taken to appropriate location
- Cash takings, floats and registers – are reconciled and stored
- Client items – are packed and returned
- Keys – are signed in.

Again checklists are a great way to ensure all aspects of the closing procedure are completed.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 5.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify different types of event stakeholders
 - 5.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify what is included in an event management plan
 - 5.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify what needs to be set up when hosting a wedding
 - 5.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify ways to monitor the smooth running of an event that is in progress
 - 5.5 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify the tasks that are associated with the breakdown of an event.
-

Summary

Plan and deliver event management

Liaise with event stakeholders

- Types of assistance
- Who might be involved?
- What input can these people make?
- Why involve them?
- Obtaining advice from others.

Prepare event management plan

- Inclusions in an event management plan
- Arrange or communicate with external providers
- Preparing function sheets
- Maintaining and updating Function Sheet
- Identify and consider possible event impacts and take appropriate action to address these impacts
- Adequate notification
- Prepare, update and distribute event documentation to clients, relevant colleagues and suppliers.

Manage event set up in-line with event management plan

- Mise-en-place
- Set up policies and procedures
- Using checklists
- Planning the set-up
- Setting-up the room according to instructions
- Floor-related mise-en-place tasks
- Setting the tables
- Bar related mise-en-place task
- Organising stock
- Set up tables for event
- Prepare and organise relevant event briefings in a timely fashion.

Monitor conduct and implementation of event in-line with event management plan

- Monitoring methods
- Monitoring the function
- Taking action to address service problems
- Using programmed decisions.

Manage finalisation of event and event breakdown in-line with event management plan

- Identifying time of next event of function
- Ensure area is clean.

Element 6:

Plan and deliver event registration

6.1 Take event bookings and process event registrations

Introduction

Many events will require participants to demonstrate commitment towards it. Given the amount of time, money and effort event organisers dedicate to the successful running of an event, it is important that not only people will attend, but any demands or special requests are taken care of.

Benefits of registrations and bookings

By processing reservations and bookings an event organiser is easily able to identify:

- Who will be attending
- That their details have been accurately recorded
- If they have all the necessary information, tickets and documents that are required
- If they have paid, if required
- That any further bookings such as transport and accommodation etc have been arranged.

Types of registrations or bookings

Registrations may be required for any or all of the following:

- Travel to and from the venue
- Accommodation
- Car hire
- Meals
- Sessions/ workshops
- Pre-dinner cocktails
- Dinner with keynote speaker
- Post-meeting entertainment
- Recreational activities.



The Registration Process

Every meeting or event has a basic registration procedure. Whilst the actual events may differ the registration process is quite standardised.

1. Expression of Interest
2. Registration Brochure
3. Registration Form
4. Process Registrations
5. Registration at the event.



Expression of interest

An 'Expression of Interest' form is used to gather information of whether people would be interested in attending your event as a delegate, speaker or exhibitor.

We need to it find out the feasibility of running an event.

It is designed to ask the relevant questions or to market the event.

Whilst it can be sent at any time before the registration form and brochure are sent, it is essential there is enough time to collate the results and gather the information required to enable an event to go ahead. This can sometimes be up to 12 to 18 months before an event.

It is common for these expressions of interest to be sent to previous delegates, speakers or exhibitors. In addition it may be sent to a wide variety of potential audiences using various communication and promotional mediums.

Registration Brochure

The brochure is designed to give information.

The purpose of a registration brochure is to not only inform potential audiences of an upcoming event but appeal to their needs, either as a delegate, speaker or exhibitor.

The brochure needs to outline all information about the event and clearly explain the registration process that potential audiences can easily follow.



Registration Form

The form is designed to collect information.

The registration form or database is designed to capture all the important information relevant to guest or delegate registration for an event.

The range of services that may be required can be comprehensive, depending on the size and the nature of the event. Some events are costed as an all-inclusive package, whilst others present delegates with a range of options from which they select their requirements.

In developing a Registration Form there are many areas you must consider to assist your delegate with relevant information.

Registration Forms should also be clear and concise for those who need to process the information.

Registration form considerations

When preparing registration forms there are a number of considerations that should be taken into account to ensure the process is simple and easy to understand for the intended audience.

Considerations include:

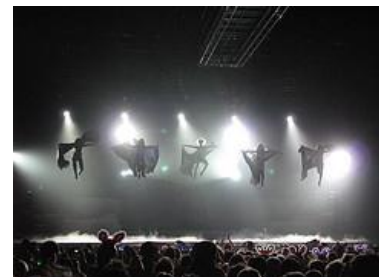
- Keep it clear and simple
- Make it easy to process
- Ensure it captures all information needed
- Ensure there is enough space for people to fill in details
- Ensure it is the appropriate size so people can easily read and follow it
- Use simple fonts
- Ensure it looks attractive with use of different colours and pictures.

Inclusions for inclusion and completion in a registration form

Naturally the information that needs to be included or collected in a registration form will differ between events however some common information is detailed below.

Event Details

- Name of the Event
- Location
- Date
- Time
- Logo
- Event organiser's details
- Contact details – address, phone etc
- Special Offer / Early bird cut off date.



Delegate details

- Titles:- Mr. Mrs. Miss. Dr. Rev. etc
- Delegate name
- Nationality – this may also include passport and visa details
- Language - this may identify need for translators
- Address- personal, residential or business address and contact
- Personal details – phone, mobile, fax, e-mail.

Types of registrations

- Early Bird Registration - Delegates are offered a discount if they pay early or by a certain date
- Full Registration - Delegate is registering for the whole conference or event program
- Member / Non-Member Registration - some organisations will offer a discount if you are a member
- Student - student price for a full registration
- Single Day Conference - fee for one day or one part of the conference or event program
- Accompanying Person Program - a charge for accompanying people to participate in certain parts of the conference or event program, sometimes these are activities organised solely for accompanying people e.g. shopping tours, beauty treatments
- Social Events or Dinners
- Exhibitor Booth
- Additional items or Merchandise.

Travel information

- Flights - Class of travel (First, Business, Economy) and Special requests (meals, seats)
- Transfers- to and from Airport, Hotel and Venue.

Accommodation

- Check in and checkout times
- Room Type – Single, Double, Executive Suite
- Tariff – Packages, Off Peak, Weekend rate
- Detailed billing instructions
- Special Conditions.



Car Hire

Normally delegates are responsible for providing their information to the hire car company; however this may be arranged by an event organiser. Information includes:

- Day, date, Arrival and Departure
- Pick up point – Drop off point
- Type of car - small, large, brand
- Features - 2 door, 4 door, auto, manual, air conditioning
- License Details
- Payment details.



Special requirements

- Special Diets
- Halal or Kosher meals
- Vegetarian and vegan meals
- Sugar free, Low fat, Gluten free
- Wheel Chair Access
- Clients with disabilities - Sight and hearing.

**Payment details**

- Methods of payment
- Time deadlines for payment
- Amount of required payment
- Cancellation Details
- Late payments.

Insurance

There are several types of insurances.

It is important to identify the types of insurance required from your delegate or organiser including:

- Personal Insurance (Delegate)
- Travel Insurance (Delegate)
- Event Insurance (Event Organiser).

TAX INVOICE for GST Purposes



Australasian Society for Ecotoxicology
2005 Conference
September 25 - 28, 2005, The University of Melbourne, Australia

Conference Registration Form

Note: All rates are quoted in Australian Dollars (AU\$).
All Registration fees include 10% GST.
A form must be completed for each registrant.

The University of Melbourne ABN: 84 002 705 224

PERSONAL DETAILS – Please print

(Ms/Mrs/Mr/Dr/Prof) Family name: _____ Given name/s: _____

Preferred name for tag: _____

Department: _____

Organisation: _____

Address: _____

City: _____ State: _____ Postcode: _____ Country: _____

Tel: (____) _____ Fax: (____) _____ Email: _____

ABSTRACT SUBMISSION

I am submitting an abstract for the conference YES / NO I prefer my presentation to be: ☐ Oral ☐ Poster Session

Abstracts must be submitted via email following the guidelines provided at www.conferences.unimelb.edu.au/ecotox/call.htm

Short title of abstract: _____

Do you wish to be considered for the ASE student prize for best paper? YES / NO

CONFERENCE REGISTRATION FEES – Please tick the appropriate box

	Early Registration (received & paid by 8 August 2005)	Standard Registration (received & paid before 21 September 2005)
ASE Member	☐ \$550	☐ \$660
Non Member	☐ \$715	☐ \$825
Student ASE Member*	☐ \$330	☐ \$385
Student Non Member*	☐ \$385	☐ \$440

On-site registration – Standard Registration fees plus additional \$110

For Day Registration Only

Single Day ASE Member	☐ \$220	☐ \$264
Single Day Non Member	☐ \$286	☐ \$330
Single Day Student ASE Member*	☐ \$165	☐ \$192
Single Day Student Non Member*	☐ \$192	☐ \$219

- If claiming MEMBERSHIP registration rates, you must have already paid your 2005/2006 ASE Membership prior to registration.

*A copy of student identification must be forwarded with the registration form to ensure eligibility for this rate.

If registering as a SINGLE DAY DELEGATE ONLY indicate the day/days you are registering for below:

- ☐ Monday 26 September
☐ Tuesday 27 September
☐ Wednesday 28 September

☒ Registration Fee AU\$ _____

NOTE: Registration fee includes morning teas, afternoon teas and lunches for all delegates.

SOCIAL FUNCTIONS**Welcome Reception** (Sun 25 September) *Included in your registration*

YES / NO

Please indicate if you will be attending the Welcome Reception at 5:30pm on Sunday 25 September at The ICT Building, The University of Melbourne.

Additional persons (not already registered) may attend the Welcome Reception at a cost of AU\$35 p/person.

Number of additional guests: _____ @ AU\$35 = Total Cost: AU\$ _____

Student Function (Mon 26 September) *Included in your registration*

YES / NO

Please indicate if you will be attending the Student Function on the evening of Monday 26 September.

Conference Dinner (Tue 27 September)

Will be held from 7pm on Tuesday 27 September at the Melbourne Aquarium.

Registered Delegate attending Conference Dinner @ AU\$93 = Total Cost: AU\$ _____

Registered Student attending Conference Dinner @ AU\$77 = Total Cost: AU\$ _____

Additional Guest attending Conference Dinner @ AU\$93 = Total Cost: AU\$ _____

B Total Social Functions Fee AU\$ _____

ACCOMMODATION

For accommodation information, please refer to the website at: www.conferences.unimelb.edu.au/ecotox/accommodation.htm

The establishments listed on this page are within a tram ride or walking distance of The University of Melbourne. Arrangements have been made for special rates for delegates attending conferences and participants are requested to make their own reservations directly with the hotels using the booking forms provided.

SPECIAL REQUIREMENTS

Special Assistance: Please indicate if you have a disability or require assistance to be able to participate fully in the Conference.

Please state the type of assistance required: _____

Dietary Requirements: We may be able to provide for special meal requirements.

Please specify if you have any: _____

Privacy: Do you agree to have your contact details included on the delegate list? ☐ Yes ☐ No

PAYMENT DETAILS (Payment of registration & social function fees **MUST** accompany this form)

A + B TOTAL PAYMENT DUE \$ _____

Payment Method - Please tick appropriate box

☐ Cheque enclosed. Cheques must be in AU\$ and made payable to **The University of Melbourne – ASE**.

☐ Payment by credit card:

☐ MasterCard ☐ Visa ☐ Bankcard

Card number: Expiry Date: /

Card holder's name [please print] _____ Signature _____

Please send registration form by mail or fax with payment in Australian Dollars (AU\$) to:

ASE 2005

Conference Management
Old Physics Building
The University of Melbourne
Victoria, Australia, 3010

Further Information: Telephone: (+61 3) 8344 6389 Fax: (+61 3) 8344 6122

Email: ecotox-2005@unimelb.edu.au Website: <http://www.conferences.unimelb.edu.au/ecotox/>

Registration Cancellation Policy

Cancellation of a registration must be notified in writing to Conference Management. Cancellations prior to 1 September 2005 will receive a full refund less \$100 administration fee. No refund will be given for cancellation after 1 September 2005, however substitutions will be possible.

Agreement to terms and conditions: I wish to register for the ASE 2005 Conference and acknowledge the registration terms including the cancellation policy.

Signature: _____

Process registrations

Once registrations have been completed and returned to organisers, either electronically or in hard copy they must be processed.

This includes the following activities:

- Enter information into database
- Send out confirmation letters, itineraries, receipts
- Make bookings with suppliers for rooms, flights, meals etc
- Identifying dietary requirements and special requests.



Taking your Registration System Online

Attendees are increasingly asking for a "self service" environment where they are not limited by office hours or the thought of having to navigate their way through a long winded automated telephone system for service.

They are demanding greater control over their registration information and the ability to amend this information at will.

Delegates or visitors can be given access using the Internet to view, change or even delete certain types of information without interaction with a meeting planner.

This innovative platform relieves meeting planners of the large workloads that would traditionally have been incurred by placing some of the load onto the attendees.

Use of databases

Data bases are used for Event Registrations for developing and collecting relevant information about delegates / exhibitors attending a particular function.

When establishing a data base for registration make sure it is appropriate for the requirements of your workplace. If a data base already exists, take some time to familiarise yourself with it. Make any recommendations to your supervisor for changes that might improve your database to tailor it to your event / conference.

There are several data base programs available on the market. Some companies prefer to develop their own system depending on the information they require.

Microsoft access is an example. To use Microsoft Access you need to open up the Access Program and click on New database. You then click on Table Wizard and it will prompt you with the possible headings for your database table. You then save your database by giving it a name.

SUMMIT Pro is another example of an Event Data Base. This Event Management system is a computer program designed to assist with the organising of Registration.

It includes the following:

- Setting up an Event
- Preparation Before an event
- Tasks during an Event
- Post Event Tasks.

6.2 Monitor on-going event registrations and take remedial action where necessary to increase attendance/registrations

Introduction

As registrations come in it is important to monitor them that the processing activities are handled in a smooth and efficient manner.

Reasons for monitoring ongoing event registration

There are endless reasons why it is important to monitor event registrations including, but certainly not limited to:

- Ensuring information is recorded accurately
- Keep track of popularity and demand for an event
- To ensure that in the case of limited spaces to an event, that action can be taken when maximum numbers have been or are nearly reached.

If there is a provision for all meeting delegates to attend every session, workshop, or recreational activity, then the only record you need to keep regarding registrations is the initial confirmation of attendance.



If there is a selection of activities from which delegates can choose, or if several activities are scheduled more than once, giving delegates alternative times, then a system must be established to ensure that activities are not overbooked

- To ensure that all delegates have received a confirmation and any other documentation that may be relevant including receipts, tickets, itineraries etc
- To ensure any further bookings that are required, such as flights, cars, accommodation or airport pickups etc
- Ensure any special or dietary requests have been passed on to the appropriate person.

Maintain accurate records

Continuous monitoring of registrations and correspondence allows accuracy in:

- Changes in the meeting program
- Late arrivals
- Catering - Costs, Extras
- Functions (Increase / Decrease in numbers)
- Program changes (Inclusions or cancellations)
- Changes in registrations
- Late requests.

Methods to monitor ongoing event registration

There are many ways to monitor event registration activities including:

- Speaking to administration staff who may be responsible for the processing of registrations and distribution of related documents
- Speaking to event organisers and clients to ensure records match or reflect accurate demand
- Reviewing data bases – identify persons who have registered
- Reviewing financial spreadsheets – identify deposits received
- Corresponding with affiliated suppliers including hotels to ensure that they have received and actioned required requests or actions such as booking accommodation rooms etc.



6.3 Finalise event registrations

Introduction

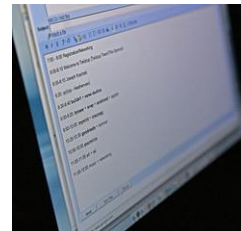
There are many activities that need to be done between taking a registration through to the opening of an event. In other sections of this manual, the operational tasks associated with physically setting up an event have been discussed, but do not take into account the handling of registration information and other arrangements that need to be made in relation to delegates or the speakers.

Types of registrations correspondence

There are many types of registration correspondence that need to be arranged in the lead up to an event. It is extremely important to maintain accurate records of any correspondence that is prepared and handled.

The following are examples of the types of records that need to be kept:

- Inward Registration Correspondence
- Letters of Confirmation
- Identify Special requirements
- Press Releases
- Refund Advice
- Conference Agenda
- Merchandise and Sales Items.



Inward Registration Correspondence

There are a number of ways to handle incoming registration information including:

- Creating a database for the event – see above
- Entering relevant details as per registration forms
- Promptly send out confirmations by mail, fax or email.

Some events have a limited number of places and are restricted by accommodation and venue capacity. Therefore, it is imperative to record bookings as they are received, to ensure that early registrations are confirmed and assured of their place.

Writing Letters of Confirmation

Once registrations have been received and input into relevant databases, they must be confirmed with the delegate or speaker. This includes:

- Identifying the Conference name, dates and venue
- Outlining what the delegate has paid for
- Confirming all the sessions, workshops, special events and catering the delegate will need to attend
- Detailing the terms and conditions for further payments
- Including any other relevant information e.g. cancellation conditions
- Listing any additional inclusions - tickets, passes etc.



On the following pages are examples of 'Letters of Confirmation' that have been prepared for different types of events.

Confirmation Letters could also be in the form of a Tax Invoice setting out what has been paid for, with an Itinerary attached showing travel, accommodation and details of what has been registered for.

INDELIBLE EVENTS PTY LTD

387 Russell Street
MELBOURNE VIC 3000
Ph: 03 8476 3876

22 May 2013

Meeting: International Diabetes Research Conference
Venue: Naranga Resort, Papua New Guinea
Date: 17 September 2013

Dear Delegate,

We have pleasure in confirming your registration for the above meeting.

We would like to draw your attention to our terms and conditions re cancellation, as you have elected not to purchase travel insurance.

Travel insurance can protect against cancellation charges and other unforeseen contingencies. We have included a brochure concerning this for your convenience. Cancellation cover is effective immediately once purchased. Please contact us if we can be of service.

If you have any concerns regarding your registration, please call.

Yours sincerely

Hereto Pleaseuwer
Registrations consultant

Enc. Itinerary

Ref: 2302

15 February 2013

Ms Kate Hyland
1 Peter Street
CHELTENHAM VIC 3022

Dear Ms Hyland

Re: AIME 2013 – The 11th Asia Pacific Incentives & Meetings Expo
23rd –24th September 2013
Melbourne Exhibition and Convention Centre

Recently you submitted a registration to attend AIME 2013. This letter confirms the receipt of that. Your Registration Number is 2302. Please quote this number when contacting the AIME Secretariat.

Exhibition Hours

23 rd September 2013	10.00am – 6.00pm
24 th September 2013	10.00am – 5.00pm

Registration Desk

To gain entry into the Exhibition you will require a Personal Access Card. This card can be collected from the AIME 2013 Registration Desk located in the Clarendon Foyer of the Melbourne Exhibition Centre and will be open between the following times:

23 rd September 2013	8.00am – 6.00pm
24 th September 2013	8.00am – 5.00pm

Business and Social Programme

An individually prepared programme itinerary indicating your confirmed selections is attached along with an official tax invoice.

Please check your details carefully and should you have any questions please do not hesitate to contact the AIME 2013 Secretariat on Tel: +61 2 9280 1295.



Reed Exhibitions Australia,
Tower 2
475 Victoria Ave
Chatswood NSW 2067
Australia.

Locked Bag 2555
Chatswood DC NSW 2067
Australia.
Tel: 02 9422 2500
Fax: 02 9422 2555
Email: aime@reedexpo.com.au

	Amount Required	Amount Owing
REGISTRATION DETAILS:		

MIAA

Member Early Rego (Paid)	750.00	0.00
(Name badge: Kate Hyland)		
Accompanying Person Early Rego (Paid)	225.00	0.00
(Name badge: Nick Hyland)		

SOCIAL FUNCTIONS:

Social Events

23/09/2013	1830	Welcome Reception (x3)	0.00	0.00
		Kate Hyland		
24/09/2013	1900	Office Party (x3) (Inclusive)	0.00	0.00
		Kate Hyland		
24/09/2013	1900	Gala Dinner (x3) (Inclusive)	0.00	0.00
		Kate Hyland		

	Amount Required	Amount Owing
REGISTRATION DETAILS:		

Social Events – Accompanying Persons

Welcome Reception –AP (Inclusive)	0.00	0.00
Nick Hyland		
Office Party –AP (Inclusive)	0.00	0.00
Nick Hyland		
Gala Dinner –AP (Inclusive)	0.00	0.00
Nick Hyland		

ACCOMMODATION RESERVATION:

Parkroyal Canberra

1 Bingara Street

Canberra City

Tel: 02 62478999

Room Type: Standard Room (Paid)	145.00	0.00
---------------------------------	--------	------

Check in: 20th Sep, 2013

Check out: 24th Sep, 2013

Daily Tariff: \$145.00

Sharing with: Nick Hyland (AP)

EVENT 201328th – 31st October 2013**Itinerary for Mr William Baggins**

Listed below are all your travel and accommodation bookings.

Please check them carefully and let me know as soon as possible any discrepancies.

Tuesday October 2013: Qantas QF40

Class: Economy

Departs: Sydney 09:00 AM **Arrives:** Gold Coast on 28 October 2013 at 10.35 AM

The Majestic Hotel

3045 Main Road

SURFERS PARADISE QLD 4606

Phone: (07) 4567 8910

Fax: (07) 4567 8911

Room Type: Deluxe Suite

Check In: 28 October 2013 **Check Out:** 30 October 2013

31 October 2013: Virgin Blue DJ74

Class: Economy

Departs: Gold Coast 06:00 PM **Arrives:** Sydney on 31 October 2013 at 08:00 PM

Thank you for your support of our conference. We look forward to meeting you.

Kind regards,

Mary-Jane Evans (Miss)

Chief Conference Organiser

The Conference Secretariat Phone: + 61 (0)3 9400 4556

Level 2, 3455 McCafferty Street

Fax: + 61 (0)3 9400 4557

PORT MELBOURNE VIC 3207

E-Mail: hettie-theseecretariat@conference.net.au

AUSTRALIA

Web Page: www.conference.com.au

GST Number: 12-345-678

Identify Special Requirements

It is important that any special requests are identified and arranged accordingly. This can include, but certainly not limited to:

- Special diets
- Interpreters
- Hearing impairments
- Wheelchair access
- Parking requests
- Security issues.



Press Releases

Press Releases can form an important part of communicating to people new information, updates, reminders or general information.

This can be done through:

- Letters
- Newsletter
- E-mails
- Website updates
- Text Messages
- Newspaper
- Magazines
- Radio.



On the following pages are examples of press releases for different events.

PRESS RELEASE

Conference: Women in Business
Venue: Cato Conference Centre, Melbourne
Date: 2 October 2013

Special guest speaker: Paul Clitheroe

Paul Clitheroe is a founding member of IPAC Securities, one of Australia's best known investment houses. Since June 1993 he has been host of Channel 9's program *Money*. Paul is regarded as a leading expert in the field of personal investment strategies.

Paul will present a range of money management strategies, designed especially for women in business and will focus on women and international business opportunities in the next century.

Early Bird Booking Special

Book before 20 August 2013 and receive a free copy of his new book

Paul will be available for book signing on the night.

Don't delay! **BOOK NOW!**

Horseland

Melbourne International Three Day Event 2013

5th – June 9th 2013

Werribee Park National Equestrian Centre

STOP PRESS – STOP PRESS – STOP PRESS

Horseland Melbourne International Three Day Event 2013, being held at Werribee Park from June 5th – June 9th is going to be the most spectacular and exciting one ever.

The event will be host to the CIC-W World Cup Qualifier, an Australian first. This is one of two qualifiers (Warwick QLD will be the second) for the CIC World Cup Final in Pau, France later in 2013. The EFA High Performance Fund will fly the combination from both events to France.

The CIC-W is similar to the new Olympic format that will be introduced. The event begins with the dressage on Saturday June 7 and concludes with the jumping final on Monday June 9.

This year's event will also include an all-star line up for the Master Class to be conducted on Saturday June 7 in the indoor arena. The floor will be graced by the expertise of Jean Mitchell, who was president of the Ground Jury at WEG in Spain, Kentucky and the infamous Badminton last year. Jean Mitchell, all the way from Ireland is the Director of Punchestown Horse Trials, including the 2013 European Eventing Championships. She will also be president of the ground jury at this year's Horseland Melbourne International Three Day Event.

Accompanying Jean Mitchell is our own Olympic Gold Medallist Gill Rolton and Barry Roycroft, part of the fabulous Roycroft clan and coach of three Olympic Gold Medal winning teams

International course designer Michael Creber, who is responsible for courses such as Adelaide Horse Trials and Spray Farm, has totally reworked the Melbourne course this year. The superb Mansion Gardens have been opened up to more fences, and the crowd drawing Lake Complex has been reintroduced with significant new fences and a crossing.

Sunday June 8 will be an important day on cross country for the many riders vying for positions on the upcoming Olympic team. The best position to view all the action will be from the Equimax Gold Class Water Complex Tent.

Equimax Gold Pass's admit entry on all days, and give you prime reserved seating indoors, entry to the masterclass with the Ground Jury a program on arrival as well as the opportunity to meet some of Australia's most famous riders. Tickets to the Gold Class can still be purchased, but don't miss out!

Watch this space to find out which famous Australian Eventers will be in the Masterclass...

MEDIA CONTACT: Gitte Donvig ph: 0417 600 410 Email: gittedonvig@hotmail.com

MEDIA INFORMATION**Harvest Picnic Foundation****'THE AGE HARVEST PICNIC AT HANGING ROCK'****Sunday 24 February 2013**

Wholeheartedly embracing the notion of the ancient harvest, this year's Harvest Picnic will expand its focus and celebrate all that the good earth provides. Gathering at the natural amphitheatre of large granite boulders and gum trees at Hanging Rock Woodend, small food and wine producers will offer their finely crafted produce.

Over 35,000 people are anticipated at this single event where over 100 separate small producers offer their exquisite preparations, secret family recipes, jams and chutneys poured straight from the much-loved copper of a local country kitchen. Produce, painstakingly tended in chemical-free soils, berries, olive oils, yabby pies and local beers will also be available - all small, select and uniquely created with care and consideration. Roving performers, stage performers and celebrity chefs will add to the sensory mix.

The Harvest Picnic provides the perfect opportunity for Victorian and interstate boutique producers to showcase the enormous range and high quality of their food.

The Harvest Picnic is organised by the Harvest Picnic Foundation, a non-profit organisation. First held twenty five years ago, each year the Harvest Picnic continues to grow in popularity with both the public and the producers, who relish the opportunity to showcase their specialty food and beverages. Today it is Australia's largest and most famous food and wine festival, helping to foster the growing vitality and innovation of the Victorian food and wine industry, and providing a successful model that has spawned a plethora of similar festivals in the State.

'The Age Harvest Picnic at Hanging Rock' 24 February 2013.

Adults: \$17.00

Concession & group bookings (10 or more people): \$13.00

Children under 15: free

Buses will run from Melbourne: \$25 return.

Tickets and transportation booked through RACV Ticketing: 13 28 86

Group bookings only through HPF office: 03 9555 0253

FOR FURTHER MEDIA INFORMATION

Sharon Wells (03) 9417 4665 M: 0419 508 619

GENERAL ENQUIRIES

Harvest Picnic Foundation (03) 9555 0253 www.harvestpicnic.com.au

Refund Advice

In some cases a refund will need to be provided to people for a number of reasons that may include, but not limited to:

- Inability to attend
- Unable to attend specific activities on an event
- Over payments.

Regardless of the reason for the refund it is important to ensure that correct person and the correct amount has been refunded.

There may be cancellation fees that may apply. This is why it is important that delegates understand the various types of cancellation fees that may apply. These are normally issues in 'Terms & Conditions' as part of the registration process.

No refund should be issued without the relevant tickets, coupons or vouchers having first been returned. Refunds should be issued and accompanied by a letter, suitably composed, to detail amounts paid by clients, deductions made for cancellation fees, and amount of balance to be forwarded to the client.

Refunds are usually completed and processed at the end of a conference or an event.

Refund advice

Please accept our refund cheque for \$3,150.00 representing refund as follows:

Prepayment of	\$3500.00
Less 10% cancellation fee	<u>\$350.00</u>
Balance / Refund	\$3150.00

Yours sincerely

Hereto Pleaseuwer

Registrations consultant

Enc. Cheque

As well as the refund notice, you should send a new confirmation letter or itinerary.

PHARMACEUTICALS CONFERENCE 2013

Grand Hyatt
Melbourne
14th & 15th April 2013

10 September 2012
Mr William J. Smith
General Manager
Pharmaceuticals Division
The Corporate Chemical Company
Level 33, The Highland Building
101 Collins Street
MELBOURNE VIC 3000

REFUND NOTICE

Dear William
Enclosed is your refund. Please check the details carefully.

1 x City Sights Tour	\$150.00
1 x T-shirt	<u>\$16.00</u>
Refund amount	\$166.00

Current Financial Status

Total Due	Already Paid	This Payment	Total Paid	Still Owing
\$21,182.50	\$21,348.50	(\$166.00)	\$21,182.50	\$0.00

If you have any queries, please call me immediately.

Kindest regards,

Archie Davies
Conference Organiser

JH Special Events
Suite 17, 500 Bourke Street
MELBOURNE VIC 3001
AUSTRALIA
ABN: 4754 5252 1254 12

Phone: + 61 (0)3 9400 4556
Fax: + 61 (0)3 9400 3455
E-Mail: archied@jhevents.com.au
Web Page: www.jhevents.com.au

Conference Agenda / Event Program

A Conference Agenda / Event Program is another way to inform delegates and guests what is happening during a meeting or event.

The Agenda / Program should highlight:

- Event Name, Address & Date
- Timing for each of the sessions / demonstrations / bands
- What room or where the functions will be held in
- Who is speaking at each session and their credentials.

Conference Agenda

Meeting: International Diabetes Research Conference

Venue: Naranga Resort, Papua New Guinea

Date: 17 July 2013

Time	Activity	Speaker	Location
8.45am	Registration		Foyer 1
9.00am	Welcome and opening	Dr Lapton	Fern Room
10.30am	Morning Tea		Foyer 2
10.50am	Guest Lecturer	Ms J Aaron	Lecture Theatre
12.00pm	Breakout sessions		Restaurant
1.00pm	Lunch		The Queen's Room
2.00pm	Speaker	Prof. G Lui	Lecture Theatre
3.45pm	Afternoon tea		Foyer 2
4.05pm	Speaker	Mr Disdall	Lecture Theatre
5.30pm	Closing remarks	Ms Orr	Fern Room
5.45pm	Pre-dinner cocktails		Cocktail Bar
7.30pm	Formal Dinner		Main Ballroom
9.15pm	After dinner speaker	Prof. N. Upton	
11.30pm	Finish		

Merchandise / Sales Items

Flyers and letters displaying merchandise can often be distributed with other correspondence before an event.

Sales items at a Meeting

Meeting: Australian Business Women's Network (ABWN)
Venue: Cato Conference Centre, Melbourne
Date: 2 February 2013

Dear Members

Due to popular demand a range of promotional items, with the association's logo, have been produced for purchase by members, and will be available at the above conference. In addition to these, a range of books, written by some of the guest speakers, will also be on sale.

For your convenience, the following price list has been prepared. Note that credit card facilities will be available and business cheques will also be accepted.

ABWN satchel	\$120.90
ABWN pen set	\$ 87.20
ABWN business card folder	\$ 12.50
ABWN road directory cover	\$ 27.00
ABWN umbrella	\$ 36.00
ABWN motivational desk calendar	\$ 18.95
<i>Women and Business</i> – Taylor Struiknberg	\$ 12.95
<i>Competitive Marketing</i> – Myra Challis	\$ 16.95
<i>Lipstick Strategies</i> – Channel Byron	\$ 9.95

We trust this information will be useful to you, and look forward to facilitating a memorable experience for you.

6.4 Produce identified event materials for guests and delegates

Introduction

Once registrations that are made in advance have been made it is now time to prepare event materials in which guests and delegates may require as part of the event.

Not only do these items need to be prepared in advance for pre-registered guests but anticipated registrations made on the day must also be considered.

Given that many event materials may be prepared by external suppliers, this process must be well managed and conducted with sufficient time to spare.

Conference Kit

What items or details could you provide to Delegates upon arrival?

Include such items as:

- Document Case / Satchel
- Name Badge
- Pens and Pads
- Sponsors Inserts
- Floor Plans / Venue Site Plan
- Final Program notices
- Promotional Material
- Exhibitors Brochures
- Delegate List
- Exhibitor List
- Speaker's papers.



Satchels

Include such items as:

- Notepad and pen
- Final program
- Sponsor's material
- Event pre-prints
- Floor plan.



Steps to arranging satchels:

- Order your satchels well in advance to allow for any delay in manufacturing or printing
- Pre-plan time to ensure all the materials to be enclosed arrive on time
- Prepare a checklist for all items to go into the satchel
- Organise a team of people to assist with filling the satchels.



Promotional Items

Many organisers produce a range of items that bear the name, theme and logo of the Conference, often these are giveaways.

Some of the items that you choose can be used for competitions throughout the conference or you may be able to use them as an Ice Breaker between Conference Sessions.

Creativity is a main ingredient for these gifts. For example, puzzles which need all delegates' participation to solve.

Promotional material is usually provided by the organisation producing the Conference.

A range of meeting items is usually produced with themes or logos printed on them. They may include:

- Brochures, posters, stickers
- Caps
- Jackets
- Notepads
- Pens
- Novelty items
- Mouse Pads
- Drink holders
- Golf balls.



Merchandise and sales items

Many event organisers will produce a range of items to sell as merchandise.

These will also bear the name, theme and logo of the Event.

They can be sold on a web site before and during an event as merchandise.

They can be sold at the event because delegates often express an interest in purchasing additional items for various reasons.

Name Badges

These are an essential part of an Event / Conference.

They are used to verify that the people who attend are the people who have registered and paid.

Considerations when preparing name badges

- First name is in larger print
- Is the first name the preferred name
- Do you Highlight Company Name or Position on the badge
- Do you need the logo of the event
- Should it clip on or be on a lanyard
- What is the Badge made of
- The cost of the Badges
- Is there a swipe facility need on the Badge for security or information.

		
Standard Holder - with metal swivel clip 90mm x 104mm Holder	Holder - with hard pin and clip 90mm x 58mm	Holder- 2 pocket (no category tag pocket) 98mm x 150mm
		
Holder - 3 pocket (with category tag pocket) 98mm x 175mm	Holder - 3 pocket with a pen slot 126mm x 152mm	Badges or Card Name Tags

Magnetic Strip Badges

A magnetic strip badge stores all the visitor details directly on the magnetic strip on the back of the card, like a normal credit card stores the relevant details of the user. Research has shown that today's credit card society identifies with the plastic card and people are more likely to retain it for future use, enhancing the attendance ratio of those visitors who pre-register.

The plastic card is specifically designed for the particular event enabling an opportunity to offer special sponsorships or to simply publicise the event. The card is sturdy and can sit in the visitor's wallet acting as a constant reminder of the event.

A label is affixed to the front of the card, usually below the event information, with the name and organisation, or other details of your choice, clearly printed.

A range of sizes can be selected. Clear plastic labels can be provided to enhance the badge if required.

The card slips easily into a choice of plastic holders. The plastic holders can have colour coded identifiers to indicate exhibitors, visitors or any other group.

Entrance staff scan the card by one of our special gates and the visitor quickly enters the event. Their entry is now recorded.

Exhibitors benefit by using our tracker devices to instantly obtain all the details of the visitor attending their stand from the information encoded on the magnetic strip.

Bar-coded Badges

Hard paper coloured cards are printed with the name and organisation of the visitor. Instead of a magnetic strip containing all the information on the visitor they contain a barcode. This barcode allows us to cross match their bar-coded identification number with our main system.

You can choose from a range of colours and the event may have a variety of cards produced to indicate different groups of people attending, such as exhibitors, visitors, staff and VIPs.

The card has the visitor's name printed in the size of your choice along with any other information you require. Underneath this the individual's unique identification is printed as a barcode and in number. A barcode entrance scanner is used to register entry of all attendees and once downloaded into our system will provide us with the necessary information to produce attendance reports. The scanner is staffed by our trained entrance control personnel. Exhibitors can use special barcode reader pens to record the identification number and the visitor details.

Smart Chip Name Badges

Smart card name badges are produced in the same way as the magnetic strip. The benefit is that the chip on the smart card can contain large amounts of information. The chip also allows for a debit or credit type system. This allows you to continue to track visitors or delegates to sites in remote locations in potentially non-related situations.

A variety of badges and labels can be provided. You have a choice of information printed on the card presented in the size and format you wish. Labels can be either paper or transparent film or the name and other details can be printed directly onto the card. Cards can be one or multiple colours - even gold.

Card can have additional information printed on the back such as venues, dates and opening and closing times of the event.

Holders

There are a variety of holders for to choose from. Holders can have plastic or metal clips. They can have additional inserts to indicate the type of visitor, such as Visitor or Exhibitor.

Conference attendees can have a multiple pocket holder to include their name badge, a pen and a pocket conference schedule.

Lanyards

Lanyards can be attached to a plastic holder before your event or they can be handed to visitors on arrival at the event.

Lanyards can be custom printed with your logo and event name or sponsor's logo and name.



Elastic Strings

Elastic strings can be attached to a plastic holder before your event. They are then handed to visitors on arrival at the event.

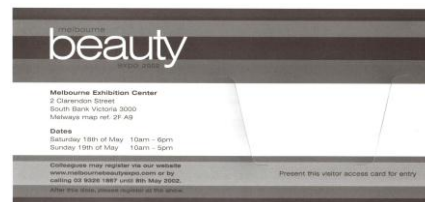


Category Tags

Category tags are used to differentiate between various people attending the conference or exhibition i.e. Visitors, Exhibitors. The tags fit neatly into plastic holders that are worn by attendees at the event.

Card and carriers

Cards are placed into carriers and distributed through the mail to pre-registered visitors to events. The carrier is the ideal way to provide information on an event or membership. You can design your carrier or Info Salons can produce a simple carrier for you.



Service vouchers

Service vouchers are internal vouchers prepared by the venue for distribution to guests, delegates or attendees at a function.

The service vouchers entitle the holder to the products or services as listed on the voucher (and as arranged with the client to be part of the function) free of charge.

For example, guests who are staying in-house may be entitled to a free breakfast – a service voucher may be issued to all such guest. When they arrive at the dining room for breakfast they hand over their voucher and it takes the form of legitimate payment.

Service vouchers may be issued for almost any product or service the venue supplies (providing it has been arranged with and paid for by the client). Examples of the use of service vouchers include:

- Free meals
- Free drinks at the bar
- Free use of facilities
- Free spa treatment
- Free tours/trips.



Other event materials

There are endless event materials that may need to be prepared before an event. Some other items which have not been previously mentioned include:

- Informational reports
- T-shirts
- Stationery
- Spare supplies
- Materials for sale – including cash register/credit card facilities
- Audio visual aids.



6.5 Coordinate and process guest and delegate registration at the event

Introduction

Whilst many registrations will take place in advance of an event following procedures explained in previous sections, it is not uncommon for events to accept registrations on the day of the event itself.

In addition, materials may need to be handed out on arrival to those who may have pre-registered.

This section will explore some of the steps associated with managing a registration desk at the event itself.

The Registration Desk

The Registration desk is the first point of contact and introduction to the event. Generally the registration area would be in the foyer of a venue or right inside the event room.

Not only are the professional opinions of you as an event organiser formed at this point, but also of the organisation or association hosting the event.

The registration Desk area is a focal point for everyone involved including:

- Venue
- Committee
- Presenters / Guest Speakers
- Sponsors
- Exhibitors
- Delegates
- Accompanying Persons
- VIP's / Guests.



Considerations when choosing the Registration Area

There are many considerations when choosing the registration area including:

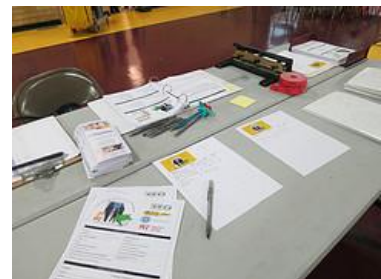
- How large a registration area is needed?
- Is area large enough to accommodate long lines?
- Where will the registration desk be located?
- Can you use this area for the entire conference?
- If not, where is the secondary site?
- Will facility supply sufficient tables and desks?
- Can the setup be dismantled easily if necessary?
- Are phone jacks and phones available if needed?
- Is lighting adequate for typing and writing?
- If not, will facility supplement with additional lamps?
- Is there a place to hang organisation's banner, logo or convention sign?
- Will registration desk be operational for entire convention?
- What days/hours will registration desk be open?
- Can someone be reached after closing hours?



Discuss requirements with Venue Management

It is important to discuss with the Venue Management all the requirements for the Registration Area including:

- Location
- Size of desk
- Covering of Desk
- Number of Power Points
- Access times
- Storage space for back-up materials
- Security of the desk over night, etc
- Rubbish Bin
- Is there enough room for Delegates to line up?
- External Phones / Phone access to the venue staff
- Is the Registration desk easy to find
- Sponsorship / banners / flags.



Preparing for registrations

It is essential to ensure that all the equipment required for an Event / Conference Registration Area is available on the day.

Registration Desk Material / Equipment required

A FULL RANGE OF STATIONERY ITEMS: Pens – different colours Highlighters Sticky tape / masking tape Blu-tack / Glue Velcro Overhead transparencies and pens Envelopes Conference letterhead Scissors / Ruler String / Rubber / Whiteout Stapler / staples Hole punch Rubber bands / Thumb tacks Message pads Note pads Blank registration forms Event note book Calculator	BANKING DETAILS: Credit card / EFTPOS Vouchers / machines Receipts / invoices Contact details of credit institutions Petty cash vouchers Cash tin BASIC FIRST AID KIT GENERAL INFORMATION Original completed rego forms Delegate name badges All delegate correspondence All venue correspondence Committee minutes Accommodation lists and contacts Functions lists
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Registration desk requirements for different types of events

The following examples relate to different types of events. As can be seen there are many items that must be considered and therefore it is essential plenty of pre-thought and preparation goes into the process.

Conferences

- Name tags prepared in numerical or alphabetical order
- Clear registrations signage / other signage
- Adequate Staff to look after attendees
- List of registrations for all staff
- Satchels / handouts / agenda
- Queuing issues
- Late registrations desk
- Security of money obtained through late registration
- Undercover for registration facilities
- Relief staff for registration
- Food and beverage for staff
- Telephone
- Computer / Laptop
- Uniform (dress code).



Exhibitions

- Name tags / Pins / lanyards
- Tags in alphabetical order
- Double check tags to listing
- Coffee / tea facilities
- Cloak room
- Delegate bags
- Maps / agenda / event manual / program
- Signage
- Walkie talkies/mobile phone (for rego people)
- Roster for staff
- Staff briefing
- Registration table / chairs / branding
- Separate Desk for Tour bookings / On the Day Registrations.



Sports events

- Staff registration /brief
- Registration of volunteers
- List of volunteers
- Set up with T-shirts/ID badges
- Staff brief.



Competitors

- List of registrations for all staff
- T-shirts/ tags / ID badges prepared / Numbers.

Guidelines to preparing a registration desk

Plan early

- Never leave things to the last minute.

Double check materials prior to an event

- Once the conference starts you cannot leave the registration desk to chase down equipment
- It looks unprofessional if things are missing.

Have all relevant material sent out prior to the Event as part of their Confirmation of Registration

- For example, how much of the Conference/Event they plan to attend, the workshops, the social functions, tours, accommodation, travel bookings and details about their payment position
- This will help to minimise the number of confused and sometimes, angry delegates.

Prepare Stationery

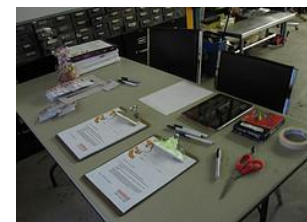
- Pens, pencils etc.

Ready Processing Equipment and Lists

- This includes Registration Lists, Computers etc.

Ready Accounting Records

- Credit Card Documentation
- A cash float and Cash tin
- Receipt books
- Statements for each delegate
- Security if large amounts of cash are handled
- Keeping record of any changes such as cancellation, change of address, and change of accommodation.



Prepare Signage

Clear and well located signs will alleviate confusion.

What signage would you need for an event including the Registration Area?

- **Directional** - 'Child Minding this way'... includes off site directional signage to the event
- **Operational** - 'You are here' includes information signs and maps
- **Statutory** (regulation/warning) - 'Fire Exits' - this includes special one off warning signs 'Slippery Floor'
- **Facility** - 'Toilets' 'Bar' 'Stage 1' includes identification signs such as 'entrance'. The entrance is an important sign as it may create the first impression of the event site and establish the type/style of signs in the minds of the audience.



Other signs include sponsors' signs, promotion signs, notifications and more general information ('Come back next year').

Checklist for Event Signs

- Site/venue sign location map - where are you going to put them
- What types of signs needed?
- Placement of signs
- Resource assessment for signs
- Registration signs
- Queuing signs
- Exit
- Entry
- Wheelchair / Disabled access
- Toilets
- Fire Extinguishers
- Emergency exits
- Exhibitor signs
- Workshop rooms – clearly labelled.



Occupational Safety and Health considerations

What checks would need to take place?

- Ensure all Exit signs are visible and doors are kept clear
- Check Meeting rooms all have emergency lighting
- Audio visual chords are covered for safety
- Check disability facilities
- Double check that any overhead displays are securely fastened
- Check the location of fire exits
- Take care when moving large, heavy boxes.



What hazards could be present?

- Spillages (coffee, water on floor near registration area)
- Uneven surfaces (can cause tripping).

Handling queues

- How many queues and possible bottlenecks will there be?
- Have adequate personnel greeters, crowd controllers, ticket collectors and security been allocated?
- Is signage (including the estimated waiting time) in place?
- When will the queues form? Will they form at once or over a period of time?
- How can the perceived waiting time be reduced? e.g. queue entertainers
- What first aid, access and emergency procedures are in place?
- Are the lighting, sun and rain protection adequate?
- Are crowd friendly barricades and partitions in place?
- Are toilets, food and water needed?
- Are different booths needed for different payment methods or prepaid?
- You never get away from queuing and yet very little thought goes into it.



Safety at the registration area

- Always set up early
- Always look and act professionally
- Keep Registration Area clean and tidy
- Be well groomed, polite and helpful
- Set up an effective working layout in which to operate.

Considerations when setting up the desk

- How much space do you have at the registration desk?
- Is the desk in the location initially agreed?
- Are there power connections available in the registration area?
- Do you have telephone access for national and international calls?
- Is the area secure for equipment?
- Have you checked the equipment to make sure it is working?
- Has all the registration material been set up, such as, name tags, satchels, papers, receipt books, stationery, back up supplies?
- Do you have back up equipment or manual methods you can put into place in the event of break-downs?

The registration process

1. Give each person a friendly welcome
2. Ask for their names and/or copy of their confirmation letter or invitation
3. Find their envelope with name badge and function tickets and confirm these are correct as you hand them to delegates
4. Explain briefly what information is in the satchel
5. Advise when and where the first session is to take place or how the exhibition works
6. Advise of any changes to the program or additional information they may need to know
7. Wish them an enjoyable time and advise that you will be there to answer any questions.



Variations to a Normal Registration

Not all registrations will run as expected. There will always be variations that must be considered. Following are common variations that may occur at events.

A delegate has registered but not paid

- The answer to this depends upon the payment policy
- You should have identified the delegate as owing money and have an invoice showing the total cost and a breakdown of amounts owing
- You could have telephoned delegate prior to the Event to confirm details and ask for payment.

A delegate has not registered but turns up on the day

- If there is room and functions are not affected by variations in numbers, welcome them and have them complete a registration form, with payment
- Prepare a Name Badge and supply them with a satchel, and treat the delegate as a normal registration.

A delegate has registered but you do not have any information or details for him/her

- Apologise, check the original registration forms to see if it was an oversight
- Ask them for a copy of their confirmation / registration form
- Efficiently process the registration, apologise again and try to make them feel special
- Double check your list to see why they were missed.

A delegate now advises he/she cannot go to a function or now wishes to attend a function previously declined

- If cancelling a function, delegates will usually forfeit his/her payment as final numbers are confirmed at least 48 hours prior to a function
- If wishing to attend a new function, this will depend on space available, particularly when catering is involved.

Use a registration checklist

Meeting Planner's Registration Desk Checklist / Brief

Registration Desk Functions	Brief
Welcome attendees	
Distribute convention material	
Register delegates	
Collect fees and money (if applicable)	
Provide convention information	
Sign-ups for seminar programs	
Sign-ups for recreation/sight-seeing tours	
Sign-ups for spouse programs	
Sell tickets to banquet and food functions (if applicable)	
Arrange transportation	
Act as a message centre	
Sell association publications	
Provide first aid information	
Give directions	

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 6.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify steps associated with handling event registrations
 - 6.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain why it is important to monitor the progress of registrations on a regular basis
 - 6.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify documents used to help finalise registrations
 - 6.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify event materials that need to be prepared before an event
 - 6.5 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify considerations when setting up a registration table.
-

Summary

Plan and deliver event registration

Take event bookings and process event registrations

- Benefits of registrations and bookings
- Types of reservations or bookings
- The Registration Process
- Expression of interest
- Registration Brochure
- Registration Form
- Inclusions for inclusion and completion in a registration form
- Process registrations.

Monitor on-going event registrations and take remedial action where necessary to increase attendance/registrations

- Reasons for monitoring ongoing event registration
- Maintain accurate records
- Methods to monitor ongoing event registration.

Finalise event registrations

- Types of registrations correspondence
- Inward Registration Correspondence
- Writing Letters of Confirmation
- Identify Special Requirements
- Press Releases
- Refund Advice
- Conference Agenda / Event Program
- Merchandise / Sales Items.

Produce identified event materials for guests and delegates

- Conference Kit
- Satchels
- Promotional Items
- Merchandise and sales items
- Name Badges
- Carriers
- Service vouchers
- Other event materials.

Coordinate and process guest and delegate registration at the event

- The Registration Desk
- Considerations when choosing the Registration Area
- Discuss requirements with Venue Management
- Preparing for registrations
- Registration desk requirements for different types of events
- Guidelines to preparing a registration desk
- Prepare Signage
- Occupational Safety and Health considerations
- The registration process
- Variations to a Normal Registration
- Use a registration checklist.

Element 7:

Plan and deliver infrastructure for outdoor event

7.1 Identify necessary infrastructure requirements

Introduction

Many events are held outdoors as they provide a unique experience which takes advantage of natural beauty and creates a special ambiance which cannot be found indoors.

Given that events can be conducted in any location, there are infrastructure needs that need to be considered, especially events that are conducted in remote, new or outdoor locations.



When events are conducted in established hotels infrastructure to support events is already in place, so these do not need a great deal of consideration, planning or organising.

Infrastructure requirements can be expected to vary widely between venues/sites and depending on the size, scope and nature of the event.

Whilst they seem to be less exciting aspects of an event to organise, they are absolutely essential parts of an event.

Outdoor event considerations

There are some initial questions that you can consider that may help with the planning of outdoor events and the infrastructure required. These questions include:

- Will you be serving food, beverage or alcohol at your event?
- Will you need infrastructure including tables, chairs, stage, grounds keeping, toilets etc
- Will you need a tent, sheltered or enclosed space?
- Will you need to utilise a sound system? Will you need production services to support your event including LCD screens, microphones, speakers, amplifiers etc
- Will you sell merchandise at the event?
- Is the event open to the public? Will children be present without their parents?
- Will you need security?
- Will you require transportation, traffic and parking support?
- Will you be showing a film or having entertainment?



- Will you be selling tickets for your event?
- Do you have a backup plan for inclement weather?
- Will a permit or special license be required
- Will there be local council restrictions that apply in relation to what can be sold or supplied, food standards, hours of operation etc?

Types of infrastructure requirements

Whilst there are endless types of infrastructure requirements, some common ones include:

Power and water supply

Most events need some power or water supply. This is used for:

- Lighting
- Emergency Lighting
- Toilets
- Cooking and cleaning
- Equipment.



Food and beverage equipment

There is no doubt that with many outdoor events the provision of food and beverage is a necessity. With the provision of food and beverage comes the need for equipment including:

- Cooking equipment – ovens, stoves, microwaves, shelving, washing stations, preparation and service tables to name but a few
- Beverage equipment – fridges, freezers (also used for food), blenders, ice machines, beer kegs and mechanisms to name a few.

Tables, chairs and related items

If food and beverage is to be served, there will no doubt be the need for tables, chairs, crockery, cutlery, glassware, candles, service stations and service equipment.

Environmental control

It is important that the holding of an event does not cause damage to the environment or become a disturbance to local residents. Therefore measures must be put in place when managing.

This includes:

- Air conditioning
- Sound
- Lighting
- Privacy
- Fencing and security
- Screening from public gaze/access.



Toilets

Toilet facilities are an essential part of every event. Care must be given to the set up, management and removal of facilities and human waste.



Emergency services

As part of a contingency program, adequate thought must be given to the use of emergency services.

These services can include:

- Fire
- Medical
- Police
- First Aid kits.



Car and coach parking

It is unlikely that guests will arrive to an event on foot, therefore consideration must be paid to access to parking of vehicles.

Thought must also be given to the integration with other transport options, including public transport systems.

Disabled access

Special thought must be given to access to various event locations for disabled patrons. This might include the need for dedicated parking areas, ramps or designated seating areas.

Signage

Signage is an essential part of an event which not only identifies an event and the key attraction locations, but also provides vital information in relation to toilets, medical facilities, exits, policies and procedures and event information.

Signage and other arrangements must also consider the needs of people who may have language difficulties or barriers.

Waste management

At every event some element of waste will build up. It is important that plans are put into place for the storage and removal of waste from a venue location.

It is important to have cleaning services, grounds keeping functions, waste bins and recycling containers.

Animals and insects

Whether it be spiders, flies, mosquitoes, baboons or other animals and insects it is wise to prepare for them. It may be a case of supplying repellent, citronella candles through to spraying or having fly covers for food.

Weather considerations

If an event is to be held outdoors, considerations and contingencies must be made in the event of rain, extreme sunshine, heat or inclement weather. This could be the need for:

- Tents
- Marquees / pavilions
- Side screens
- Indoor venue as an alternative
- Rain equipment or clothing – in the event of gold events where the whole location cannot be covered
- Air-conditioners – in the event of hot weather
- Portable heaters – in the event of cold weather
- Sunscreen
- Additional water.



Entertainment infrastructure

In many outdoor events and festivals some form of entertainment may be arranged ranging from a speaker to make announcements through to elaborate rock concert settings.

This equipment is often sourced by specialist providers or by companies who conduct the complete set up and breakdown.

Equipment can include:

- Staging
- Lighting
- Fireworks
- Speakers
- Flood lights
- Electrical wiring and provision
- Back stage areas and portable rooms
- Seating for the audience.



There are endless types of infrastructure that can be utilised for an event.

7.2 Organise identified infrastructure needs

Introduction

As can be seen there are many different types of infrastructure that is needed for an outdoor event. Regardless of the items required, sufficient planning needs to be done to ensure that:

- The right items are identified
- They are available
- They are within budget
- They can be delivered, set up and dismantled at the appropriate times
- Any additional services that are required can be provided.

Prepare a plan

Naturally some infrastructure items will be required for instillation before others. For example it is no point delivering food and beverage until electricity is established and fridges have been installed.

It is important to logically think through which items will be required in a sequential order.

Identify suppliers

In many cases external suppliers will be required for the provision of infrastructure.

It is important to:

- Identify reputable suppliers from a variety of sources including past experiences, existing suppliers, industry contacts, industry associations and word of mouth. Naturally the internet is the fastest way of identifying a wide range of suppliers
- Where possible, meet with potential suppliers to ensure they are fully briefed on what is required for the event. This may also involve visiting the actual site where the event will take place
- Obtain a minimum of three quotations
- Identify their service guarantees
- Obtain references and follow up with them to find out how their service has been in previous events.



Arrange delivery dates and times

Once the suppliers have been selected it is important to identify the correct time and dates for which the infrastructure will not only be delivered but also picked up after the event.

It is important to ensure that any pre-requisite infrastructure is in place and that the delivery of one type of infrastructure does not clash with the delivery of the other.



Provide access and security details

Where the client or their personnel require access to the venue an access and security list will identify:

- Dates and times involved
- Locations which access is sought
- Names of those nominated by the client as authorised to access the venue – in practice, no-one should be given access to the venue unless their name is on this list
- Registration numbers of vehicles
- The jobs they will be doing for the function.



Note it is standard practice for security staff to have the right to search vehicles and personnel leaving the venue area.

It may be standard procedure for anyone accessing the venue who is not a staff member to be allocated a 'visitor' identification tag. This may identify the areas within the venue to which the holder has authority to enter.

Where the client has provided strict directions about who may enter a function/event the details on this list can include:

- Names of those who are authorised to enter – this may be accompanied by photo ID
- Names of those specifically identified as not being authorised to enter. This can occur when the client believes the function is likely to be targeted by a person or group who could disrupt or pose a threat to the occasion. There will usually be a photograph of these people with a brief outline regarding what type and level of threat they pose.

Access and security details can also cover:

- Establishment of communication and command centres for large functions
- Provision of suitable communication devices to security staff and, where appropriate, staff representing the client
- Allocation of other equipment (batons, handcuffs, mobile phones) – as appropriate for the function
- Determination of controls to apply at access and egress points – ID checks, assigning wrist bands, cards and lanyards to indicate authority access for different people
- Identification of routes for foot patrols, and crowd control and surveillance points
- Allocation of temporary codes to enable access to visitors to coded security areas
- Observation of activities by all preparation staff (internal and external) during set-up and during take-down – to deter theft.



The next section will explore the reasons associated with monitoring the set up of infrastructure in the build up to an event.

7.3 Monitor implementation of identified infrastructure requirements

Introduction

Whilst the planning of infrastructure is a monumental task on its own, it is only part of the process.

It is important that when infrastructure arrives for implementation, that the process is monitored. Like with any other aspect of event operations, the importance of constant monitoring and communication is vital.

Reason for monitoring implementation

There are many reasons why it is important to monitor the implementation of infrastructure at an outdoor event, including:

- Ensuring all items have been delivered as intended
- Ensuring the right items have been delivered
- Ensuring items are set up in their correct location
- To help instruct and coordinate different suppliers and their needs
- To ensure all items are in working condition before the supplier leaves.



Being a constant presence is essential during this critical stage not just for your own piece of mind but to be a help to suppliers, many of whom have sent staff to implement items who have not been to the location before, or are unaware of the overall event itself.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 7.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify different types of infrastructure that may be required for two outdoor events of your choice
 - 7.2. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how you would arrange these infrastructure items
 - 7.3. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain how you would monitor the implementation of these items to ensure they are operationally ready for an event.
-

Summary

Plan and deliver infrastructure for outdoor event

Identify necessary infrastructure requirements

- Outdoor event considerations
- Types of infrastructure requirements.

Organise identified infrastructure needs

- Prepare a plan
- Identify suppliers
- Arrange delivery dates and times
- Provide access and security details.

Monitor implementation of identified infrastructure requirements

- Reason for monitoring implementation.

Element 8:

Conduct post-event evaluation

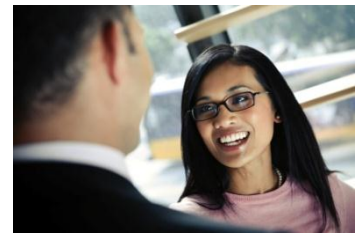
8.1 Meet with client to discuss the event and finalise outstanding issues

Introduction

It should be standard practice during and after every function to seek feedback that may be used to assist in the planning and implementation of future functions.

This feedback can come from a variety of sources, all of which can provide invaluable feedback and suggestions for improvement in future functions.

This process also enables the venue to determine the level of satisfaction of the client with the function and so provides an opportunity for the business to take whatever remedial action might be deemed appropriate.



Client feedback

During the function

An important task is to seek feedback from the client and guests during the course of a function.

They may provide feedback without any prompting, whilst at other times, it will have to be actively sought out by asking questions or by using a function evaluation sheet.

Both positive and negative feedback should be welcomed.

Positive feedback confirms the function is running as expected and expectations are being met.

Negative feedback provides an opportunity to rectify a less than satisfactory situation.

There may also be times when the original function plan may have to be altered to achieve the customer's expectations. Where possible, changes should be made and the client informed of any additional costs associated with the changes.

After the function

After the function it is good industry practice to speak or meet with the client to determine their level of satisfaction and seek feedback.

It is important the venue identifies anything that failed to meet promises or expectations so they can be flagged for extra attention in forthcoming functions.

A pro forma feedback sheet may be used to guide this discussion to ensure vital aspects are not overlooked.

One-on-one, face-to-face meetings with the clients are preferred as they enable you to pick up on body language that may signal problems and the nature of this sort of meeting facilitates following up on issues.

Collecting feedback also helps to identify areas of the function that failed to meet customer expectations and trying to explain the reasons behind these problems, whether caused by the organisation, the customers or out of the control of both.

Some establishments may require the function coordinator to seek written feedback from the customer who attended or organised a previous function. A customer feedback form may be used in such instances and may be supplied to the customer at the end of the function, or mailed out after the event.



It is important all issues mentioned by the client are recorded so they can be discussed internally with relevant staff and suitable arrangements made to ensure mistakes are not repeated in future functions and positive aspects are repeated.

The collection of feedback also helps to seek opportunities to provide further function services to customer. This may be to confirm additional function bookings or provide suitable remedies where the customer is disappointed with the service provider.

Staff feedback

Staff feedback is vital, given that they are the people who can provide a firsthand account of how the event went.

Receiving feedback from operational staff is essential and can assist in assessing the overall running of future functions.

Positive feedback reaffirms the current procedures are working well, while negative feedback may indicate current procedures and methods may need to be revised.

Negative feedback should be accepted and addressed and action taken, where and when necessary, to avoid the same situation from recurring.

It is important that staff understand they are free to highlight any aspect of the function they believe warrants attention. They should feel safe their job is not at risk if they mention something that may 'challenge' arrangements that management put in place.

Staff feedback, which can form part of an individual group discussion, will focus on trying to identify:

- What went right and how this can be replicated
- What went wrong and what changes need to be made to correct this in the future
- Any ideas or suggestions for improvement.



This feedback normally is obtained during the de-brief process which will be discussed in more detail in Section 8.3 of this manual.

External provider feedback

It is also worth checking with third party suppliers after a function to obtain their feedback. A telephone call should suffice.

Matters which could be addressed include:

- Did they have sufficient information to enable them to provide the goods and services they were contracted to supply?
- What extra information do they need next time to make their involvement more effective?
- What issues did they note as part of the set-up or as part of the implementation of the function – they can often bring a different but valid perspective to the evaluation process
- What suggestions do they have that may assist in the planning and execution of future functions – it should be remembered that suppliers deal with lots of functions at other venues and can be seen as a legitimate source of input.

8.2 Meet with sponsors to analyse their thoughts

Introduction

It is vital that as part of the feedback and evaluation process that event organisers seek feedback from sponsors. Given that they would have invested in the event, it is vital that they feel they received value for their investment and that what they were striving to achieve through their sponsorship was achieved.

Not only is it important to find out what they liked or did not like about the event, by taking the input of sponsors seriously, it hopefully keeps them happy and hopefully develops opportunity for continued partnership in events to come.

Meeting with sponsors after the event

It is important to communicate with sponsors after the conclusion of an event. This includes:

- Arranging a meeting with sponsors to debrief the event
- Issuing a proper and appropriate thank-you
- Providing post-event data and reporting that will show your sponsors how your event successfully met their objectives
- Following up on issues that are outstanding.

If your event is an annual one, the gesture will set the stage for repeat sponsorship, and even if not, the move will reassure sponsors that their investment was a smart one.



8.3 Meet with staff to debrief the event

Introduction

In the same way that some properties encourage or require supervisors to hold a briefing session with staff at the start of a session, they also encourage a de-briefing session to be held at the completion of the session.

Conduct debriefing session

This debriefing is usually an informal gathering of all staff once the closing procedures have been completed.

It usually takes 5 – 10 minutes. Some venues include a knock-off drink as part of this session: some don't.

It must be remembered that while this session is potentially important and useful, most staff are either tired or just want to go home.



The supervisor leads the session focused on:

- Congratulating staff on work that has been well done during service
- Discussing staffing issues including:
 - Staffing levels
 - Rostered start and finish times – including breaks, where applicable
 - Skill levels required or found to be missing
- Suggestions from staff regarding improvements that could be made to the implementation of future functions
- Highlighting and leading discussion on problems and issues that arose – with a view to determining what went wrong, how a similar event can be avoided in the future
- Providing the staff with feedback on their perspective of how the session went – and providing feedback they have captured from others such as customers, management or other departments
- Discussing feedback received by staff from those who attended
- Reviewing the quality of service delivery provided – with a view to identifying changes that could lead to possible improvements in service delivery
- Encouraging staff to identify issues of concern to them – including identification of problems they have found with equipment etc, suspicious persons, procedures that are not working effectively
- Discussing patron issues – regarding access, behaviour, intoxication, knowledge about the function
- Discussing operation of ancillary services provided as part of the function – such as accommodation, parking, participation in activities, access and use of inclusions
- Presenting issues or details of what can be expected in the next session
- Determining staff who will work on future functions
- Thanking staff for their efforts and contribution.

8.4 Calculate the financial outcome of the event

Introduction

Once the function has been concluded and all the feedback has been collected by the customer, it is now time for the client to settle the account.

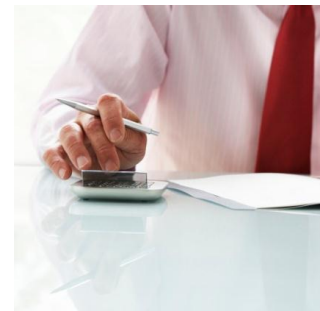
Preparing the account

When preparing the final account for the client it must be detailed according to quoted prices, confirmed final numbers and actual attendance.

Charges for no-shows or reduced numbers must be fully explained, having been initially explained as part of the initial negotiations, and agreed to, by the client.

Charges may include:

- Food and beverage – as per initial agreement, taking into account adjustments 'on the day'
- Entertainment – bands, artists, personalities
- Venue hire – fees for rooms
- Labour – technical and service staff to set up rooms, activities or operate equipment during the function
- Flowers
- Audio-visual equipment hire
- Printing, photocopying, secretarial services, phone and fax usage
- Ice or margarine carvings, balloons, streamers and other specialised decorations
- Dance floor hire.



Before the account is presented to the client it should be shown to management for their final approval so all charges may be verified and that all monies expended may be recouped.

A copy of the account must then be presented to the correct person. Care must be taken here to ensure that the 'right' person gets the bill.

For example, it would be most inappropriate and embarrassing for the bride and groom to be given the bill, when the parents had organised the wedding and agreed to pay.

A copy of the account should be placed in the function file.

Methods of payment

When the function is booked a credit check may be done to ascertain client ability to pay.

Where the check reveals a doubt about ability to pay then options are to refuse the function or to request total payment in advance.

Many venues require at least part pre-payment of functions to cover food and base labour costs.

Whatever method of payment is decided on it should be set out on the function sheet under the sub-heading 'billing instructions'.

Some venues require the account to be presented on the day at the end of the function for immediate payment in cash, by cheque or credit card. This is obviously a preferable option for the venue but may be difficult or nearly impossible for the client.

In this case the account presentation should be done sensitively so as not to spoil the occasion. Also you need to be aware the client is sometimes hard to find, or difficult to get away from people that they are talking to.



Moreover the host could also be affected by liquor thereby making discussion of final points and matters difficult.

Where an account is posted out it is common for 7 or 14 day payment terms to apply.

Complete administration documentation

It is quite common for the Functions manager to complete a range of documentation at the completion of a function. There is generally an urgency associated with this as the venue will commonly seek to finalise this aspect of the function as soon as possible.

Activities to complete include:

- Collating feedback from the sources identified in the previous section
- Paying out monies to any entertainers or outside suppliers for services rendered
- Receiving final payment of the client's account in accordance with the terms and conditions set out in the function contract
- Signing off staff time sheets – and ensuring all hours claimed by staff have been authorised
- Checking the facilities to determine if repairs are need, service is required or if replacement items need to be purchased
- Processing payment and posting payment record on account
- Issuing receipt and 'Thank you' letter to the client
- Completing a feedback form which is often the basis for the staff debriefing (explained in the next section) and to be used as a database for up-coming functions
- Preparing final comments about the function
- Identifying preferences that may be helpful for future functions by the client
- Adding customer comment cards
- Adding photos taken onto a database to be used as a marketing tool
- Finalising all financial documentation including closure of accounts and printing of final accounts and payments
- Storing the account file in an appropriate storage folder or area.



8.5 Determine the extent to which the event attained the identified objectives that were set for it

Introduction

One of the final tasks to perform after all the operational activities associated with an event have concluded is to determine if the event actually attained the identified objectives that would have originally been set in the initial stages of event planning.

Types of objectives

General objectives

There are many overall objectives for holding an event, some of which include:

- Increase revenue and profit to a department
- Increase brand awareness in the market place
- Expand the range of products or services provided by an organisation
- Promote new products or services
- Reinforce or cement success of organisation.

Specific objectives

Each event will also have objectives in which they would like to achieve, many of which are service related and aimed at meeting set standards. Some of these include:

- Run a safe and secure event with no accidents
- Ensure the client is satisfied
- Ensure sponsors are satisfied with their investment and that their objectives were achieved
- Ensure all delegates who attended the event are satisfied
- Ensure the desired profit margins were obtained
- Ensure the event had no or minimal environmental impact
- Ensure service standards reflected overall organisational standards.



Ways to measure obtainment of objectives

There are many ways in which to measure the obtainment of both general and specific objectives including:

- Feedback from delegates, suppliers, clients and sponsors
- Media releases about the event
- Financial reports
- Customer complaints
- Repeat business statistics
- Injury reports
- Social media interaction
- Flow on bookings to other departments
- Personal observations
- Peer and management feedback
- Personal evaluation and reflection.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 8.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify why it is important to meet with clients after the event including information that needs to be finalised or obtained
 - 8.2. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify why it is important to meet with sponsors after an event
 - 8.3. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify what is normally discussed with staff at an event debrief
 - 8.4. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify the financial costs associated with an event
 - 8.5 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify various event objectives and how you can measure if they have been obtained.
-

Summary

Conduct post-event evaluation

Meet with client to discuss the event and finalise outstanding issues

- Client feedback
- Staff feedback
- External provider feedback.

Meet with sponsors to analyse their thoughts

- Meeting with sponsors after the event.

Meet with staff to debrief the event

- Conduct debriefing session.

Calculate the financial outcome of the event

- Preparing the account
- Methods of payment
- Complete administration documentation.

Determine the extent to which the event attained the identified objectives that were set for it

- Types of objectives
- Ways to measure obtainment of objectives.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Allen, Judy; 2009 (2nd edition); *Event Planning: The Ultimate Guide to Successful Meetings, Corporate Events, Fundraising Galas, Conferences, Conventions, Incentives and Other Special Events*; Wiley

Arduser, Lora and Brown, Douglas R; 2004 (1st edition); *The Waiter & Waitress and Waitstaff Training Handbook: A Complete Guide to the Proper Steps in Service for Food & Beverage Employees*; Atlantic Publishing Group Inc.

Fenich, George; 2011 (3rd edition); *Meetings, Expositions, Events & Conventions: An Introduction to the Industry*; Prentice Hall

Golden-Romero, Pat; 2007 (1st edition); *Hotel Convention Sales, Services, and Operations*; Butterworth-Heinemann

Johnston, R & Clark G, 2008 (3rd Edition); *Service Operations Management*; Pearson Education

Lillicrap, Dennis & Cousins, John; 2010 (1st edition); *Essential Food and Beverage Service: Levels 1 & 2*; Hodder Arnold

Zeithaml, Valarie A; 2009 (1st edition); *Delivering Quality Service*; Free Press

Trainee evaluation sheet

Manage special events

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Manage special events

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Develop event concept and proposal			
1.1	Identify event objectives and scope	☐	☐
1.2	Establish event concept, theme, format and protocols	☐	☐
1.3	Prepare event brief	☐	☐
1.4	Develop event proposal/bid details, where necessary	☐	☐
Element 2: Determine event venue/location			
2.1	Identify potential event venues and sites	☐	☐
2.2	Analyse alternative event venues and sites	☐	☐
2.3	Select event venue/site	☐	☐
2.4	Confirm arrangements for selected venue/site	☐	☐
Element 3: Plan and deliver event catering			
3.1	Identify and analyse event factors which may impact on catering	☐	☐
3.2	Prepare event catering proposal	☐	☐
3.3	Prepare event catering operational plan	☐	☐
3.4	Implement event catering operational plan	☐	☐
Element 4: Lead and motivate staff			
4.1	Identify sponsorship opportunities, where appropriate	☐	☐
4.2	Create and promote sponsorship packages, where appropriate	☐	☐
4.3	Implement sponsorship items and activities	☐	☐
4.4	Follow up with sponsors	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 5: Plan and deliver event management			
5.1	Liaise with event stakeholders	☐	☐
5.2	Prepare event management plan	☐	☐
5.3	Manage event set up in-line with event management plan	☐	☐
5.4	Monitor conduct and implementation of event in-line with event management plan	☐	☐
5.5	Manage finalisation of event and event breakdown in-line with event management plan	☐	☐
Element 6: Provide for human resource development			
6.1	Take event bookings and process event registrations	☐	☐
6.2	Monitor on-going event registrations and take remedial action where necessary to increase attendance/registrations	☐	☐
6.3	Finalise event registrations	☐	☐
6.4	Produce identified event materials for guests and delegates	☐	☐
6.5	Coordinate and process guest and delegate registration at the event	☐	☐
Element 7: Evaluate the implementation of the human resource plan			
7.1	Identify necessary infrastructure requirements	☐	☐
7.2	Organise identified infrastructure needs	☐	☐
7.3	Monitor implementation of identified infrastructure requirements	☐	☐
Element 8: Conduct post-event evaluation			
8.1	Meet with client to discuss the event and finalise outstanding issues	☐	☐
8.2	Meet with sponsors to analyse their thoughts	☐	☐
8.3	Meet with staff to debrief the event	☐	☐
8.4	Calculate the financial outcome of the event	☐	☐
8.5	Determine the extent to which the event attained the identified objectives that were set for it	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

